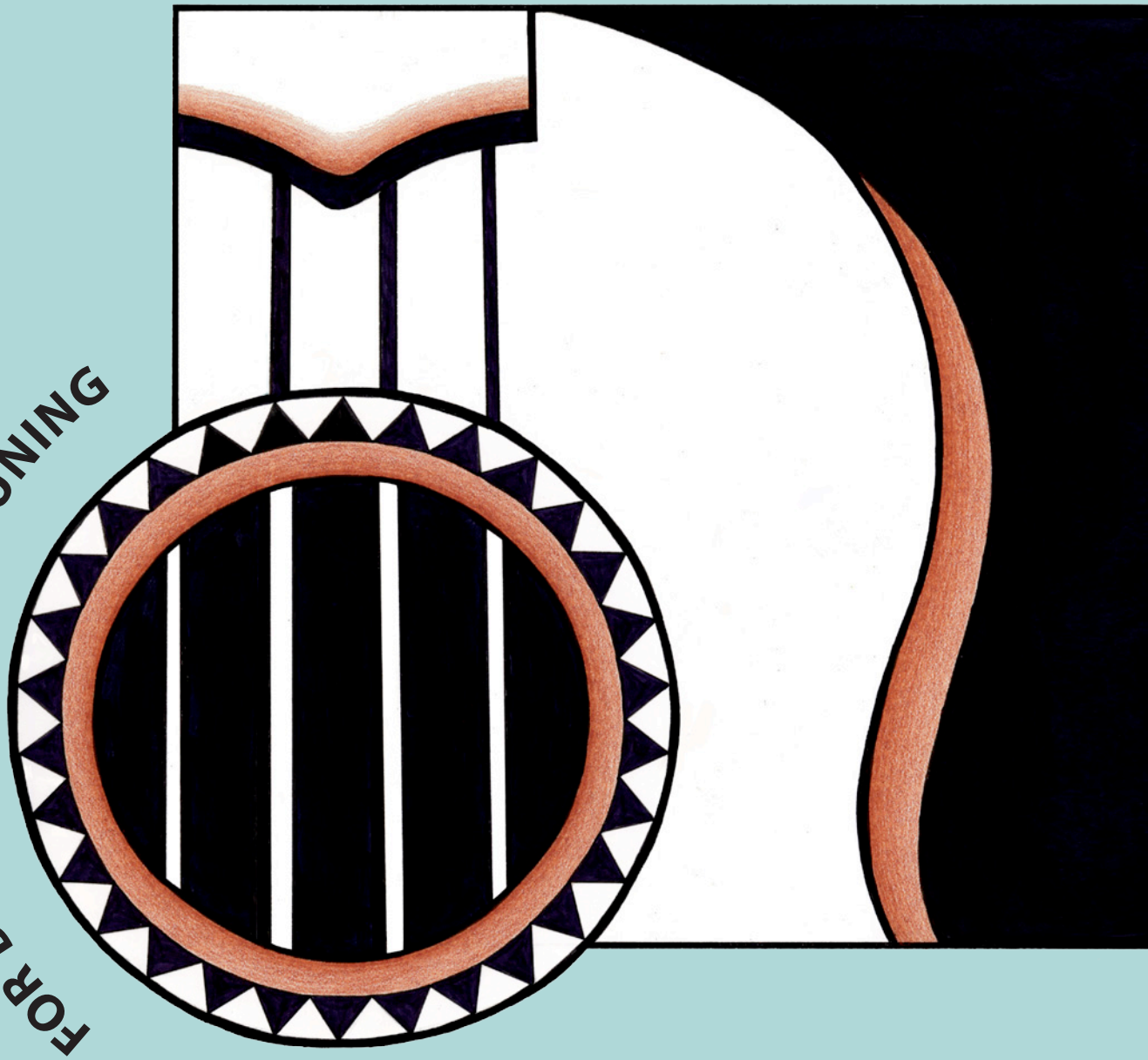
Ukulele

Sounds of Earlier Music



FOR BARITONE DGBE TUNING

Chord melody arrangements by Elizabeth Ragsdale

A special thanks
to members of the
Madison Area Ukulele Initiative
www.mauimadison.com



allelon music

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Contents

GETTING STARTED 4
Allegretto in C by Carcassi 6
Allegretto in C by Giuliani 7
Allegretto in E Minor by Carcassi 8
Allegretto in G by Carcassi 9
Allemande in A Minor by Anonymous 10
Allemande in A Minor by Phalèse 11
Almain by Dowland 12
Andante in A by Mozart 13
Andante in A Minor by Carulli 14
Andante in C by Sor 16
Andante in D Minor by Carcassi 17
Andantino in C by Carcassi 19
Andantino Mosso in A Minor by Carcassi 20
Arioso by Bach 22
Bianco Fiore by Negri 23
Brandenburg Concerto No. 3 24
Canarie by van den Hove 25
Concerto in E Minor by Vivaldi 26
Corrente by Corelli 27
Country Dance No. 4 by Haydn 29
Dear Nightingale by Kaiser 30
Españoleta by Sanz 31
Etude No. 4 by Fenando Sor 32
Gypsy Rondo by Vivaldi 33
Harmonious Blacksmith, The, by Handel 35
Larghetto Espressivo by Carulli 37
Largo from the Four Seasons by Vivaldi 38
Minuet in A Minor by Krieger 40
Minuet in B Minor by Weiss 41
Minuet in C by Carcassi 42
New German Dance No. 4 by Haydn 43
Nonesuch by Anonymous 44
Ode to Joy by Beethoven 45
Prelude in D by Carcassi 46
Prelude in E Minor by Carcassi 47
Rigadoon by Purcell 48
Rondeau by Jean-Joseph Mouret 49
Sarabande by de Visée 50
Sonatine op. 71 by Giuliani 51
Spagnoletta by Caroso 52
Study in G by Carulli 53
Study No. 5 by Sor 55
Symphony No. 40 by Mozart 56
Theme and Variations by Giuliani 58
Toy, A, by Anonymous 59
Volte by Anonymous 60
Waltz in A Minor by Carcassi 61
Waltz in D by Carcassi 62
Waltz No. 3 by Carulli 64
What If a Day by Anonymous 65
APPENDIX 66

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Getting started

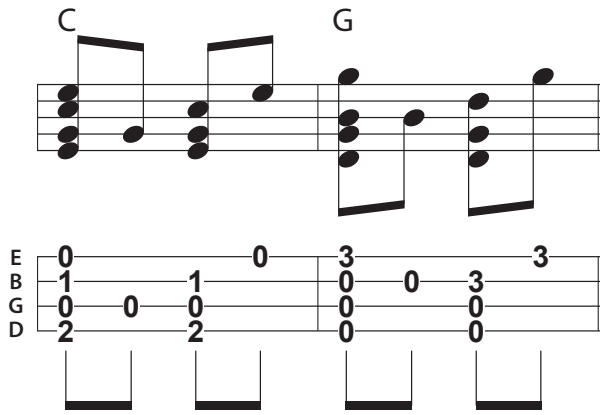
Welcome to **Ukulele Sounds of Earlier Music: For Baritone DGBE Tuning.** This unique collection includes 50 songs from the Renaissance, Baroque, and Classical musical periods. The pieces were chosen because they have memorable melodies and are well suited to the ukulele.

These instrumental arrangements feature common chords played at intervals to enrich the sound of the melody. You strum or pick the chords and pick the melody.

Level

This book was written for the beginner in chord melody playing, but not the absolute beginner on the ukulele. The melodies in this book stay mostly in first position. The ability to read music is helpful but not necessary. The standard chord tabs for each song are displayed at the top of the page. (See the Appendix for a complete list of the chords.)

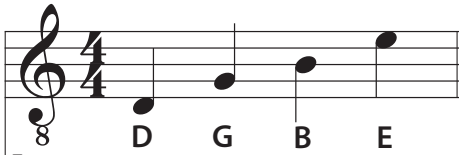
As shown in the following example, tabs are used below the melody line to show you where to place your fingers on the strings.



The four lines represent the four ukulele strings. The numbers indicate which frets to place your fingers on, not which fingers to use. A zero means the string is played open. The marks below the numbers indicate how long the notes are held.

Tuning

The songs were written for DGBE tuning, which is ideal for melody playing because the pitch of the open strings ranges from low to high.



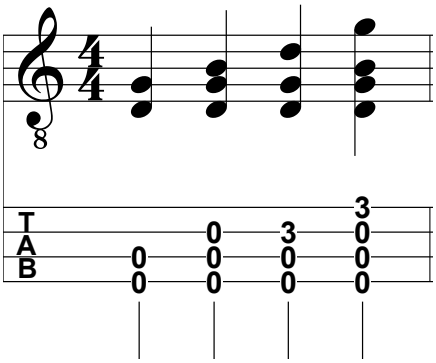
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Chord melody arrangements

In chord melody playing, the highest note played in a chord is what the ear hears as the melody note. For many of the songs, you'll see a small 8 below the treble clef sign. This means the pitches on your ukulele will be one octave below the notes in the staff.

Technique

1. Strumming chords: To strum the chords, brush down the strings with your thumb, playing only those notes indicated in the tablature. The tab for a chord may show 2, 3, or 4 vertical numbers. For example, a G chord may be strummed any of the following ways, depending on the melody note.

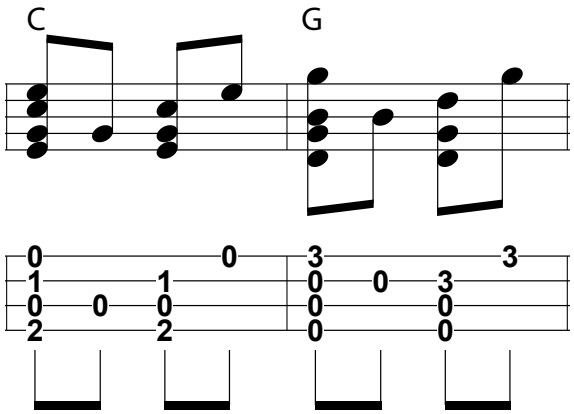


Alternate between strumming or picking the chords and picking the individual melody notes. This gives you a lighter and smoother sound than strumming a chord on every melody note.

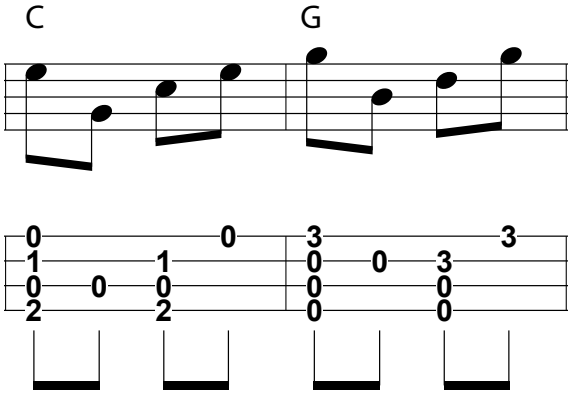
2. Picking chords: The technique of playing two or three notes at the same time is especially suited to earlier music. You can (a) pluck the notes in a pinching motion with your thumb and fingers, (b) strum the notes if they are on adjacent strings, or (c) rapidly pick the notes.

For ease of reading, only the melody note is displayed in the top part of the score, even though chords are sometimes being played.

Standard music notation



Simplified music notation in this book



The rewards

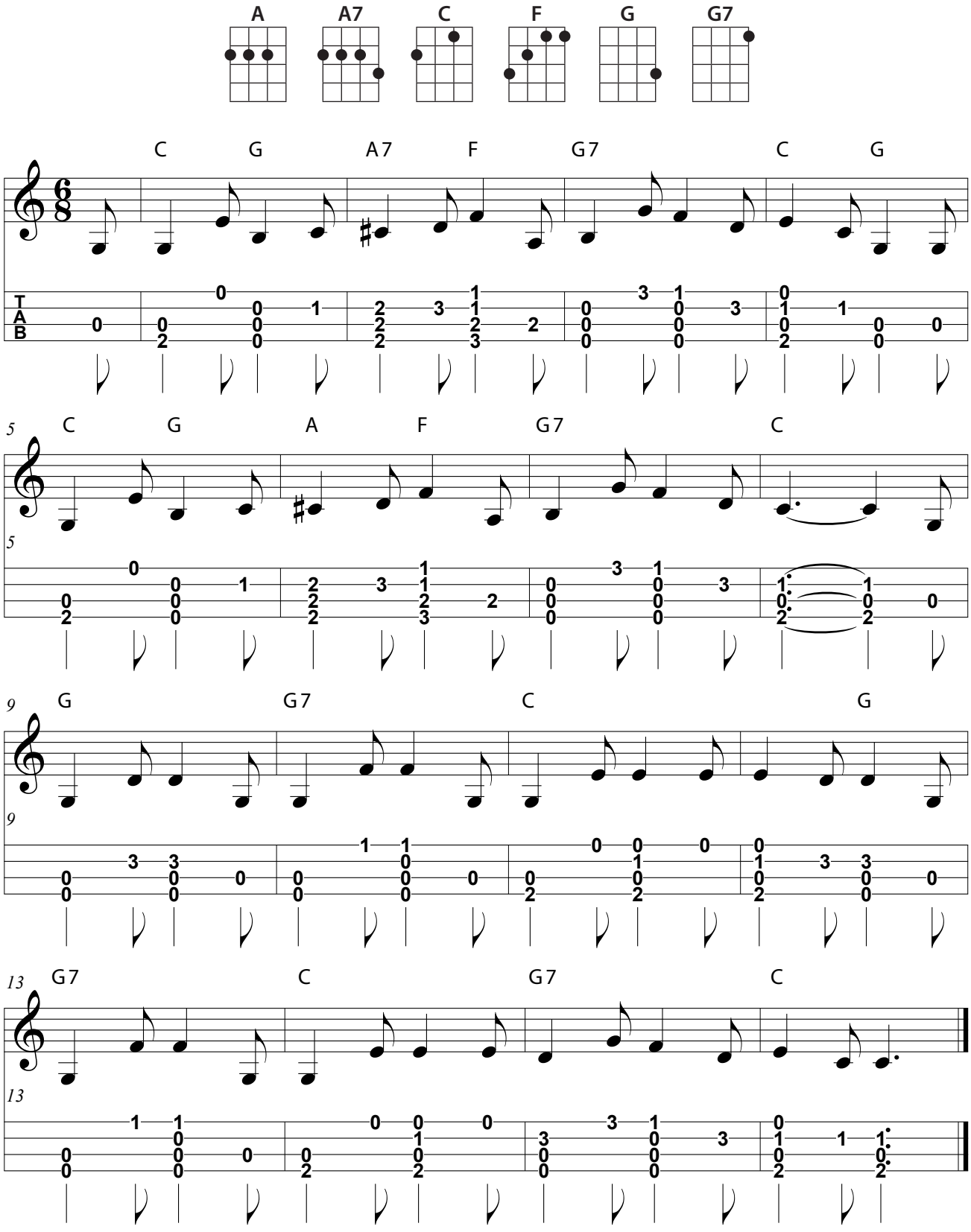
Learning the chord melody technique is a satisfying addition to whatever kind of playing you're already doing. You'll be demonstrating that the ukulele is a real musical instrument with a lot more potential than often recognized.

You may find it easier to finger an entire chord, even though you may not be playing all the strings. Likewise, you can often keep your fingers in a set position as you play a whole segment of the melody, with the goal of shifting your hand as little as possible.

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Allegretto in C
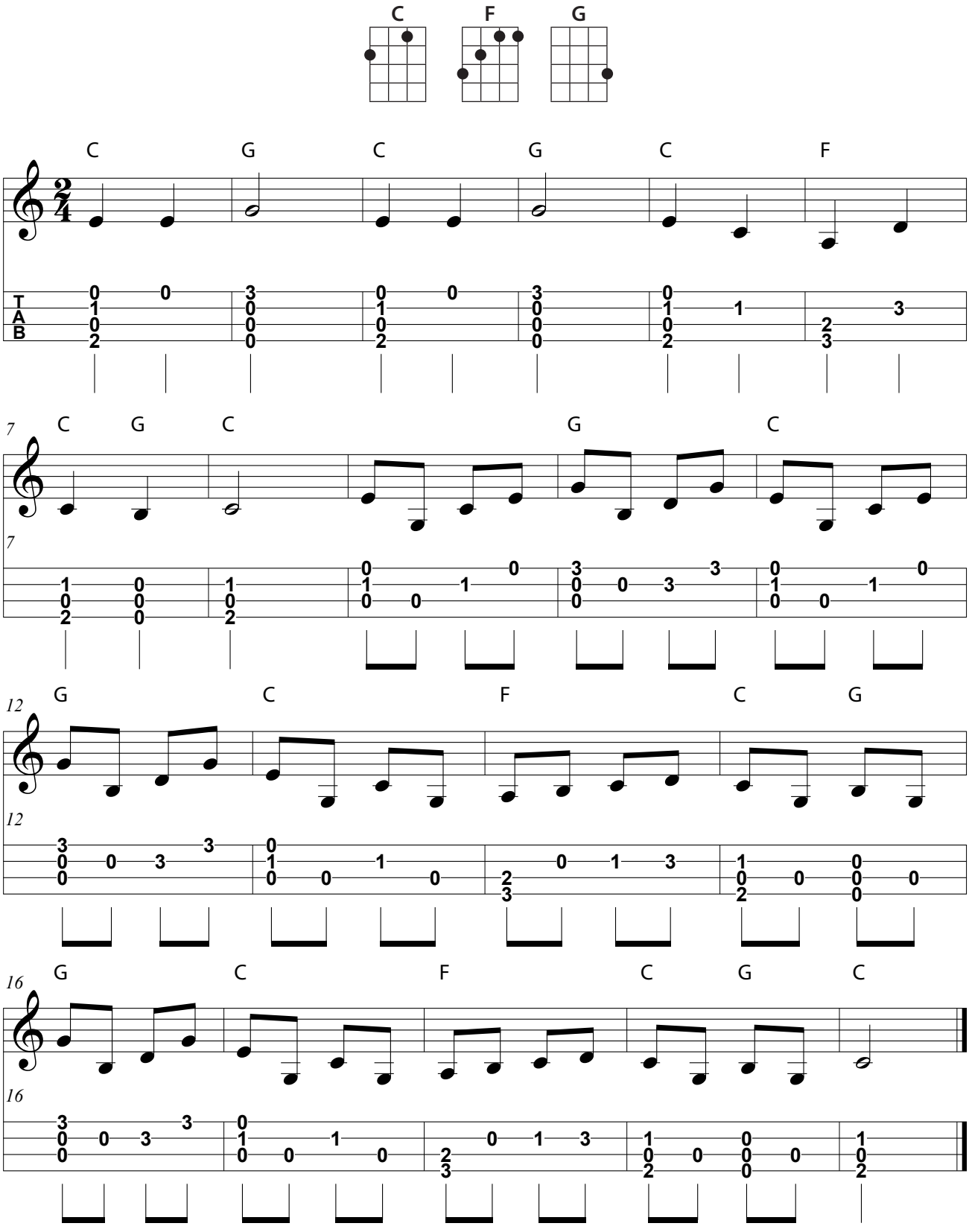
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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Allegretto in C

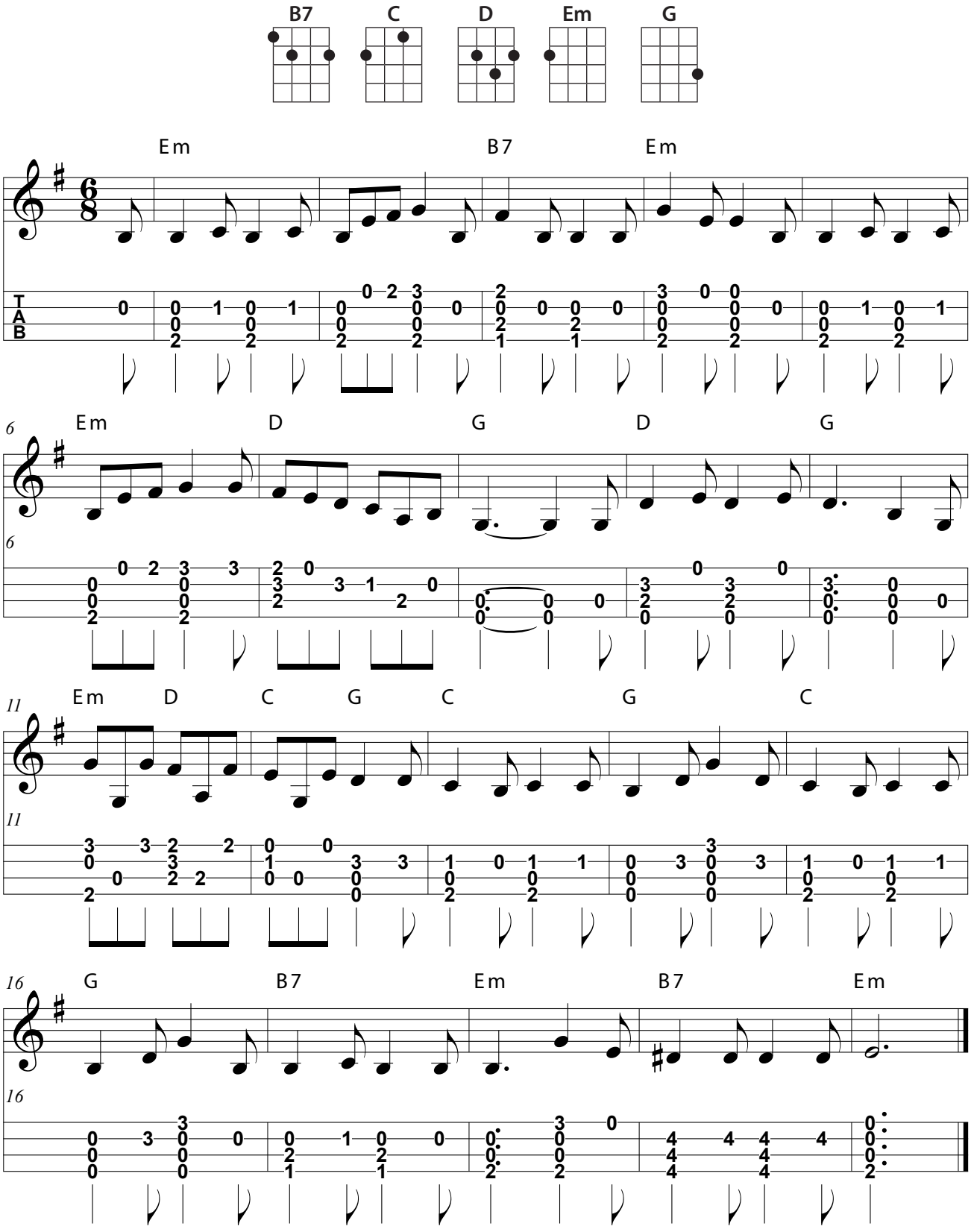
Mauro Giuliani (1781–1829)



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Allegretto in E Minor

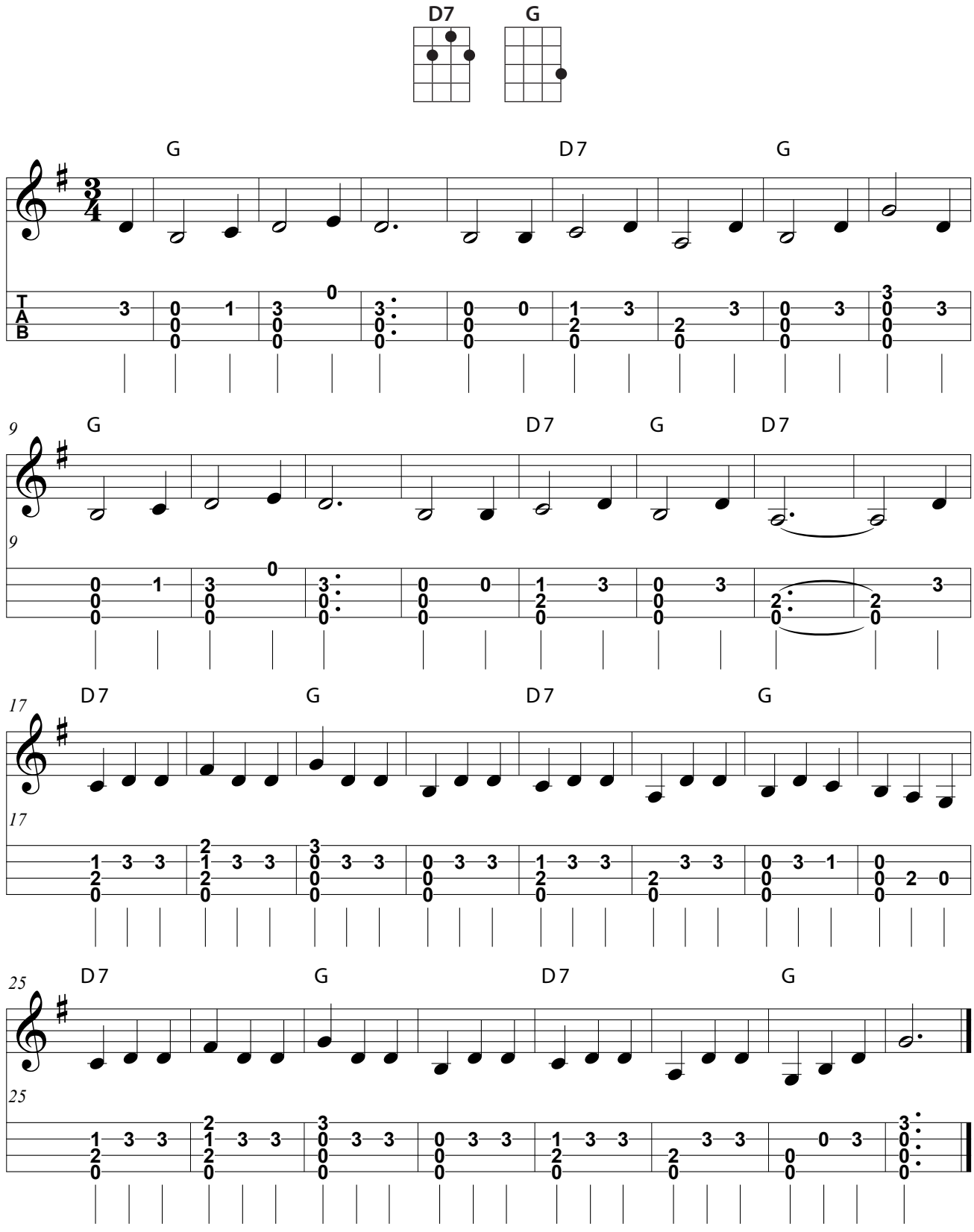
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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Allegretto in G
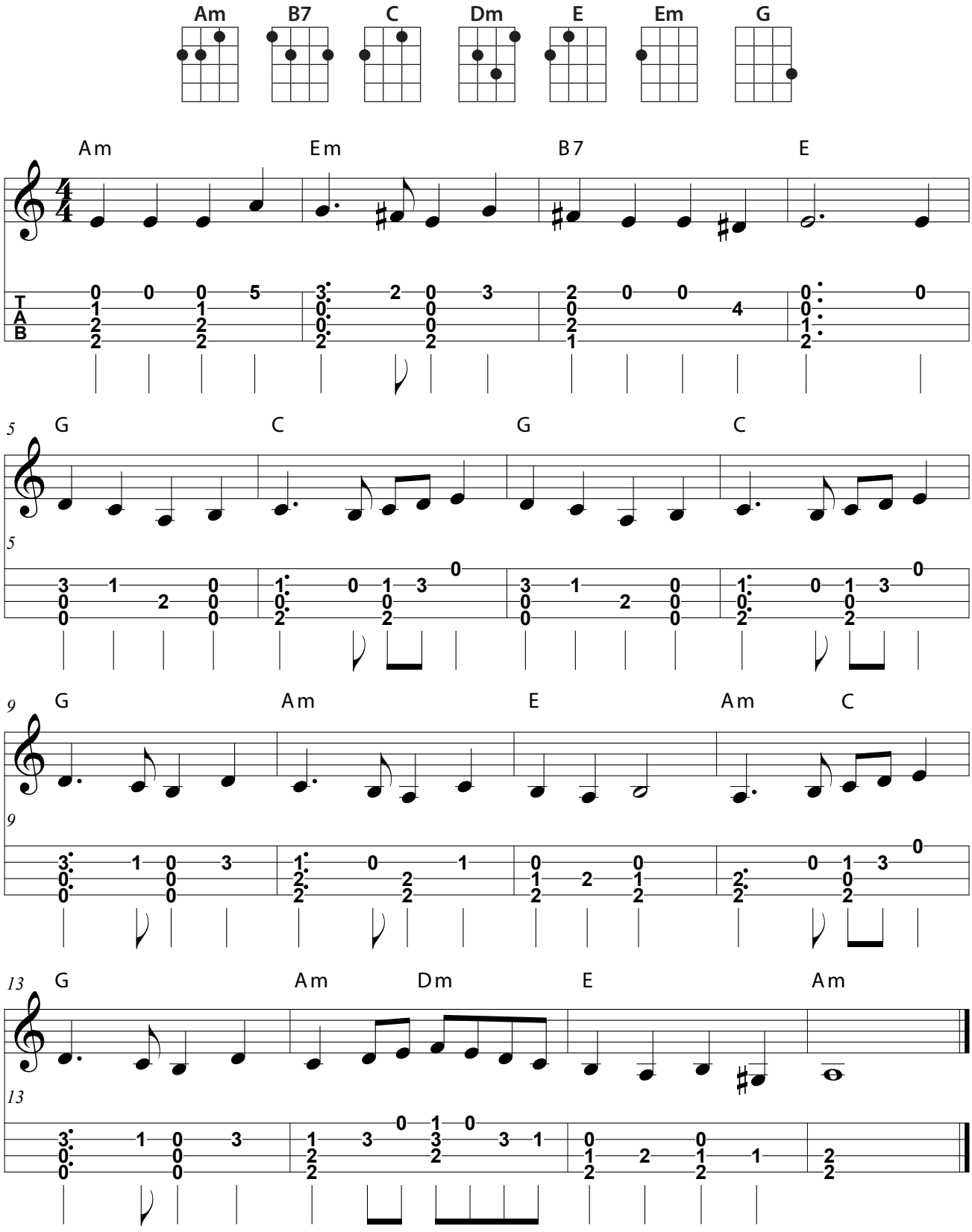
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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Allemande in A MInor
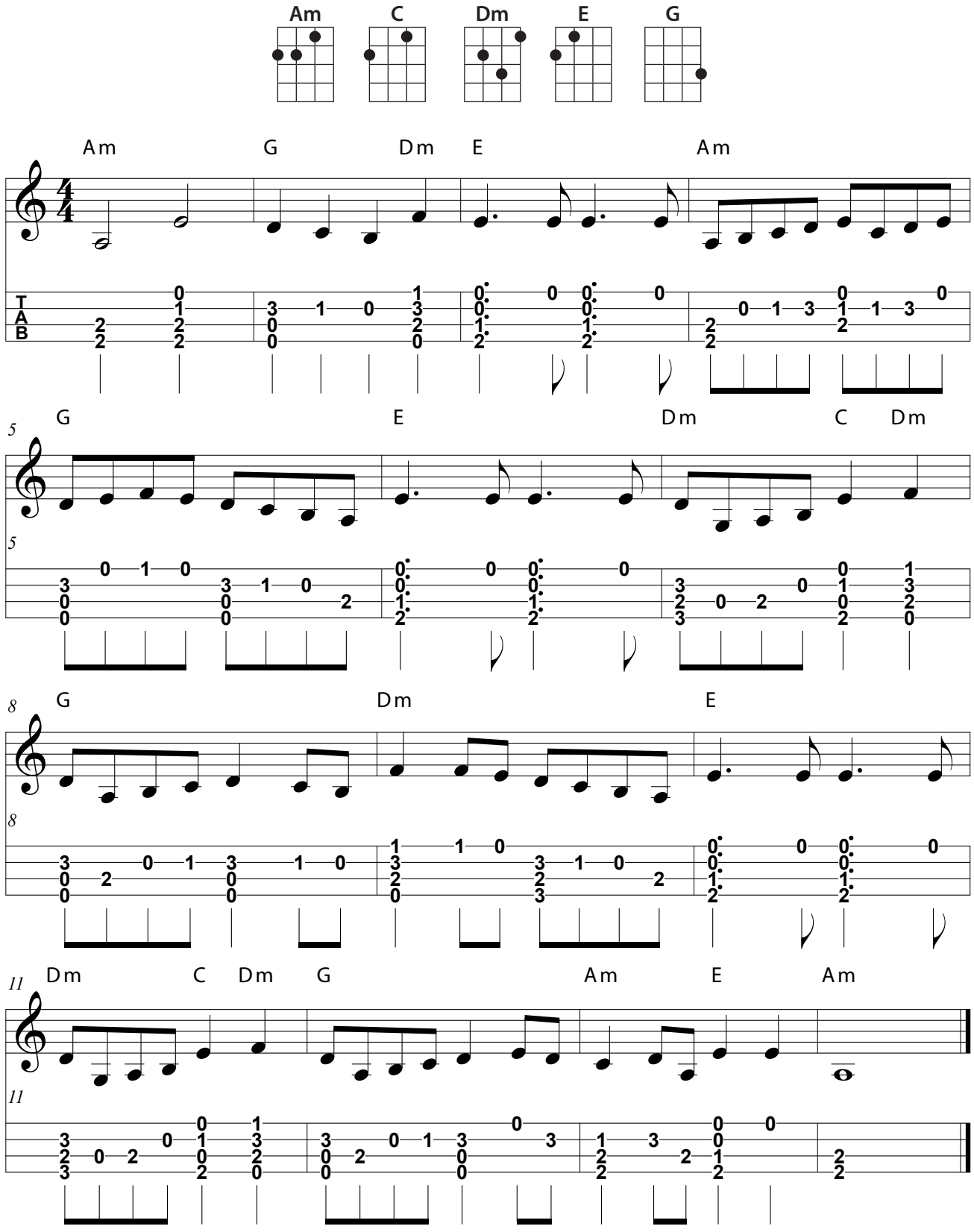
Anonymous (Renaissance)



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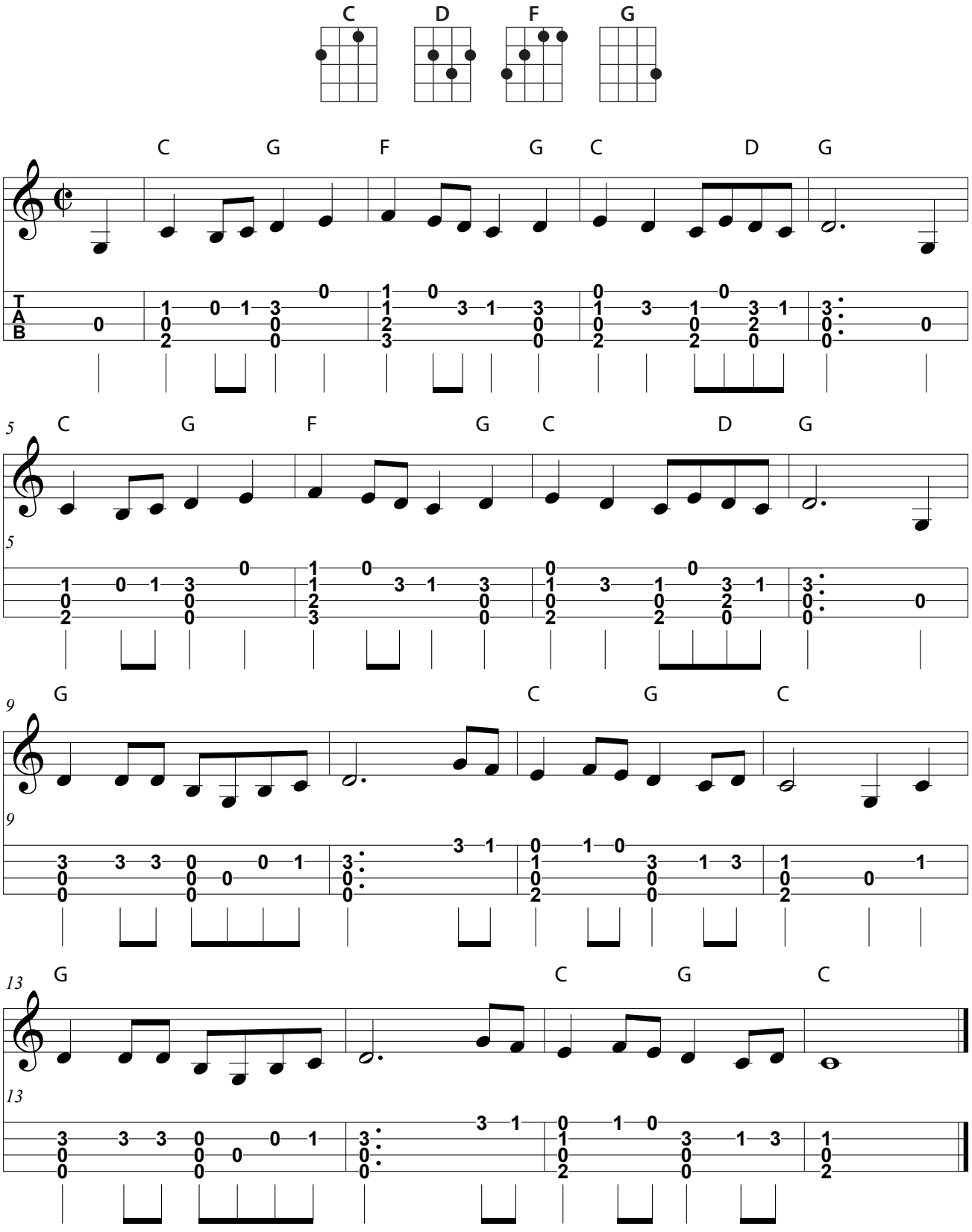
Pierre Phalèse (1510–1575)



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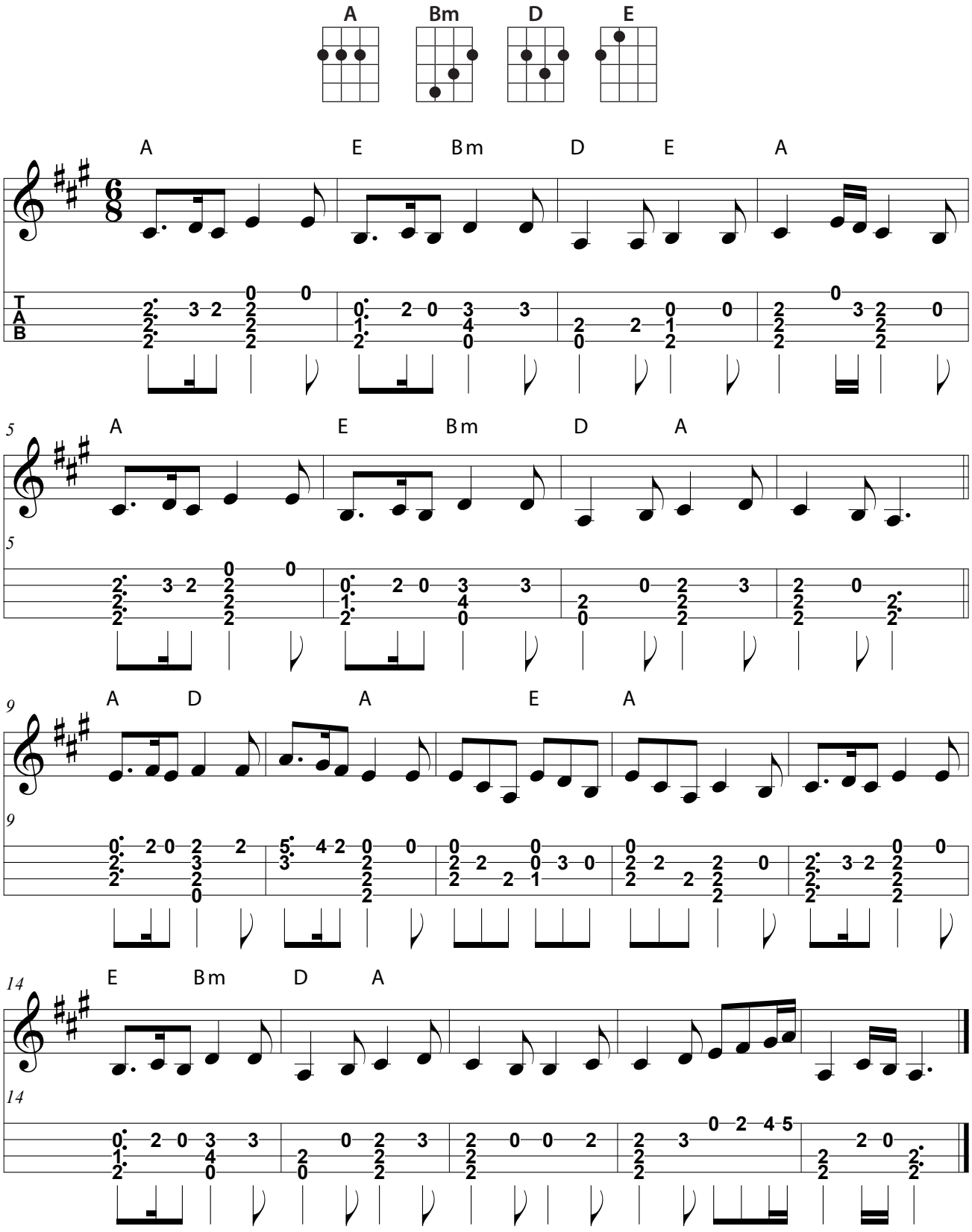
John Dowland (1563–1626)



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Andante in A

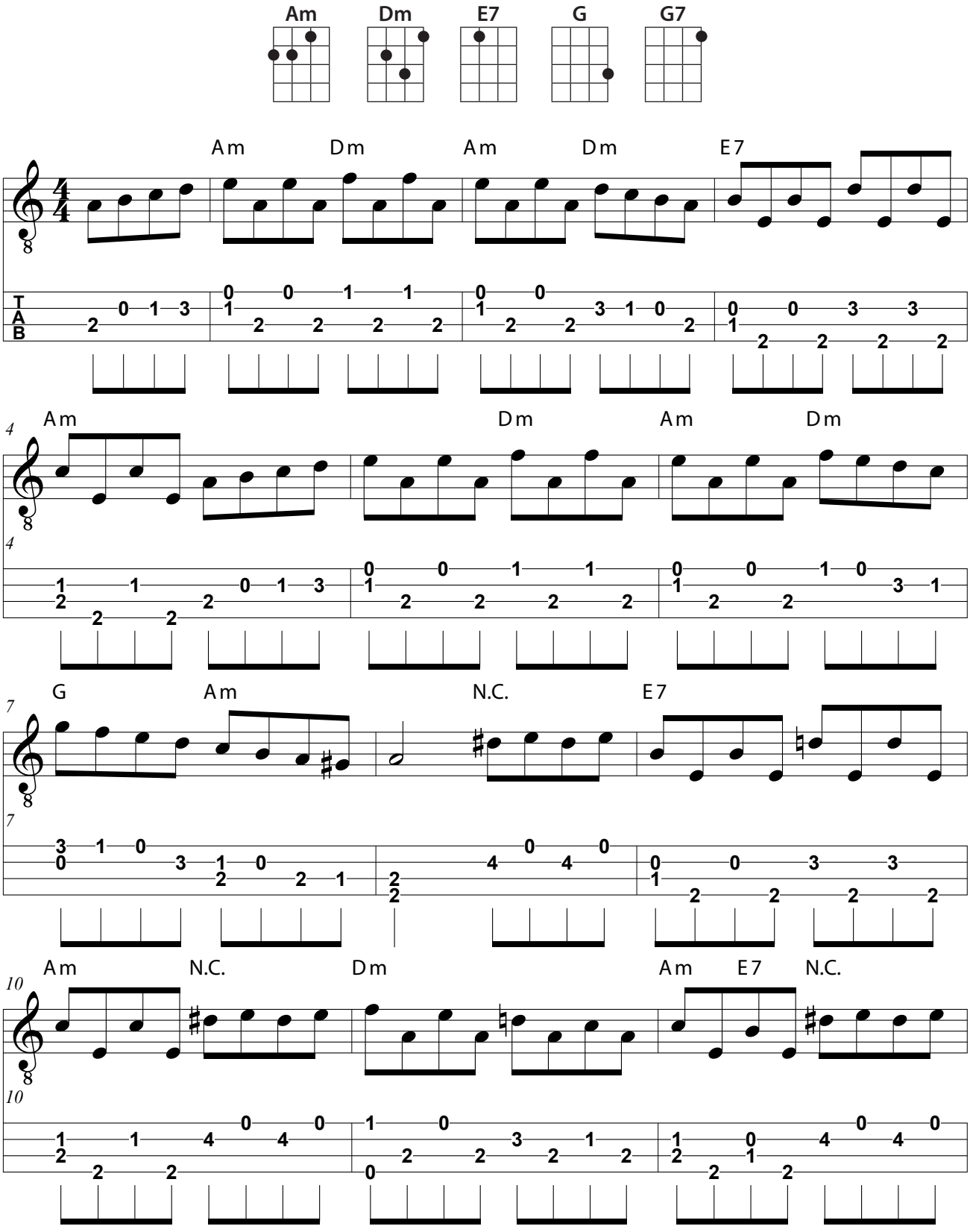
Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart (1756–1791)



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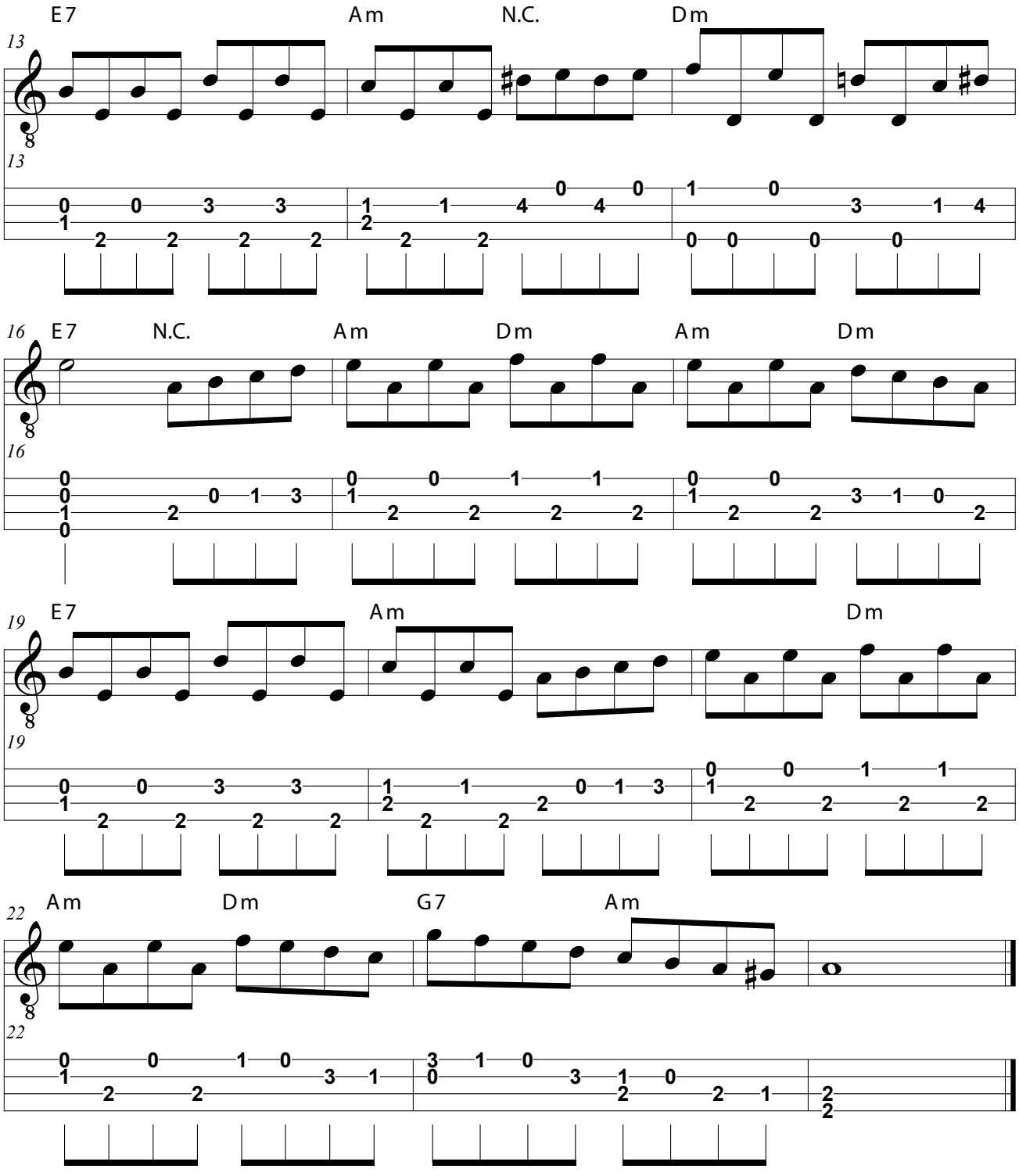
Andante in A Minor

Ferdinando Carulli (1770–1841)



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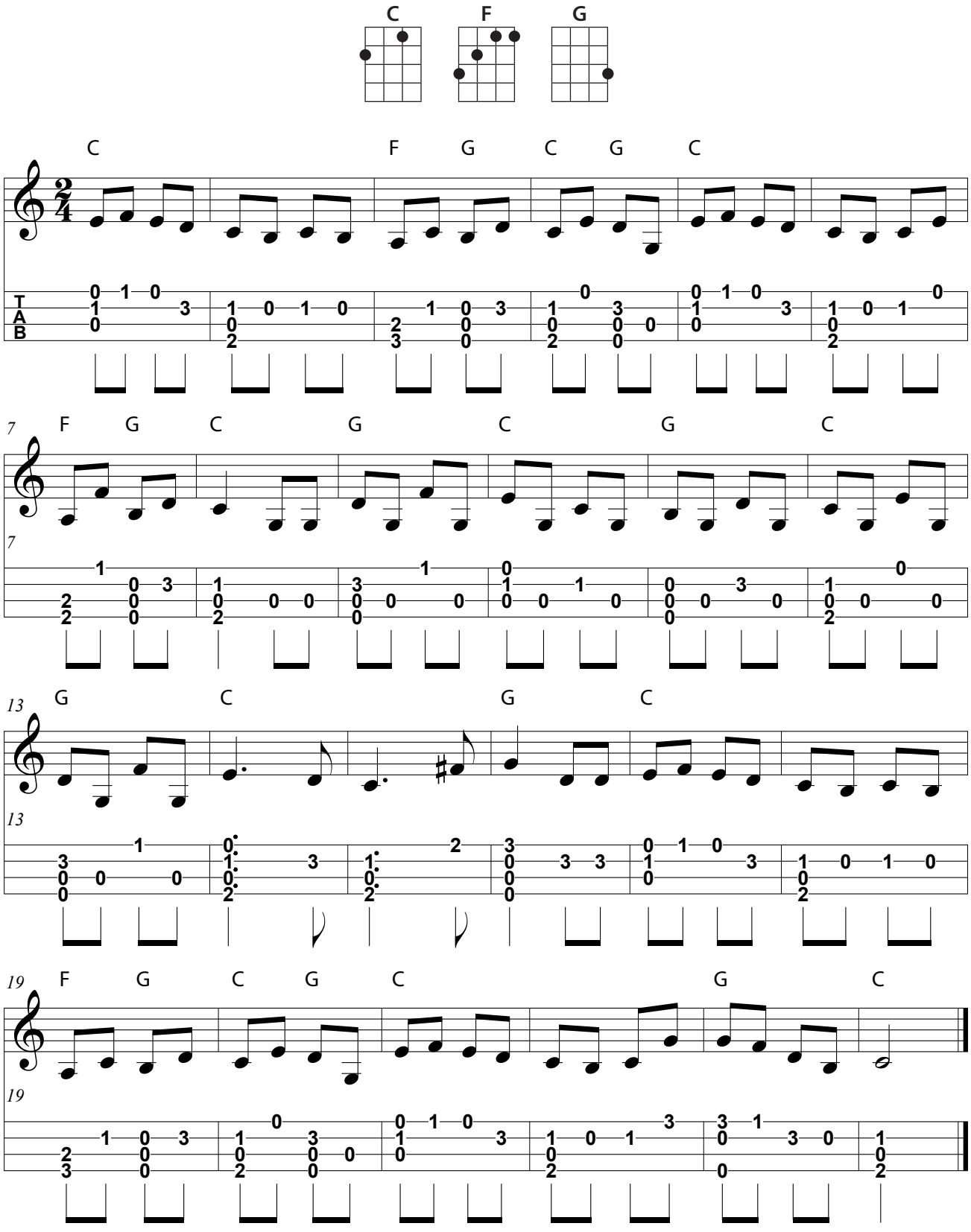
Andante in A Minor



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Andante in C
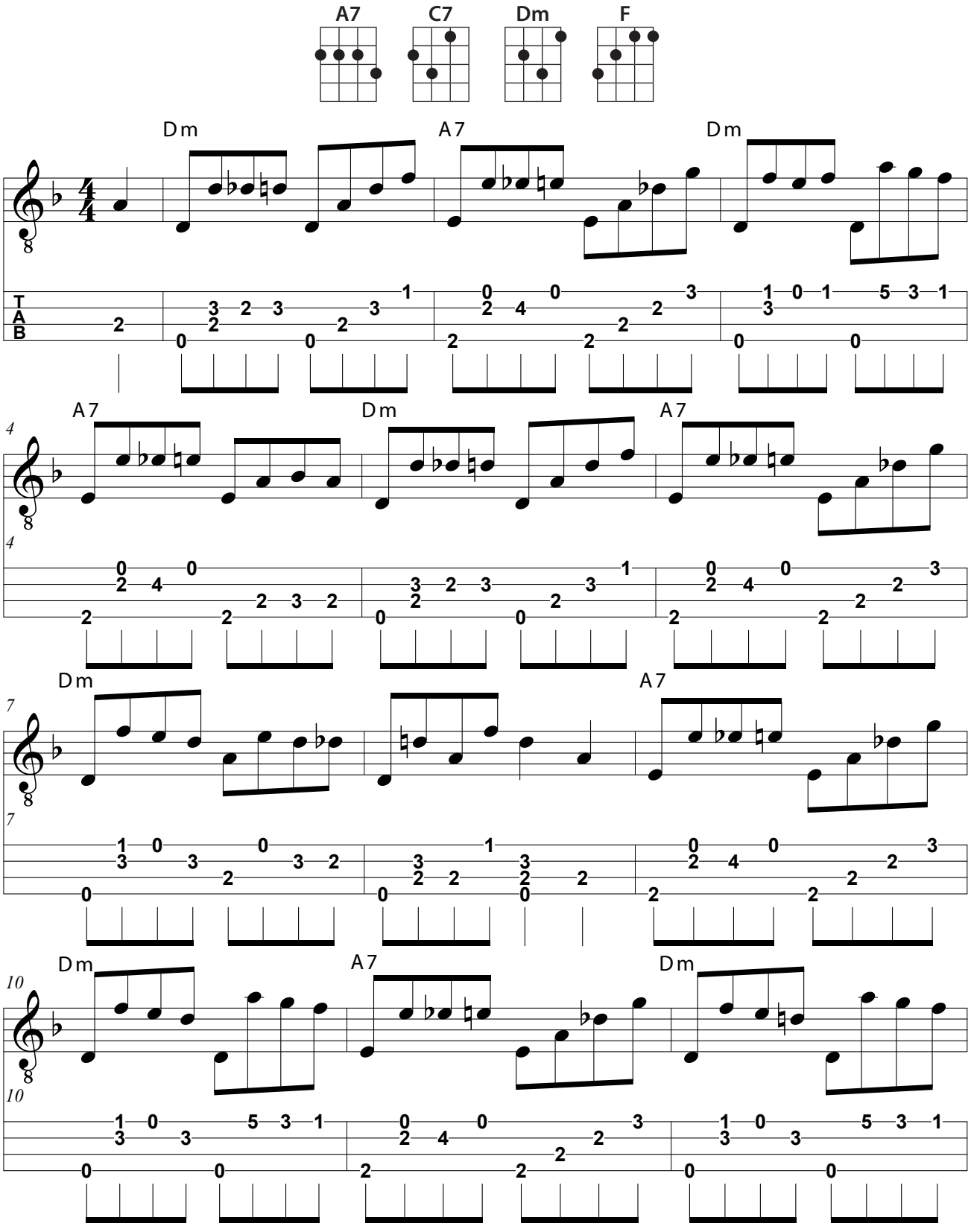
Fernando Sor (1778–1839)



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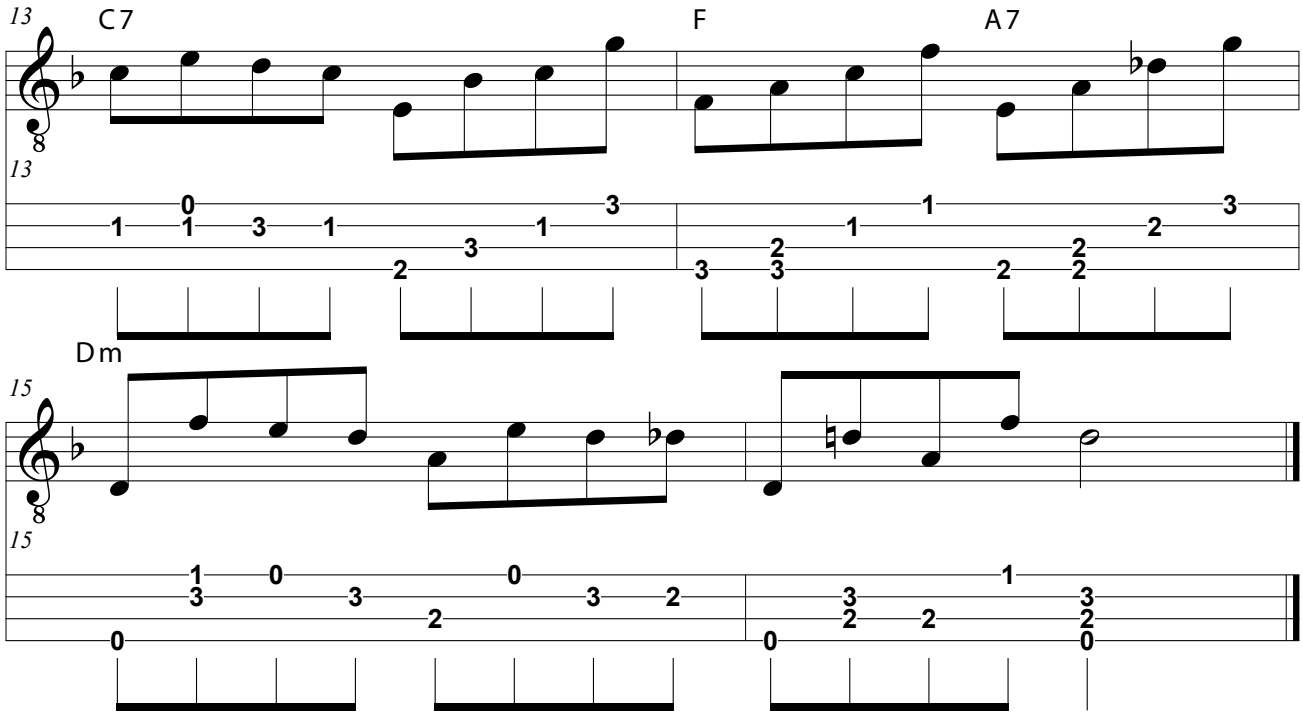
Andante in D Minor

Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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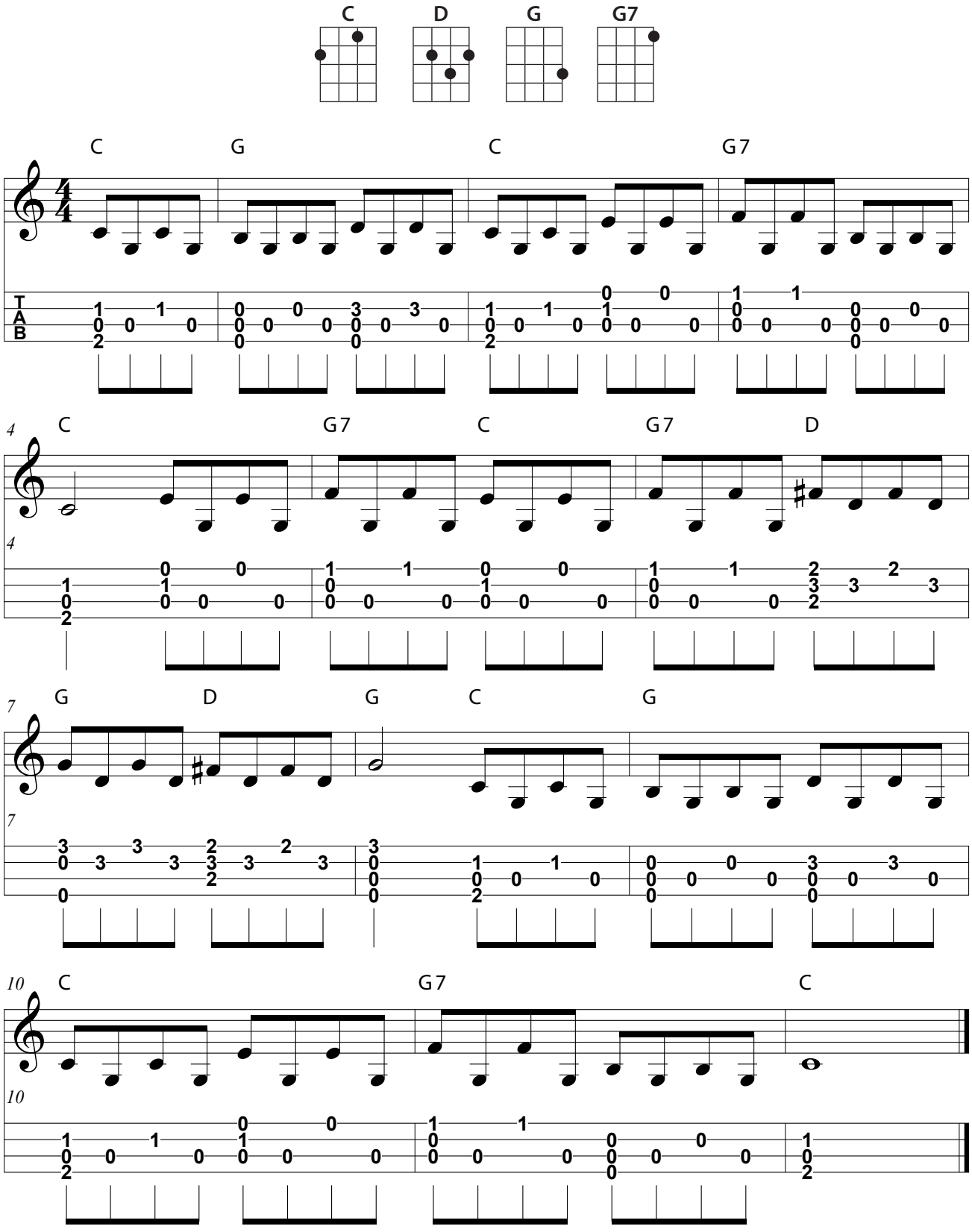
Andante in D MInor



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Andantino in C

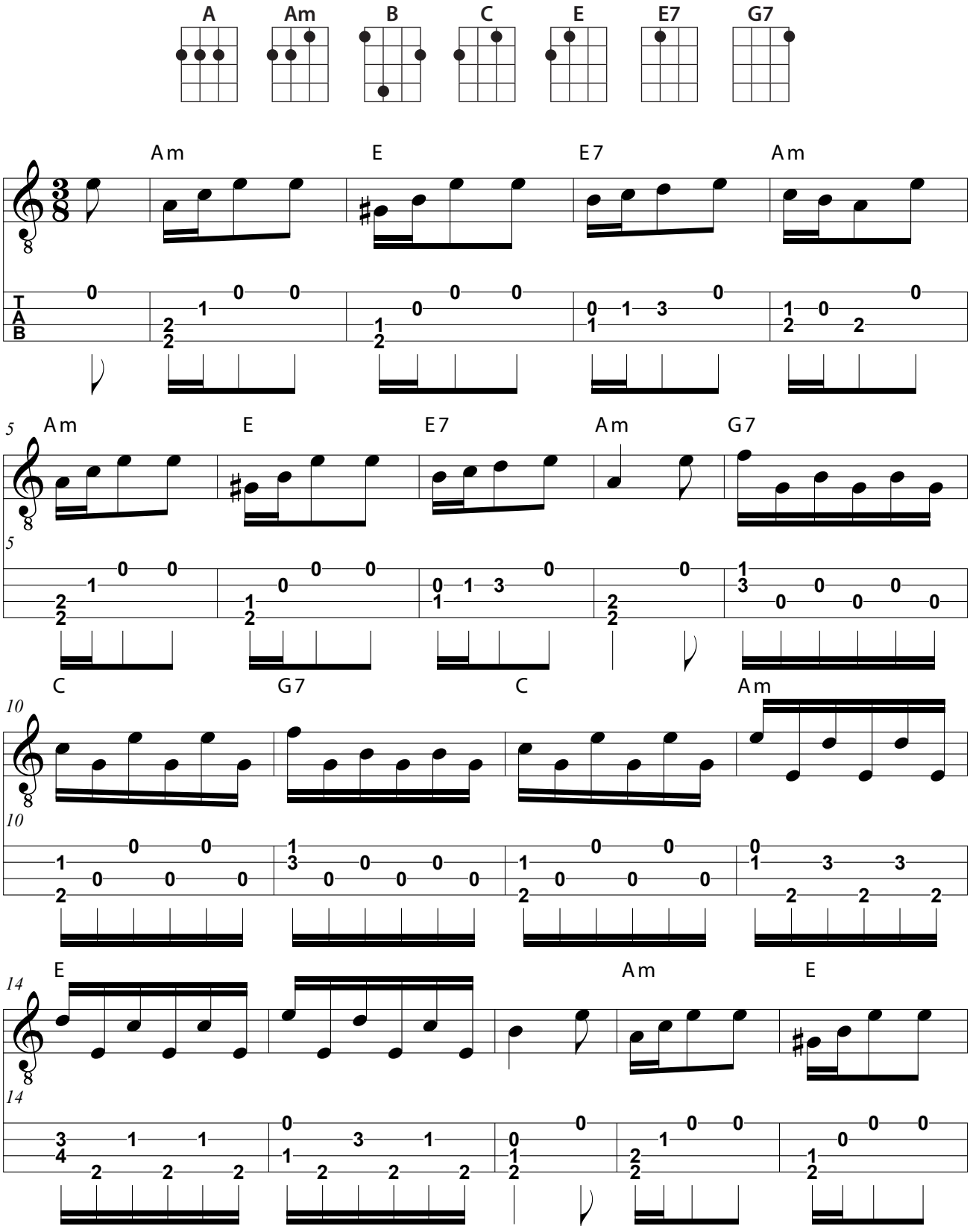
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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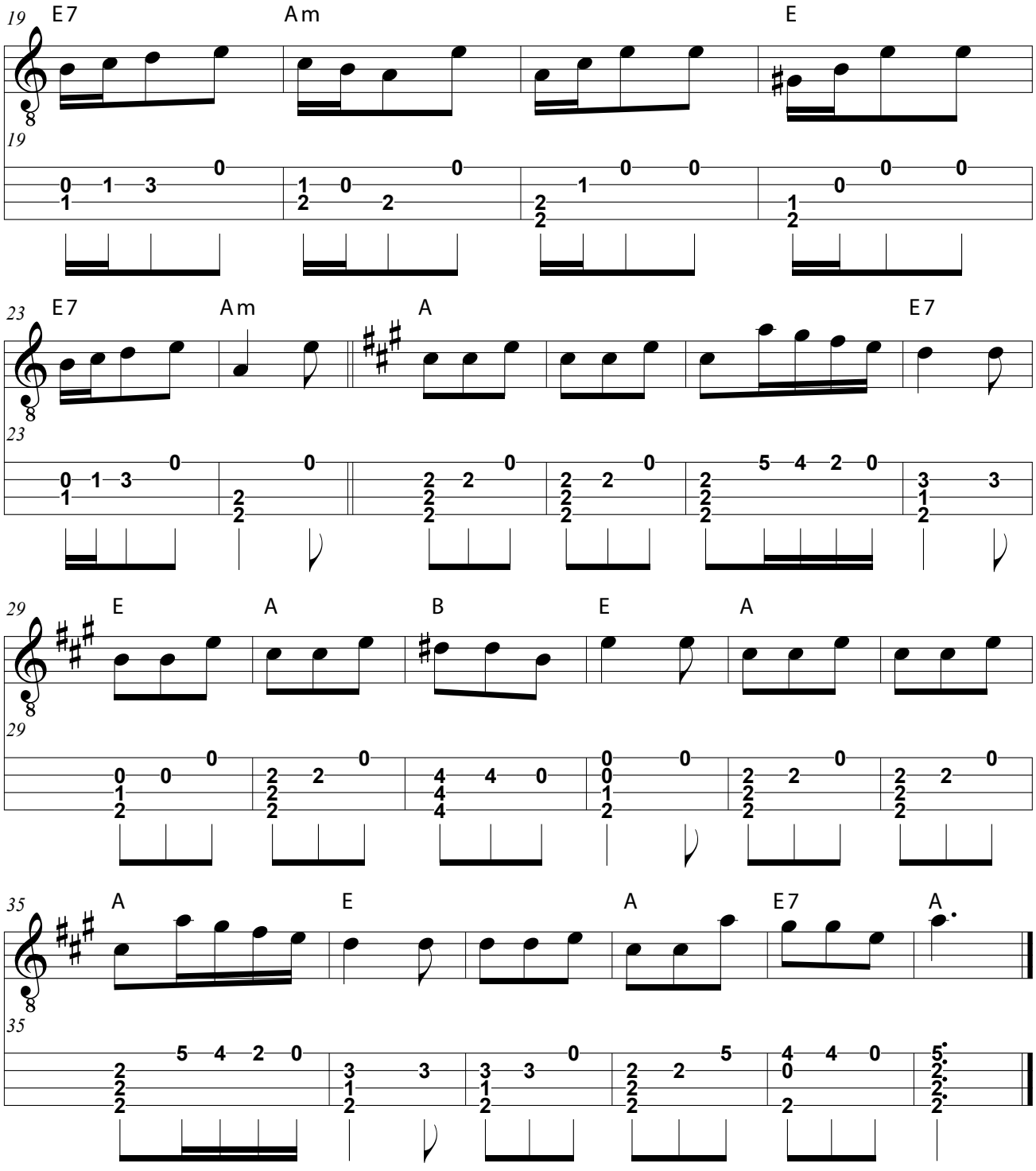
Andantino Mosso in A MInor

Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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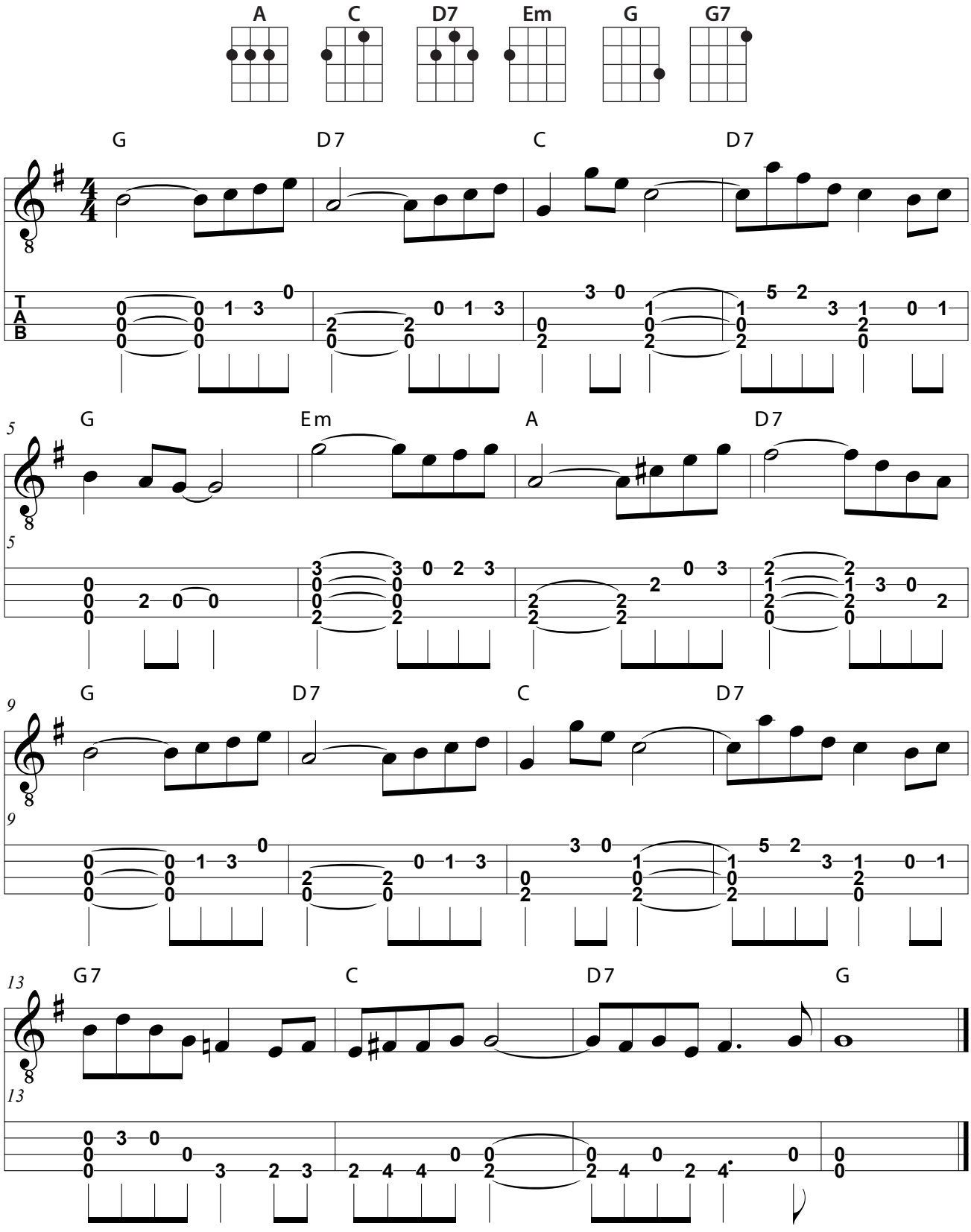
Andantino Mosso in A Minor



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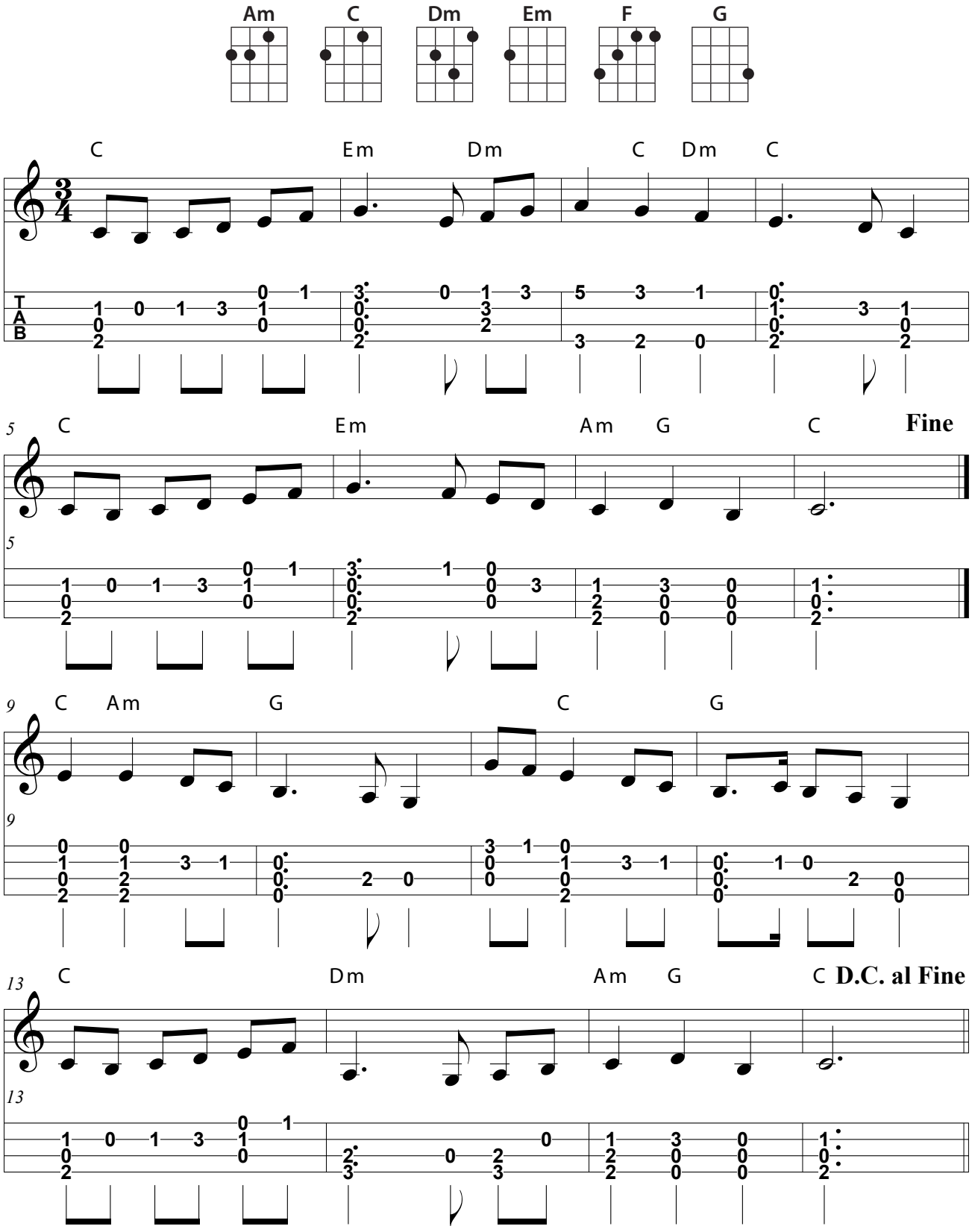
Johann Sebastian Bach (1685–1750)



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Bianco Fiore
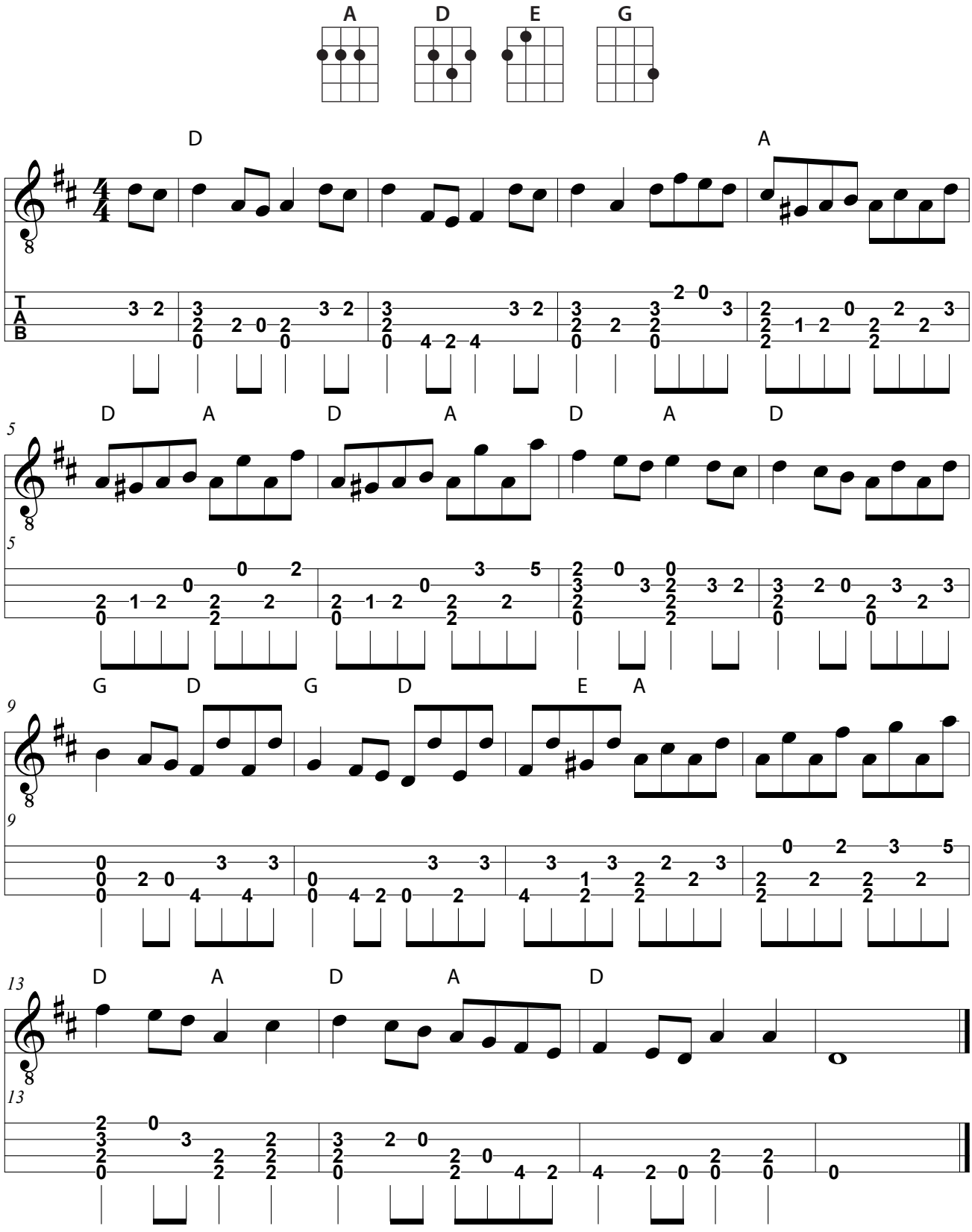
Cesare Negri (1535–1604)



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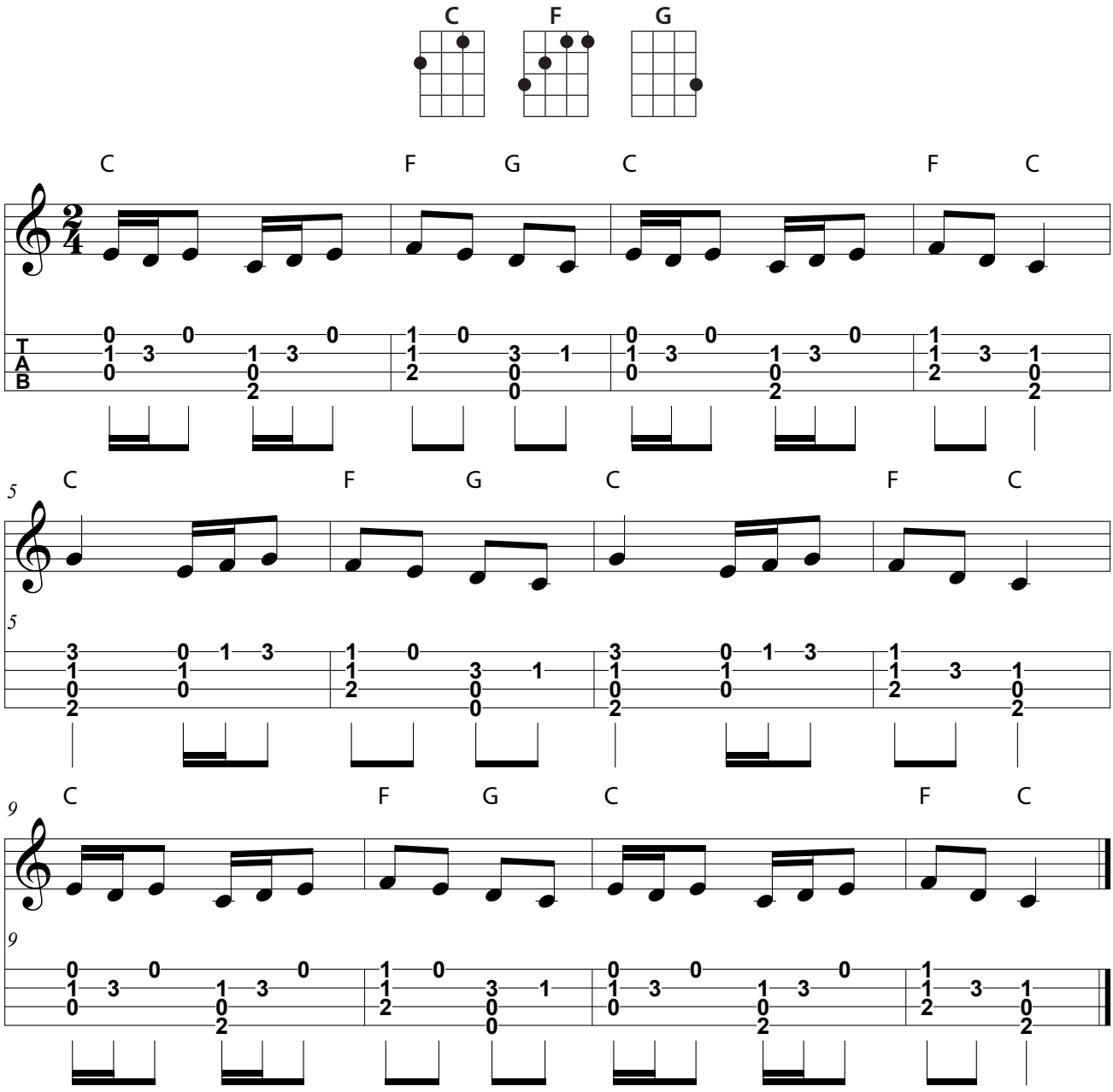
Johann Sebastian Bach (1685–1750)



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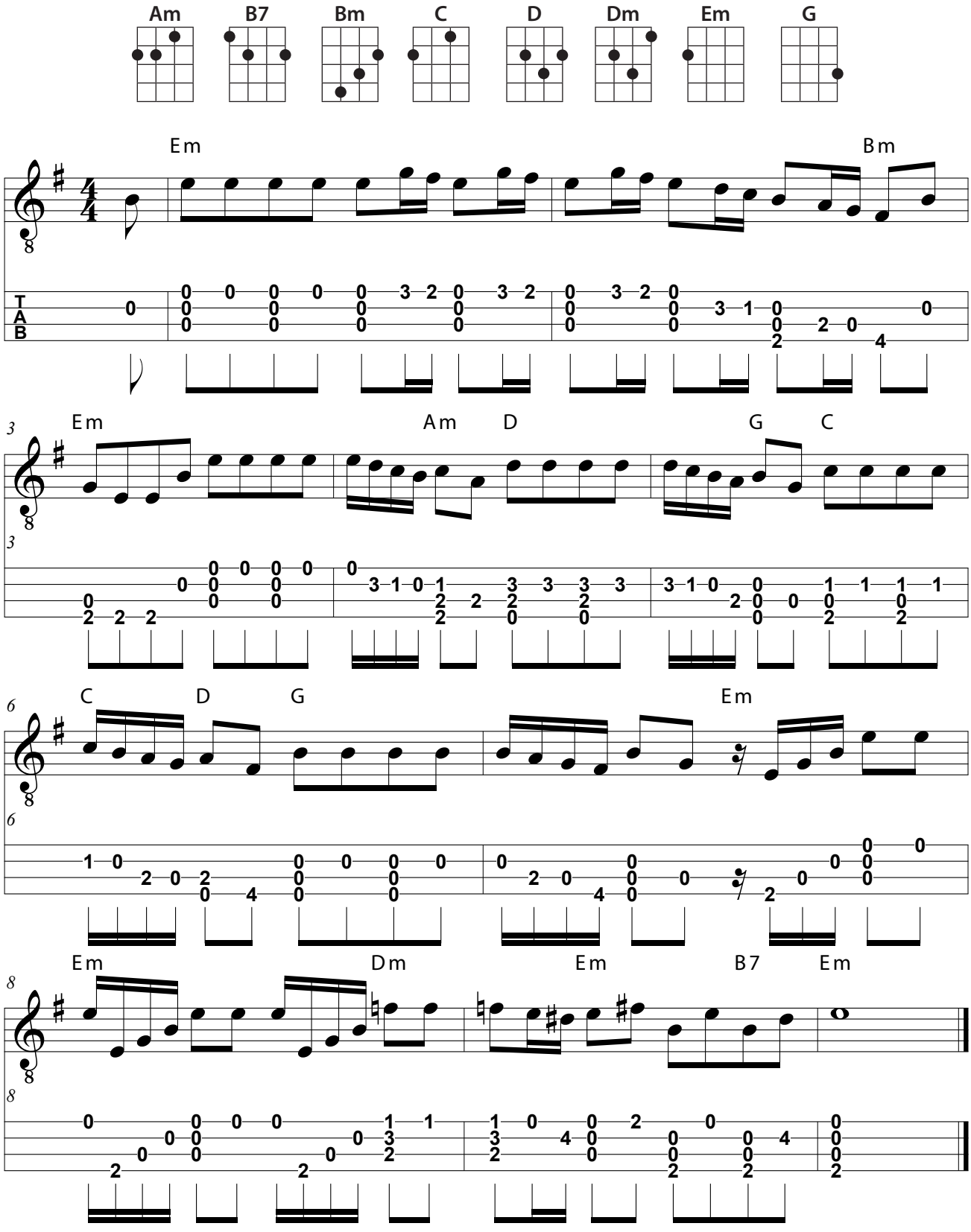
Joachim van den Hove (1567–1620)



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Concerto in E Minor
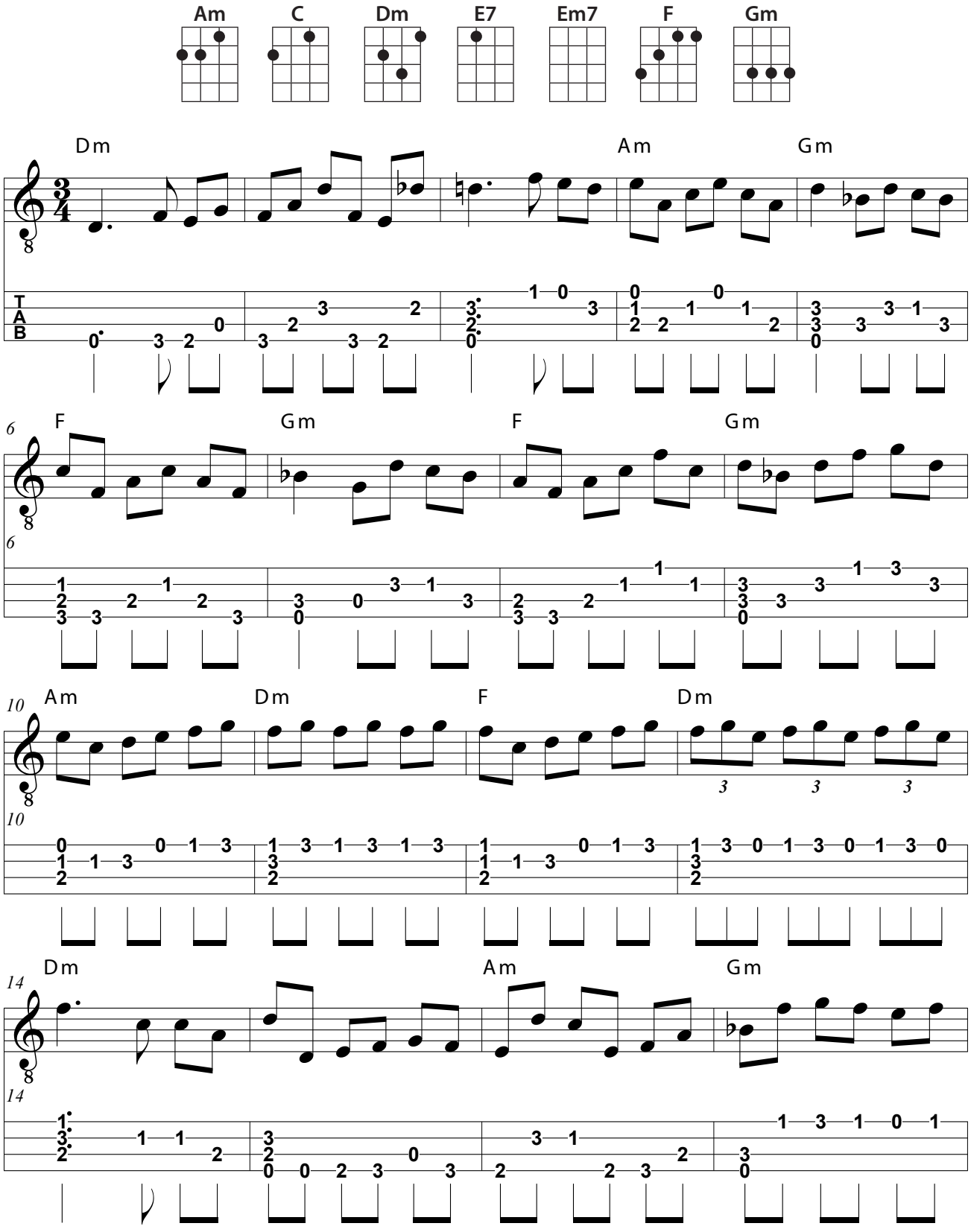
Antonio Vivaldi (1678–1741)



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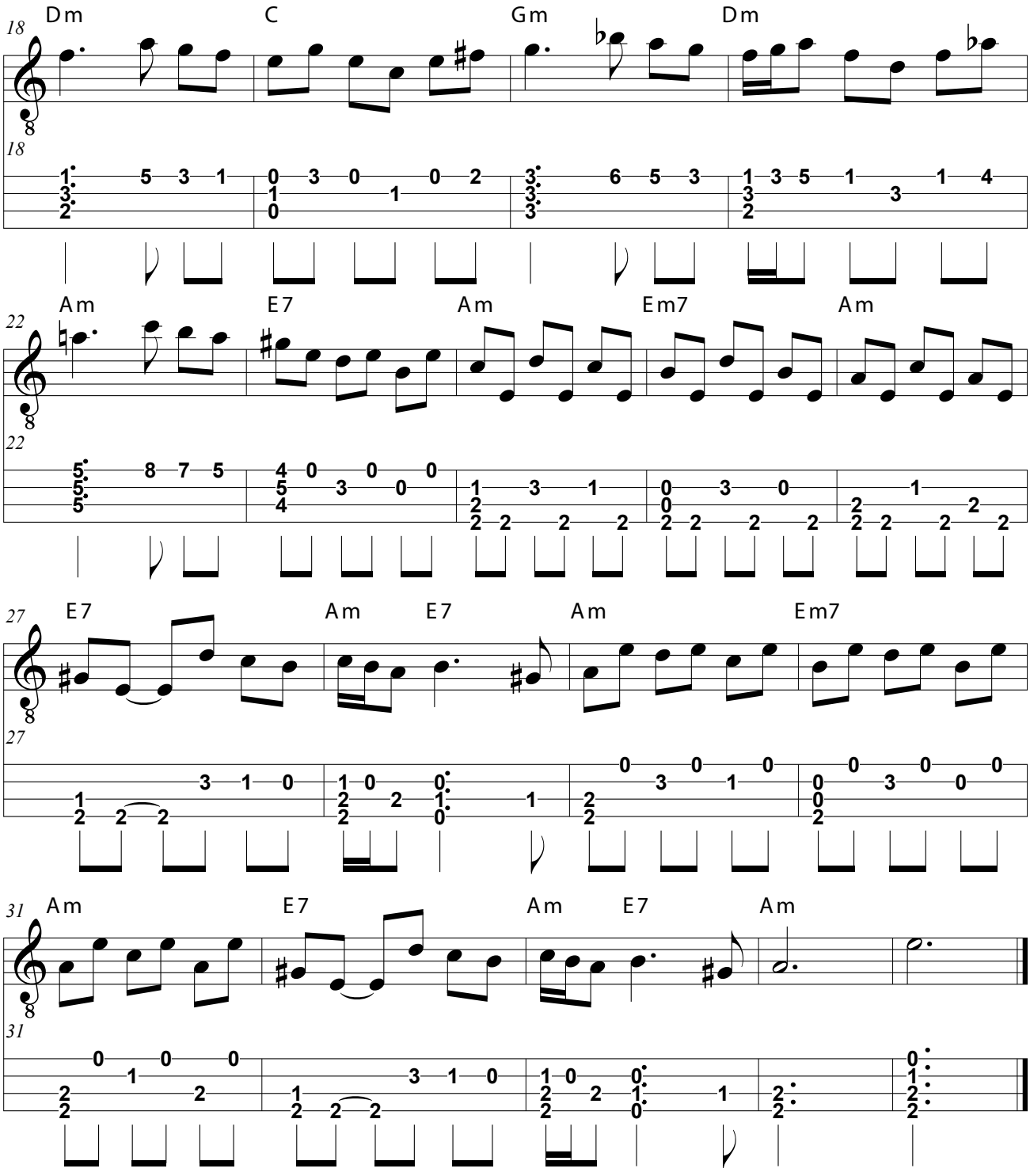
Corrente

Arcangelo Corelli (1653–1713)



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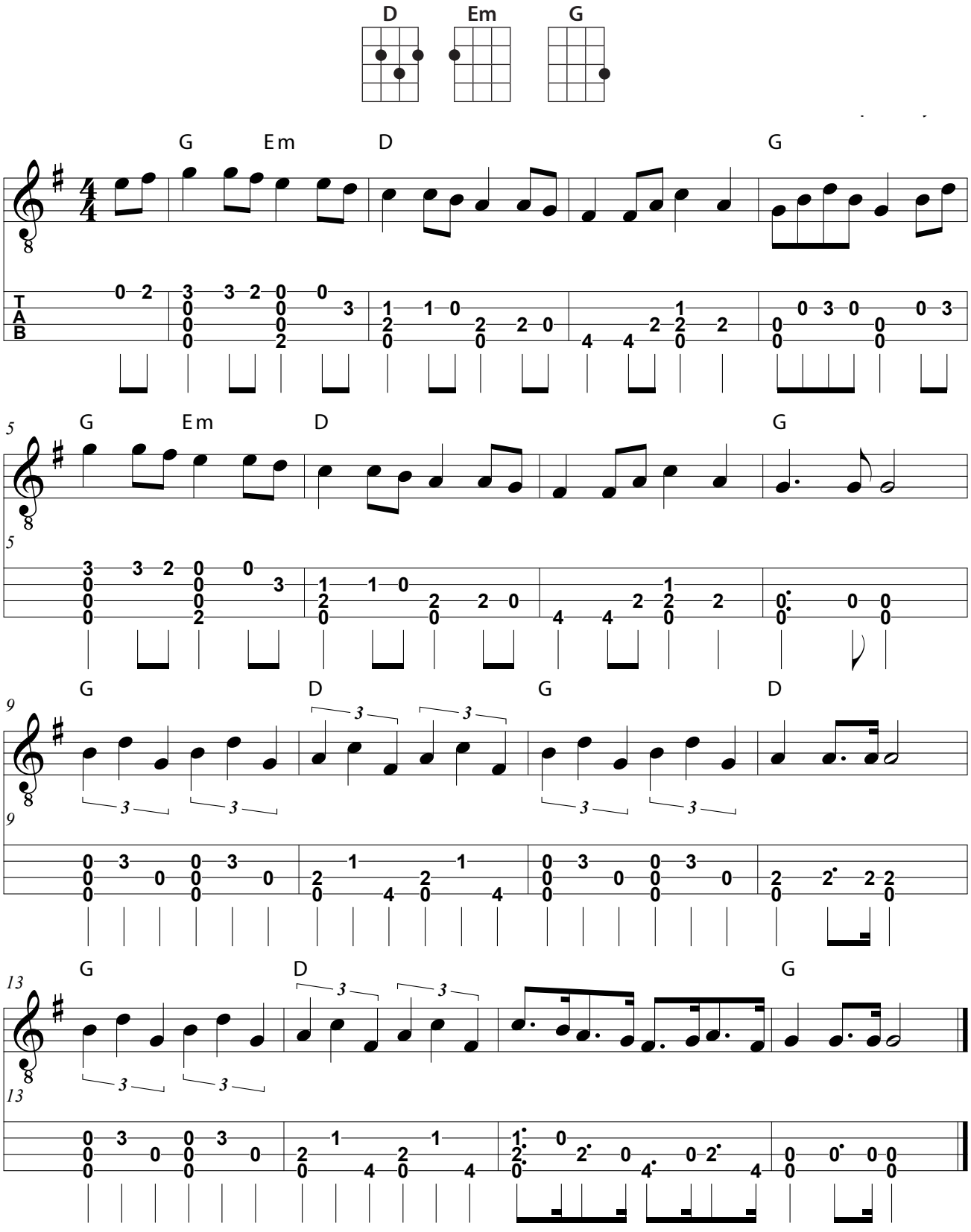
Corrente



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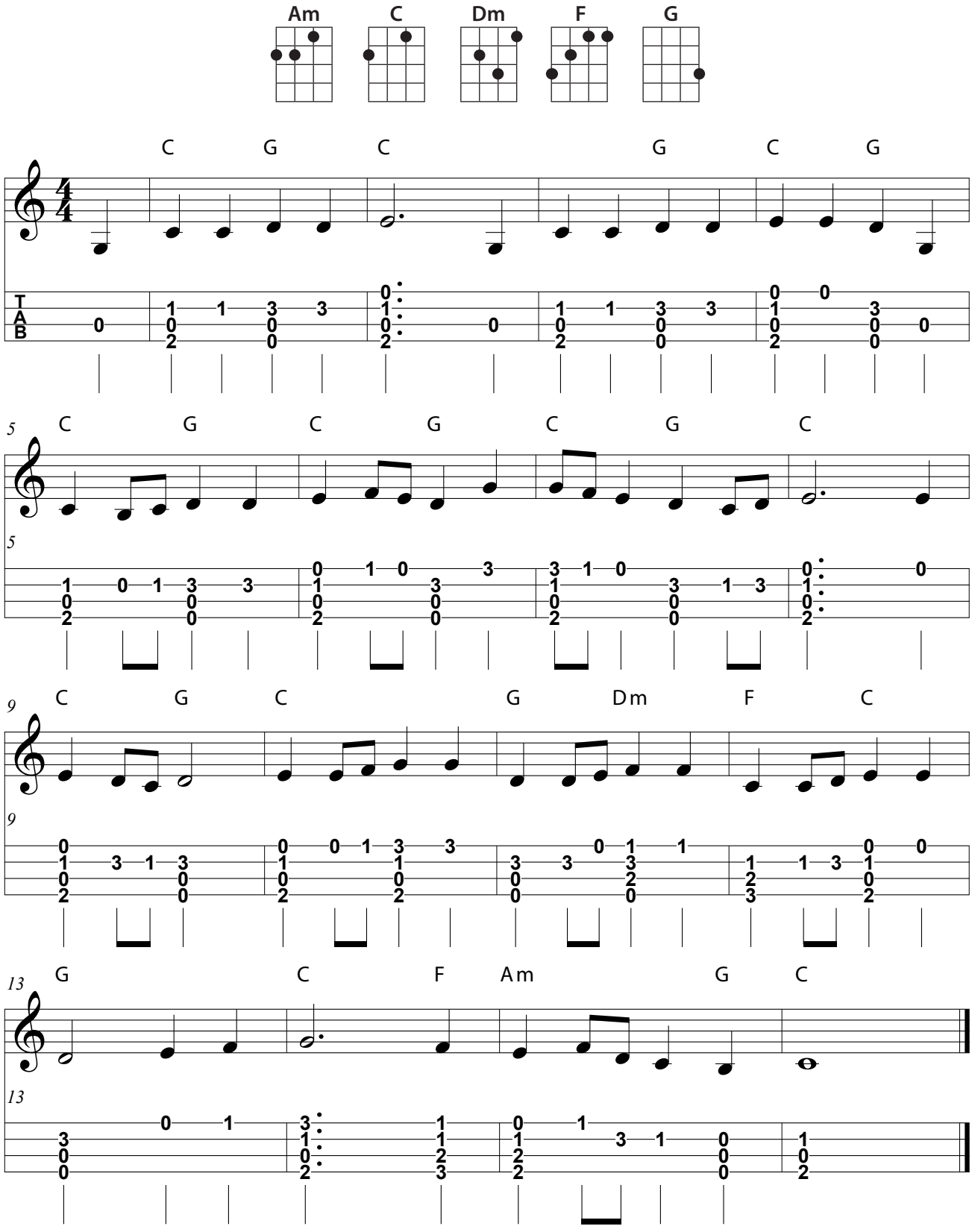
Franz Joseph Haydn (1732–1809)



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Dear Nightingale
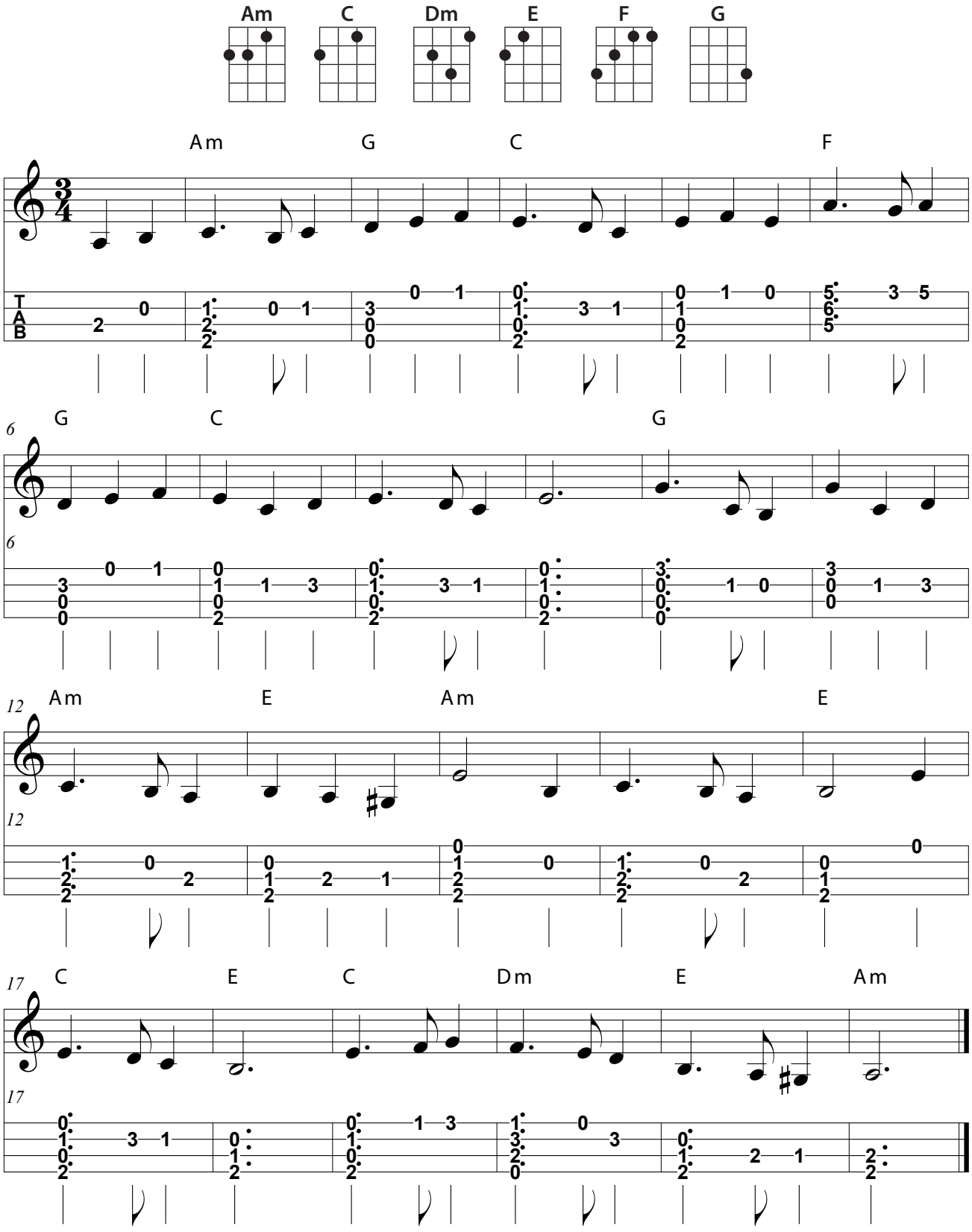
Benno Kaiser (Baroque)



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Española
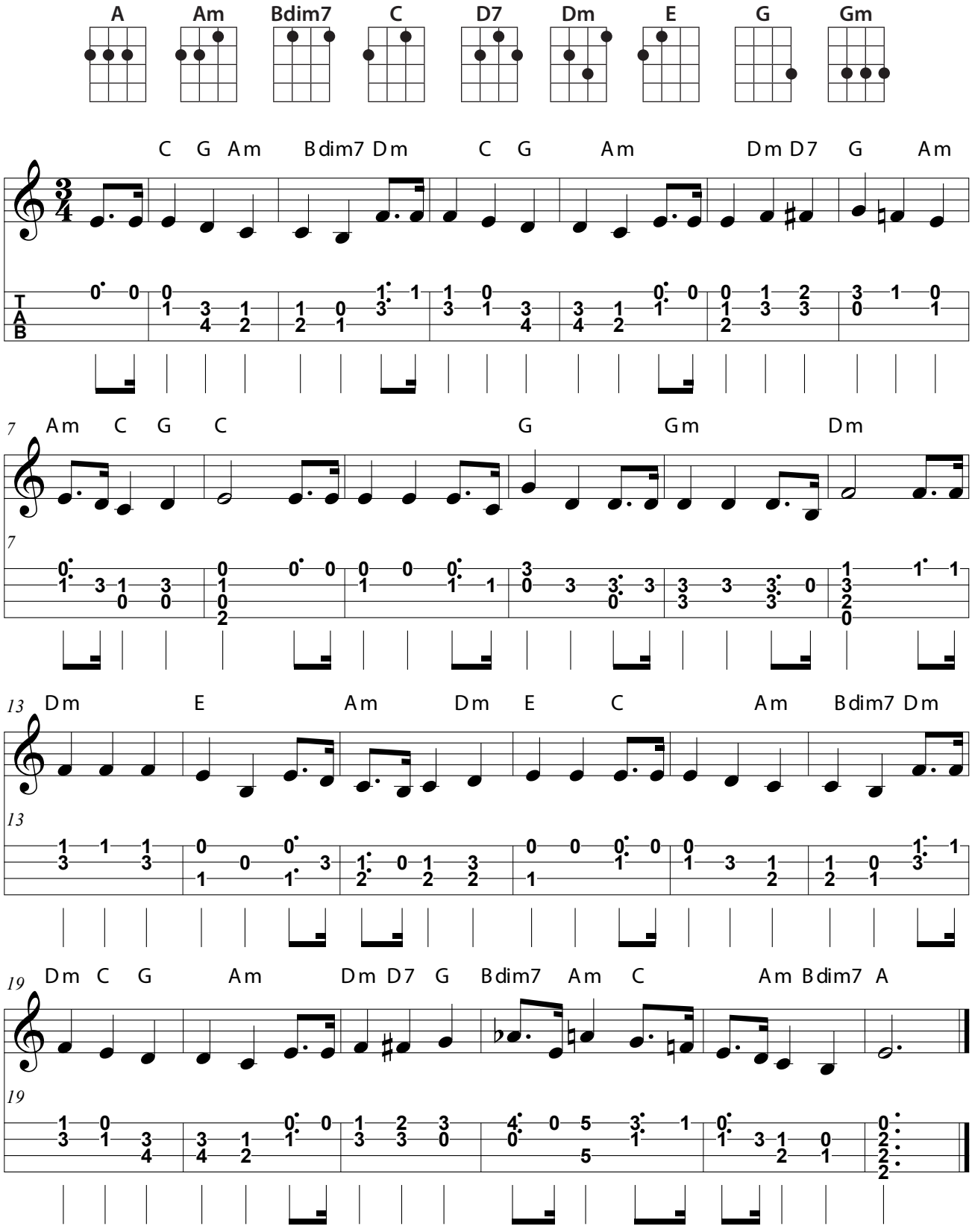
Gaspar Sanz (1640–1710)



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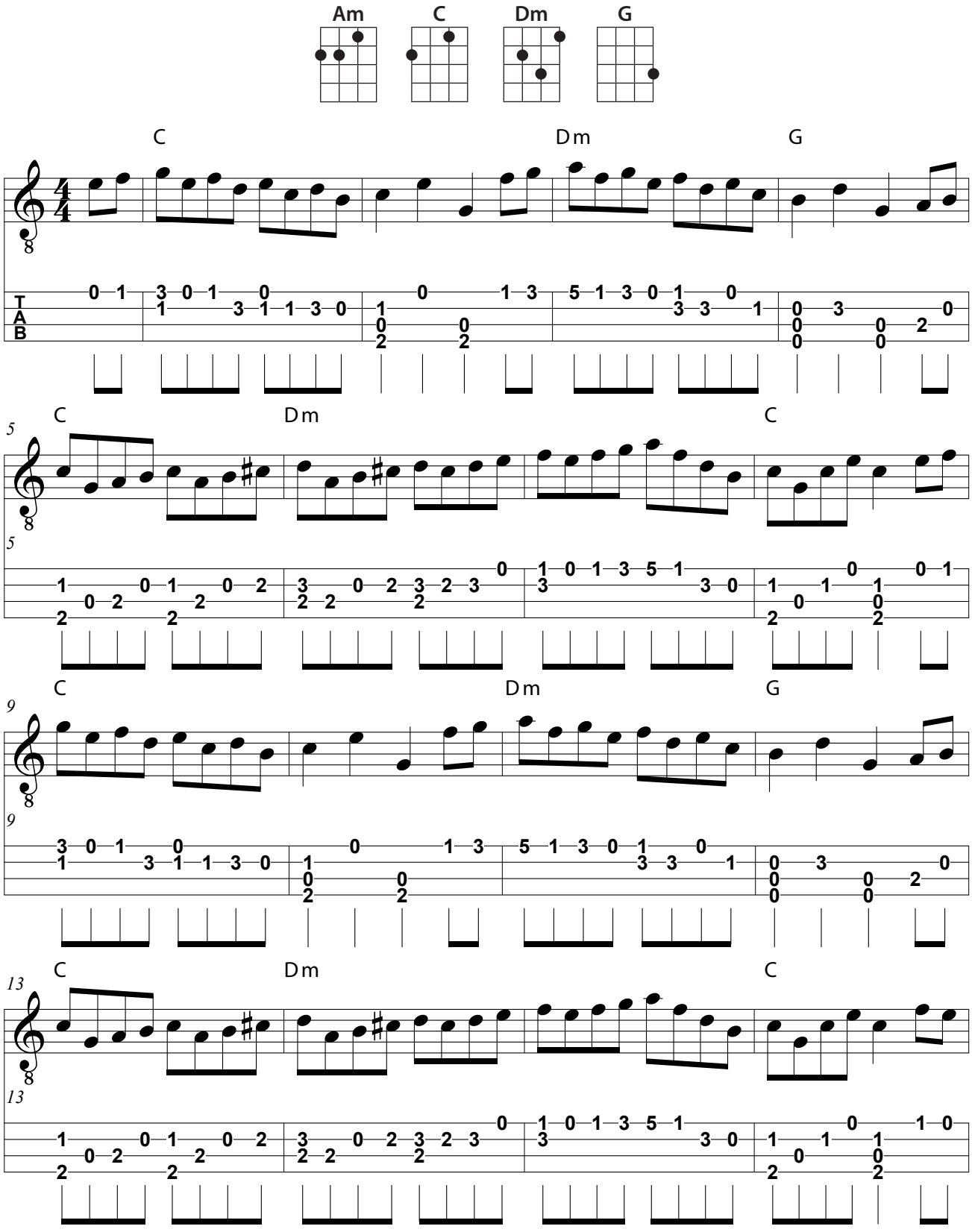
Fernando Sor (1778–1839)



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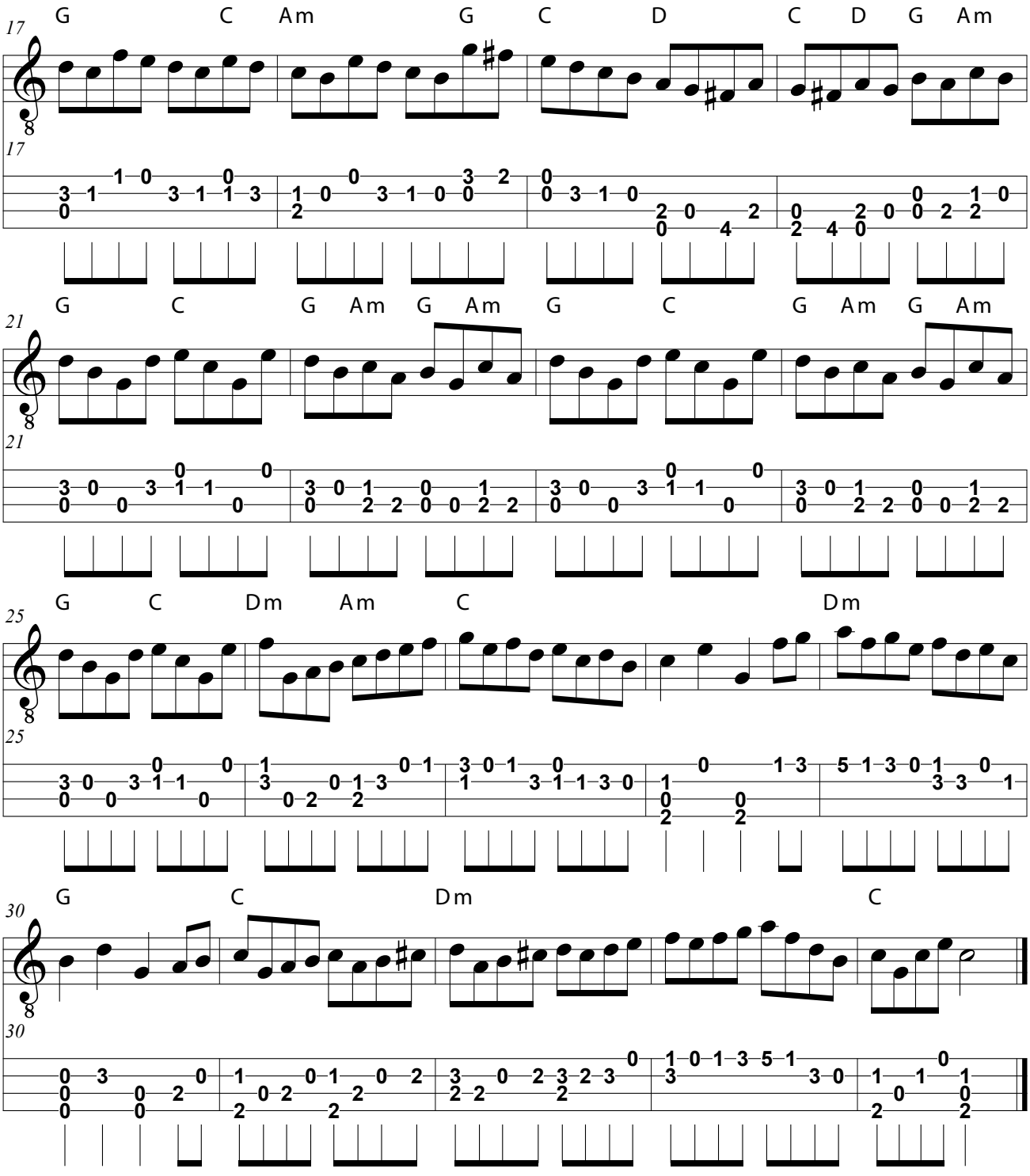
Gypsy Rondo

Franz Joseph Haydn (1732–1809)



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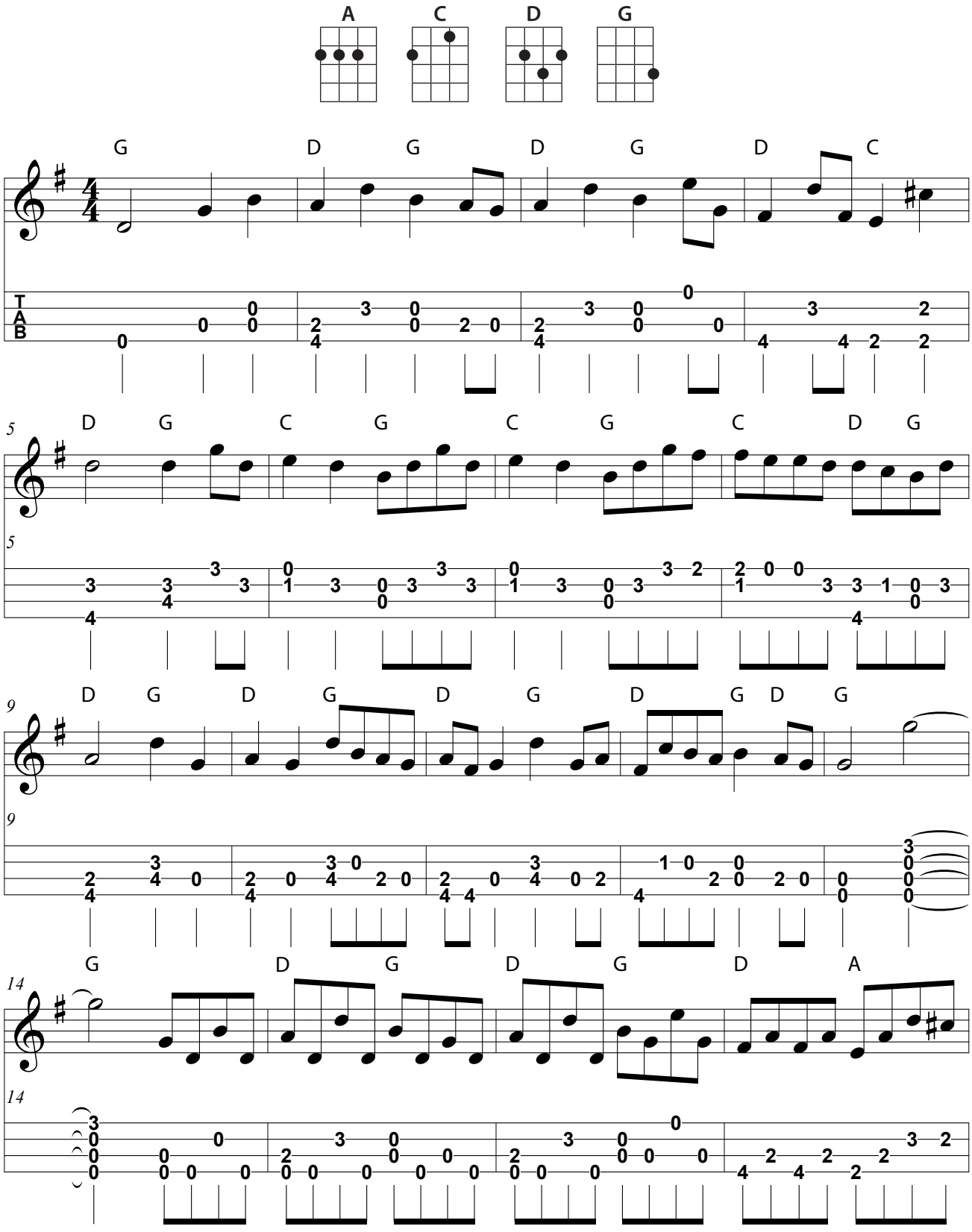
Gypsy Rondo



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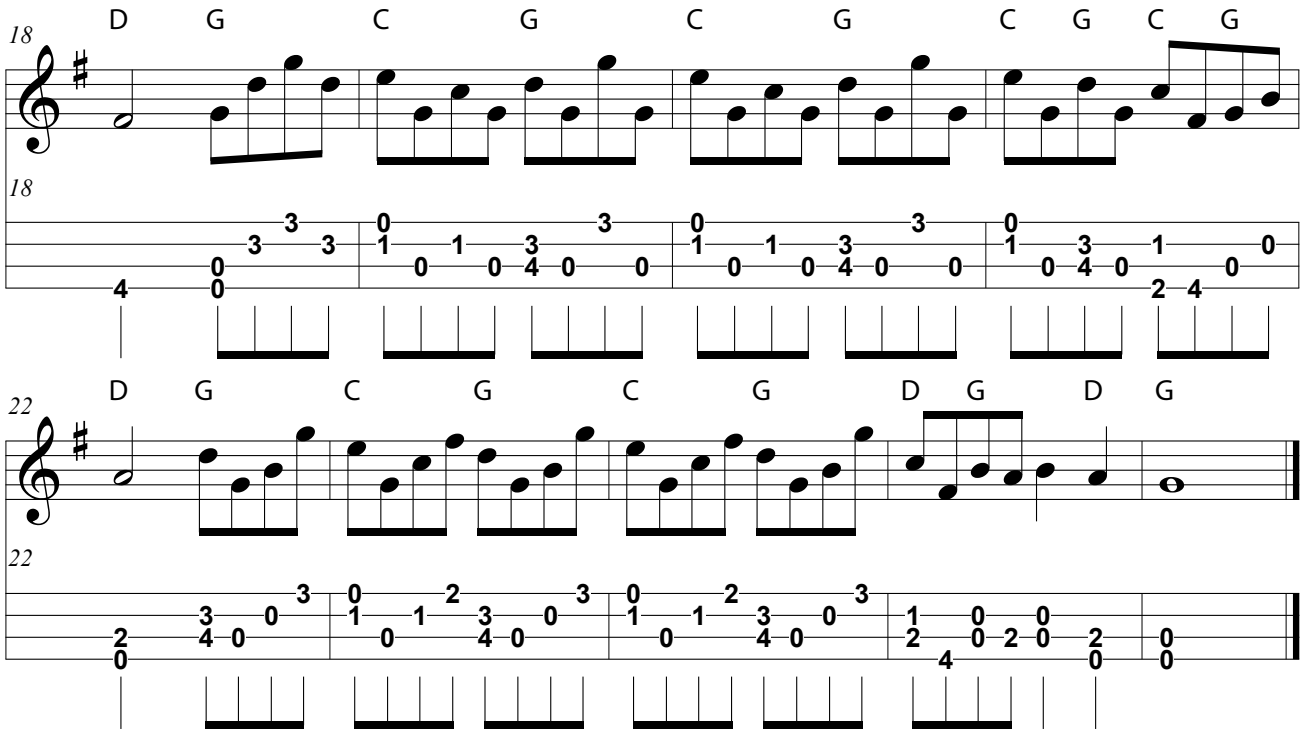
The Harmonious Blacksmith

George Frederick Handel (1685–1759)



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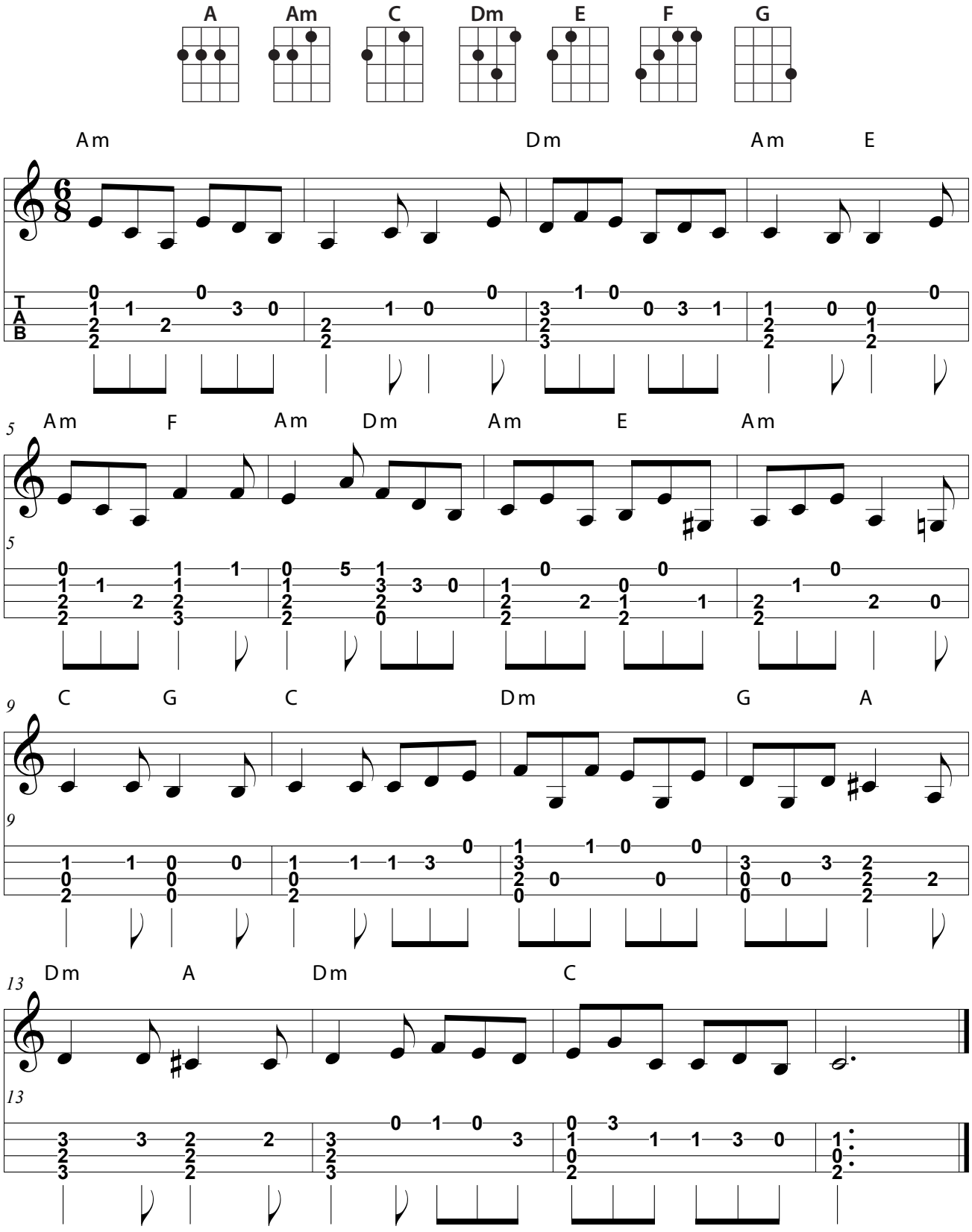
The Harmonious Blacksmith



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Larghetto Espressivo
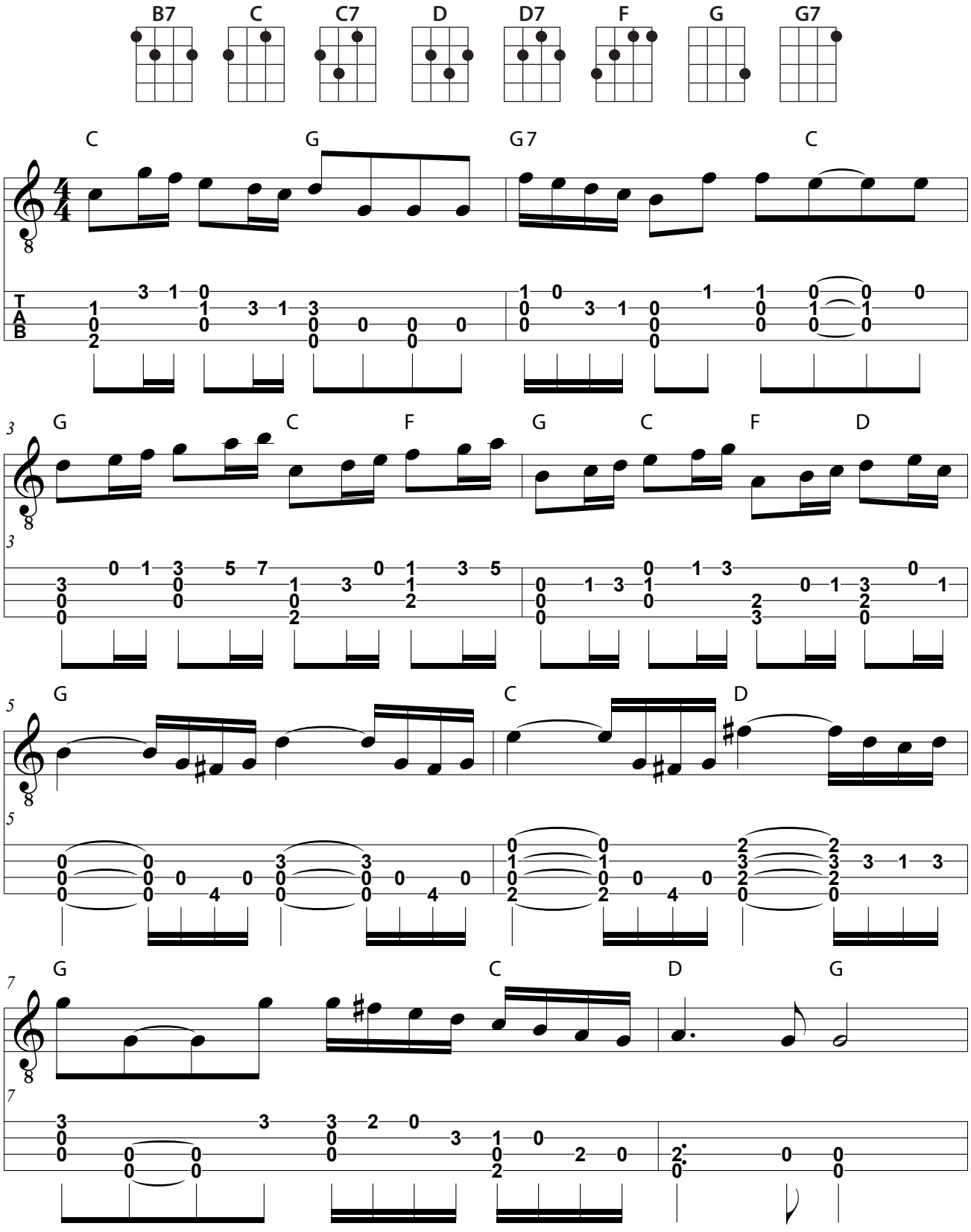
Ferdinando Carulli (1770–1841)



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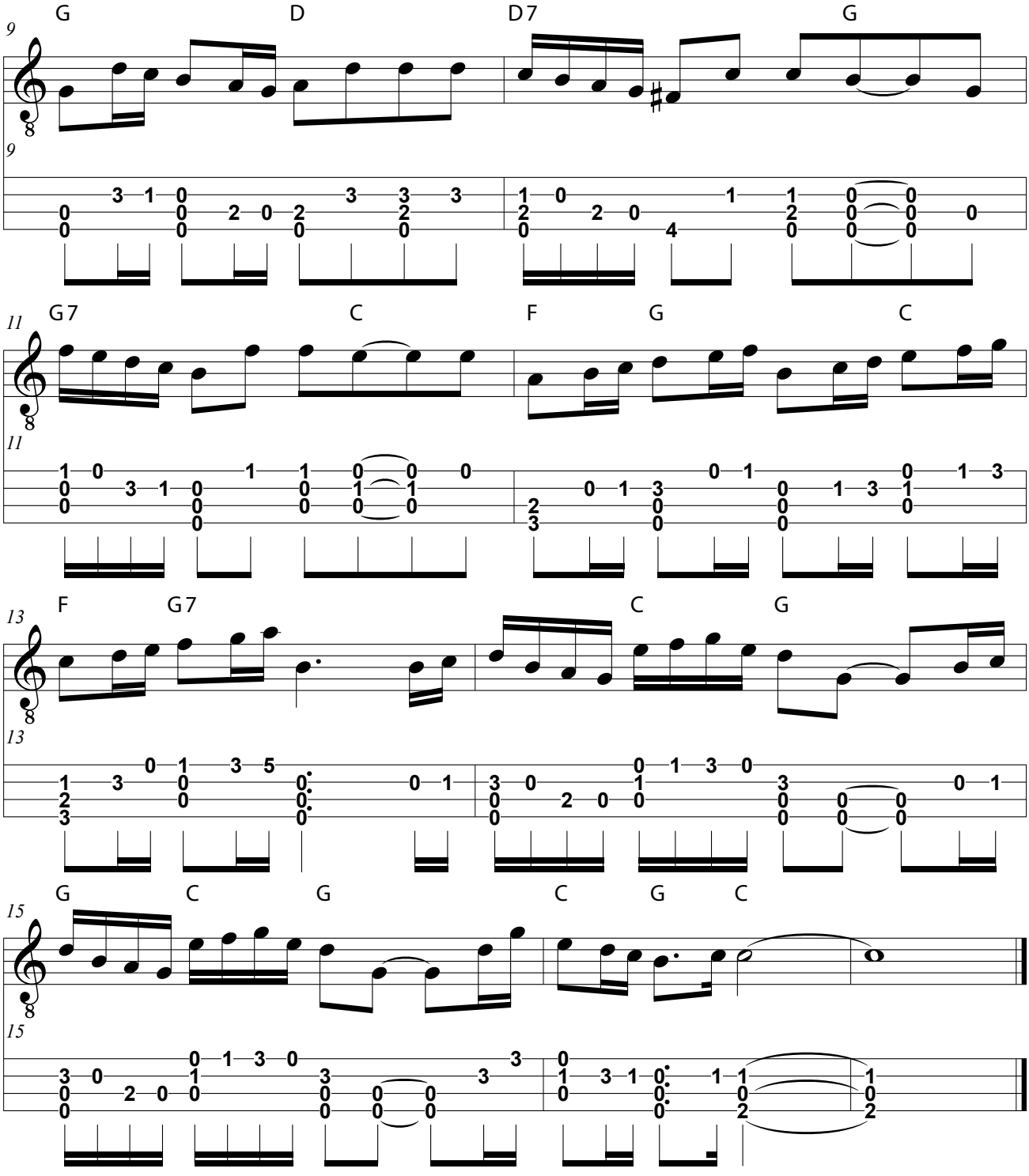
Largo from the Four Seasons

Antonio Vivaldi (1678–1741)



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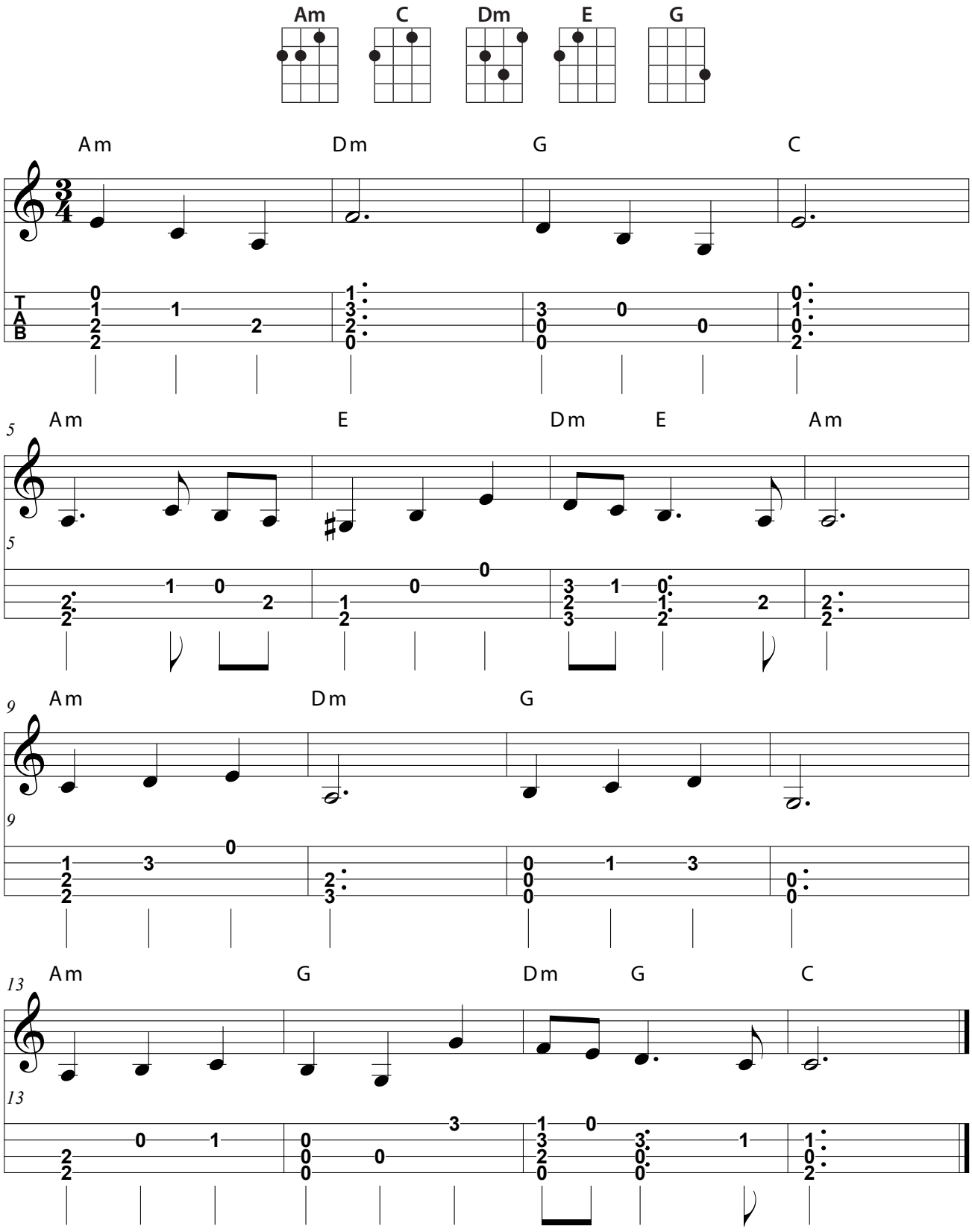
Largo from the Four Seasons



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Minuet in A Minor
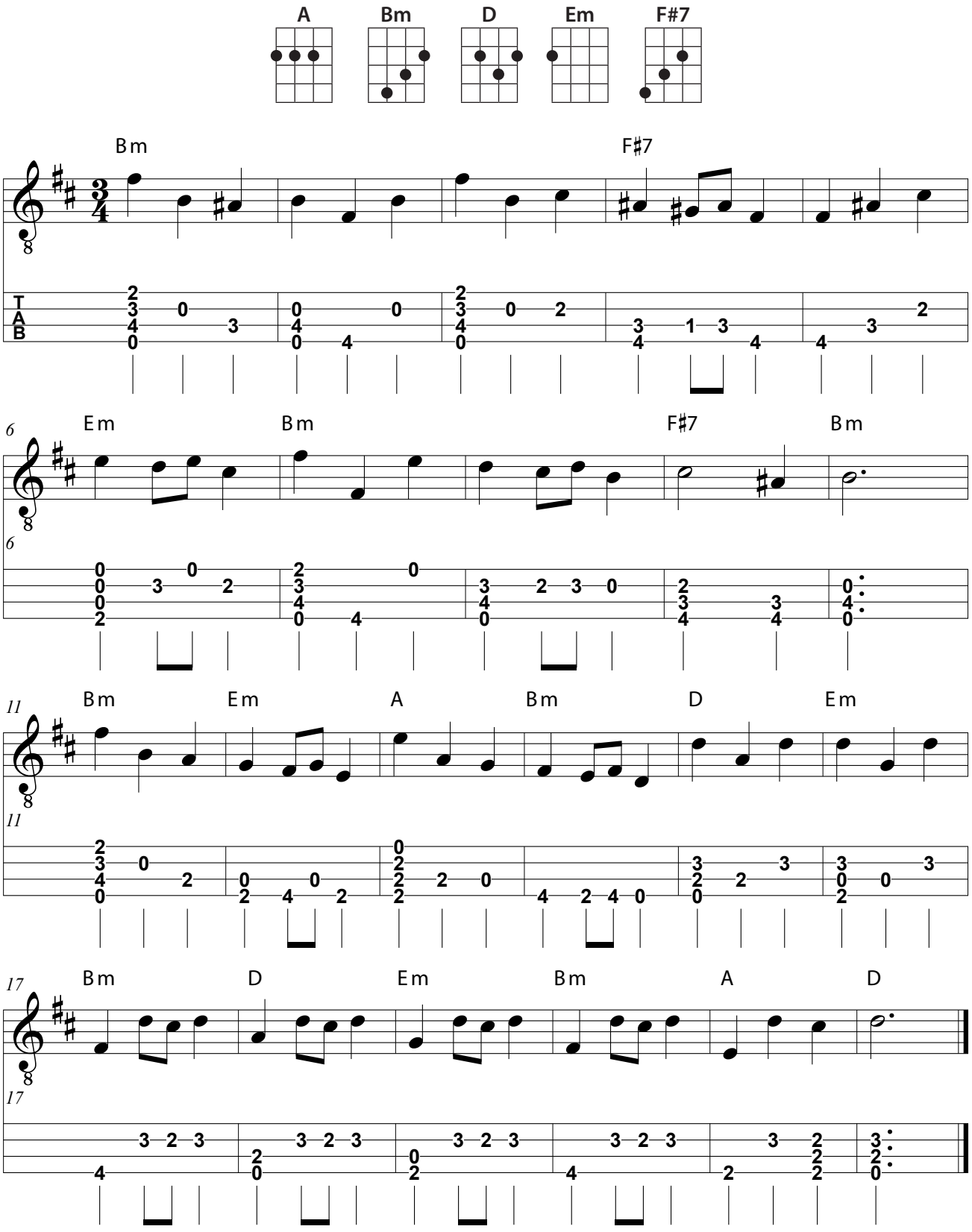
Johann Krieger (1651–1735)



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Minuet in B Minor
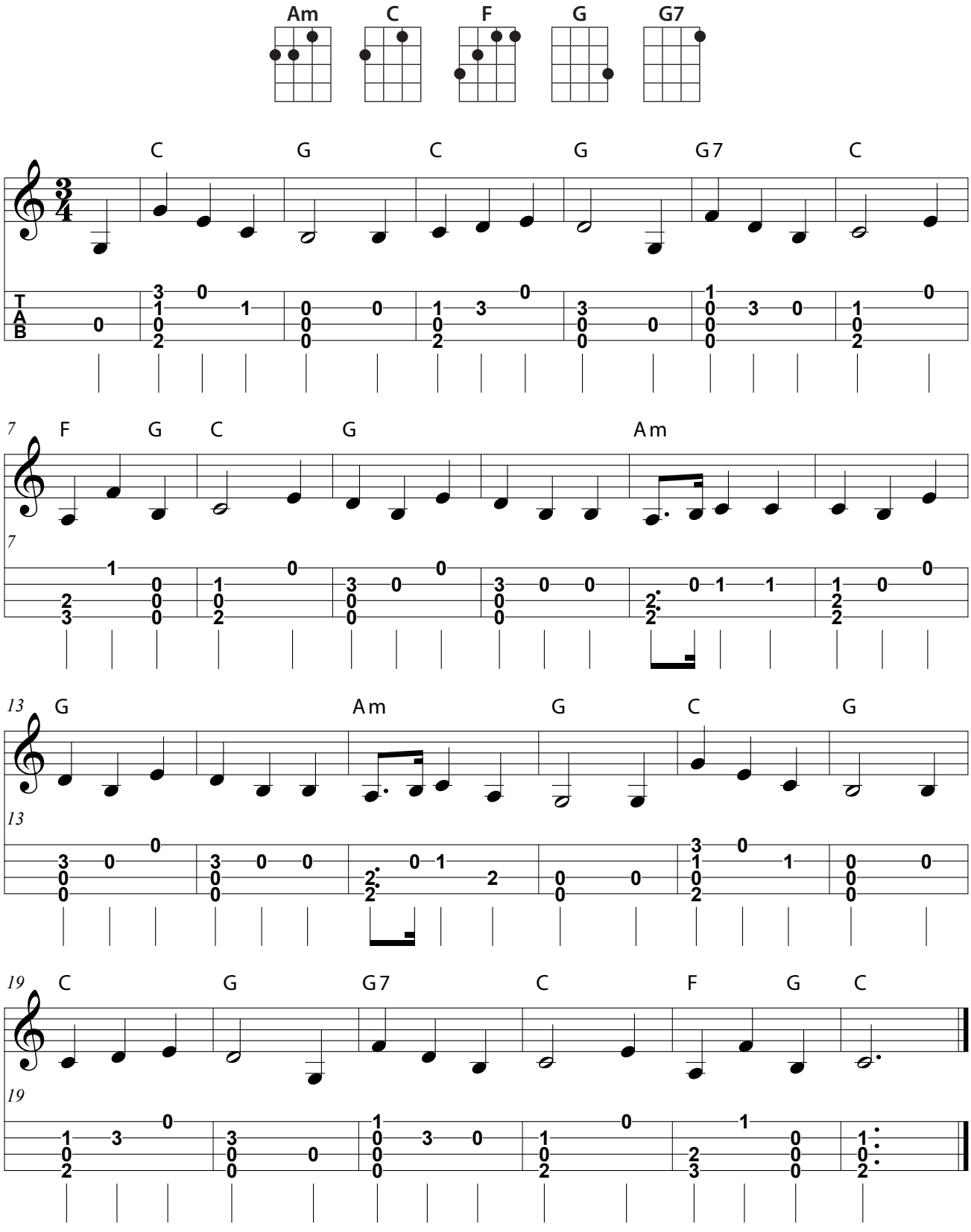
Silvius Leopold Weiss (1868–1750)



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Minuet in C
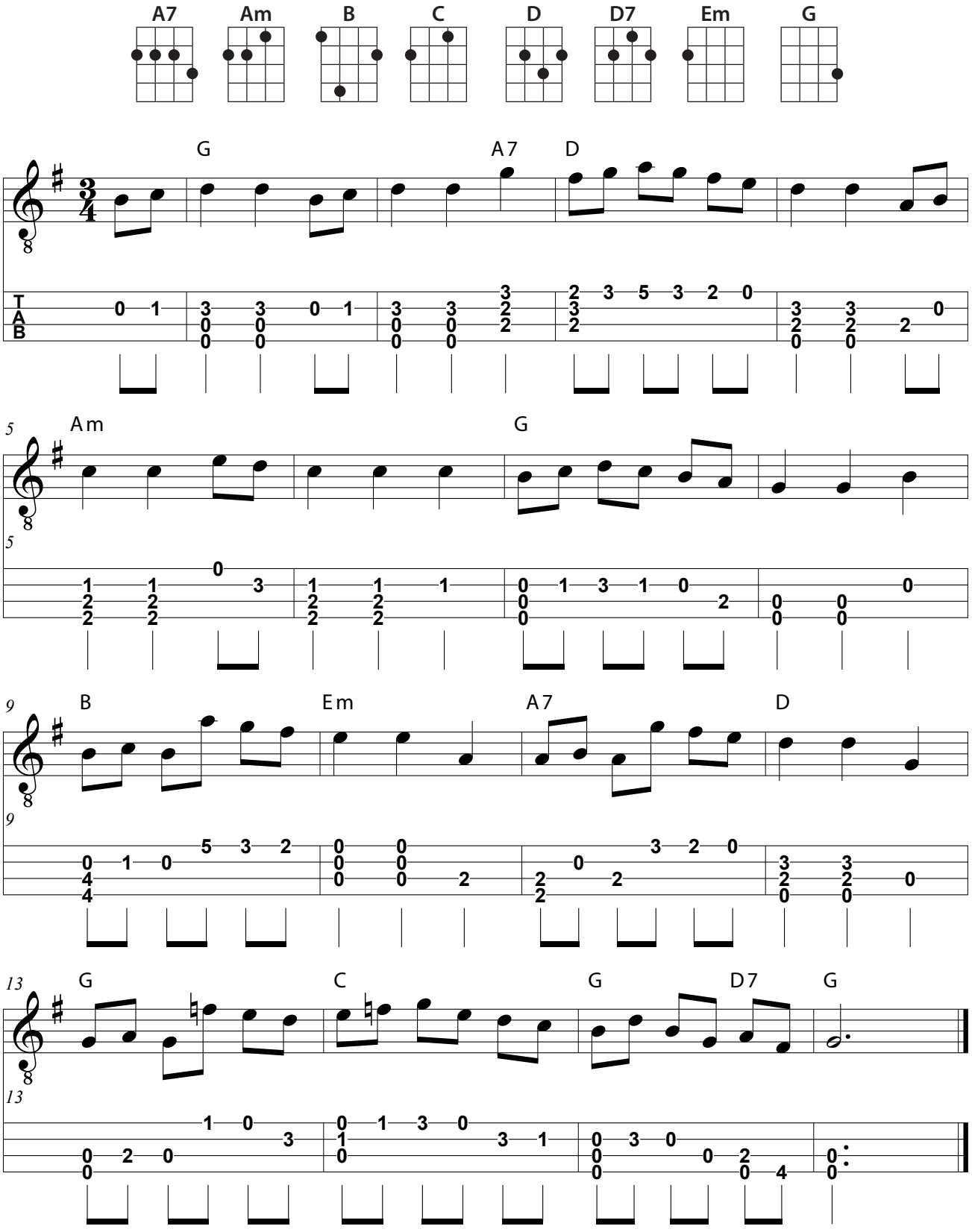
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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New German Dance No. 4
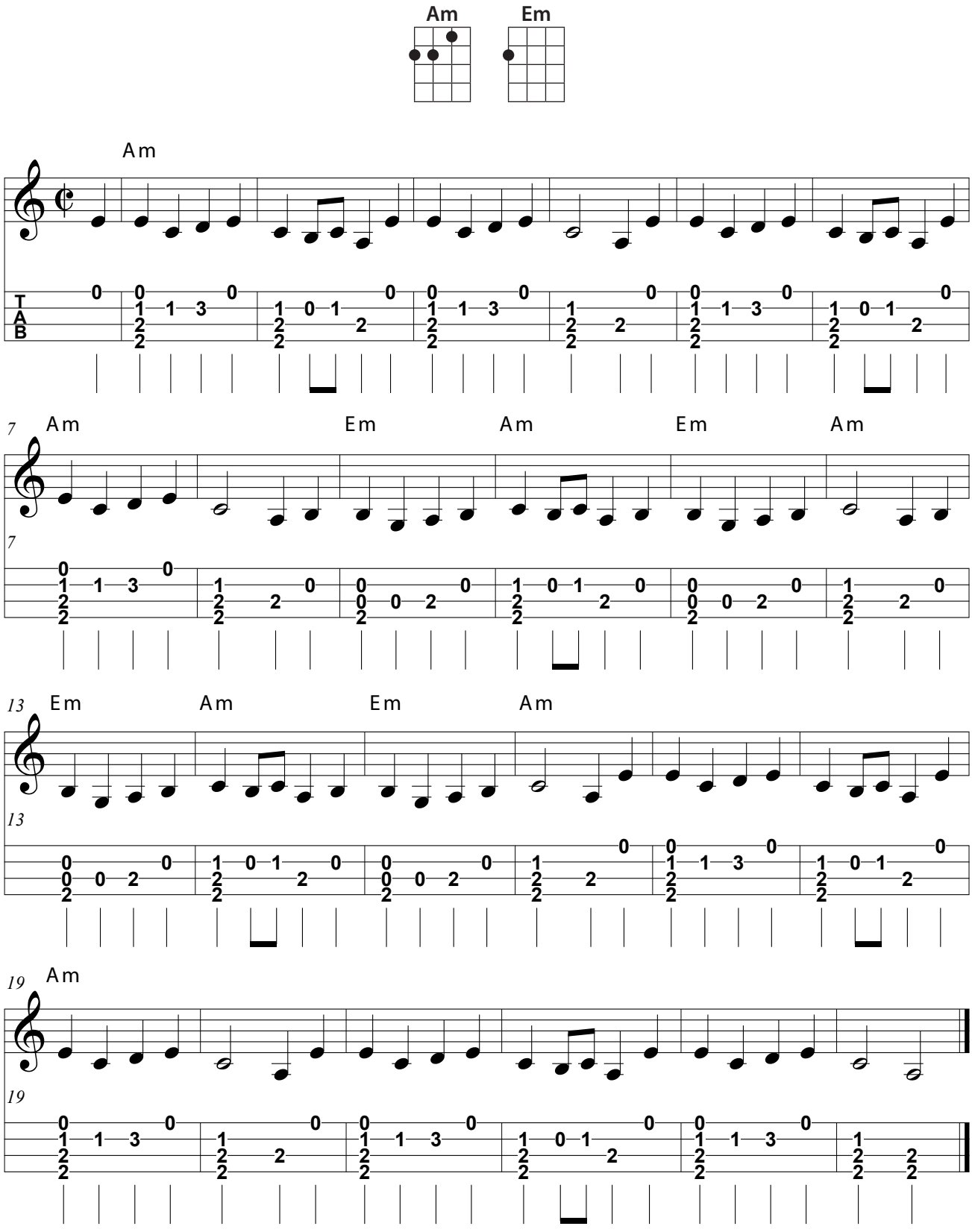
Franz Joseph Haydn (1732–1809)



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Nonesuch
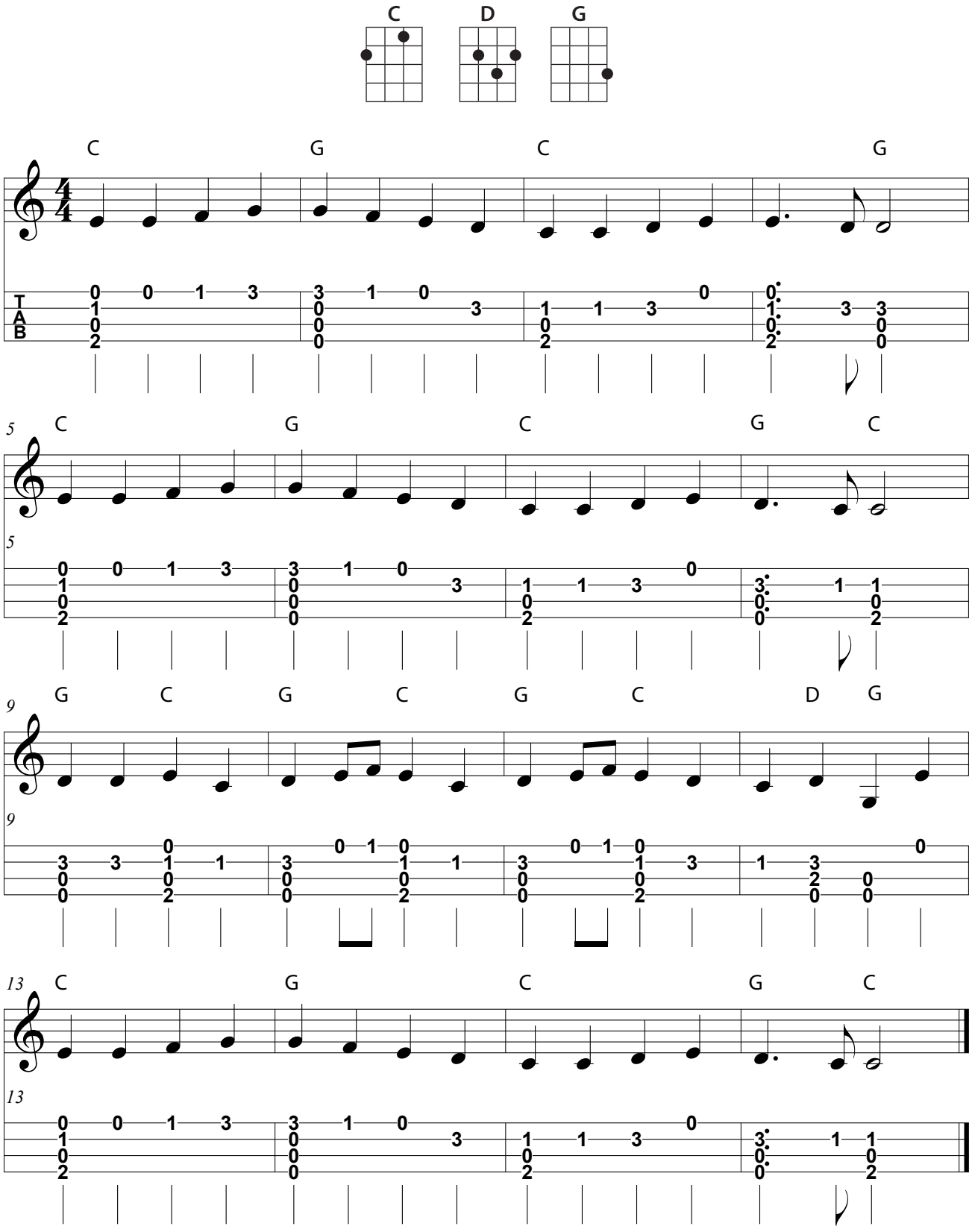
Anonymous (Renaissance)



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Ode to Joy

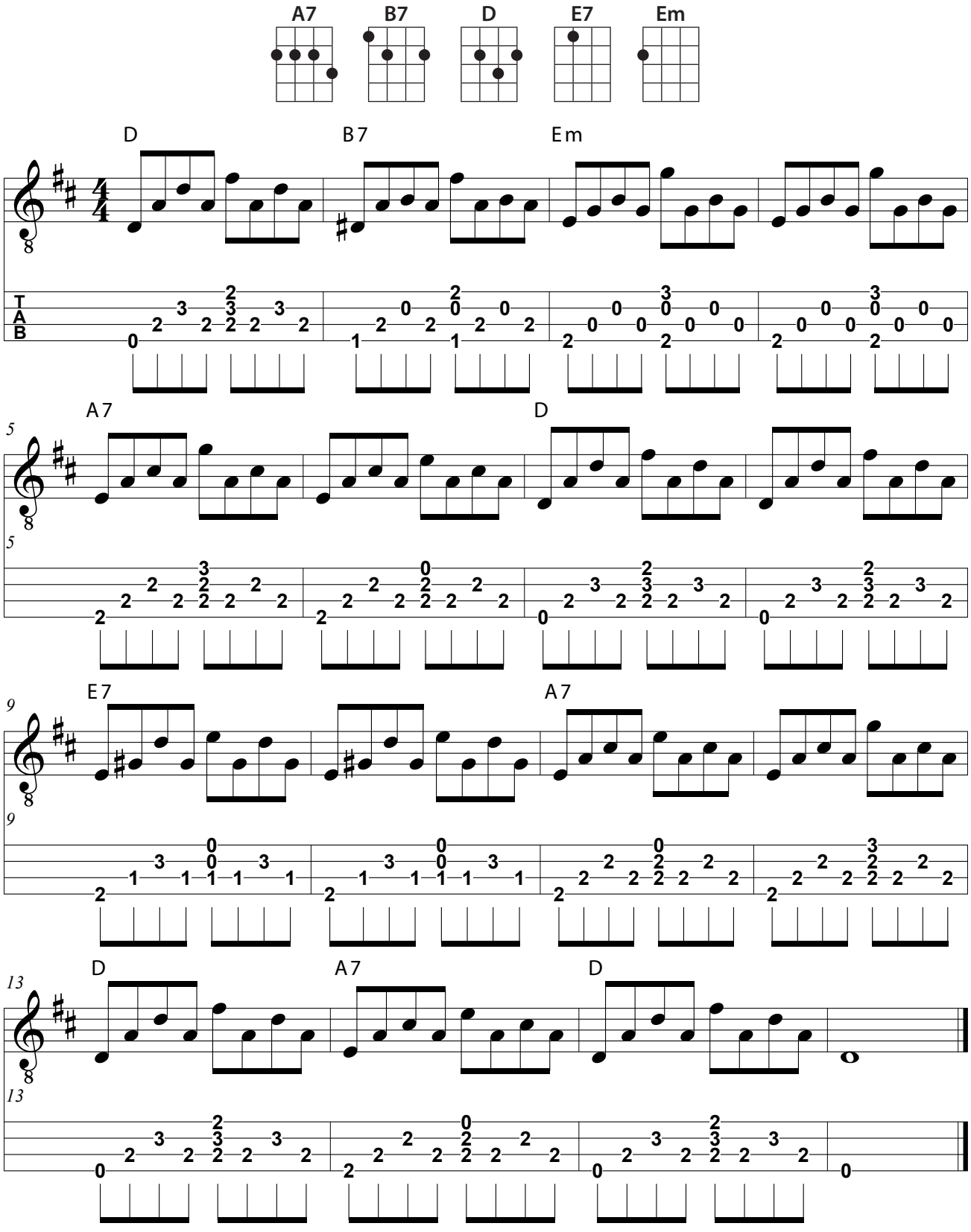
Ludwig van Beethoven (1770–1827)



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Prelude in D
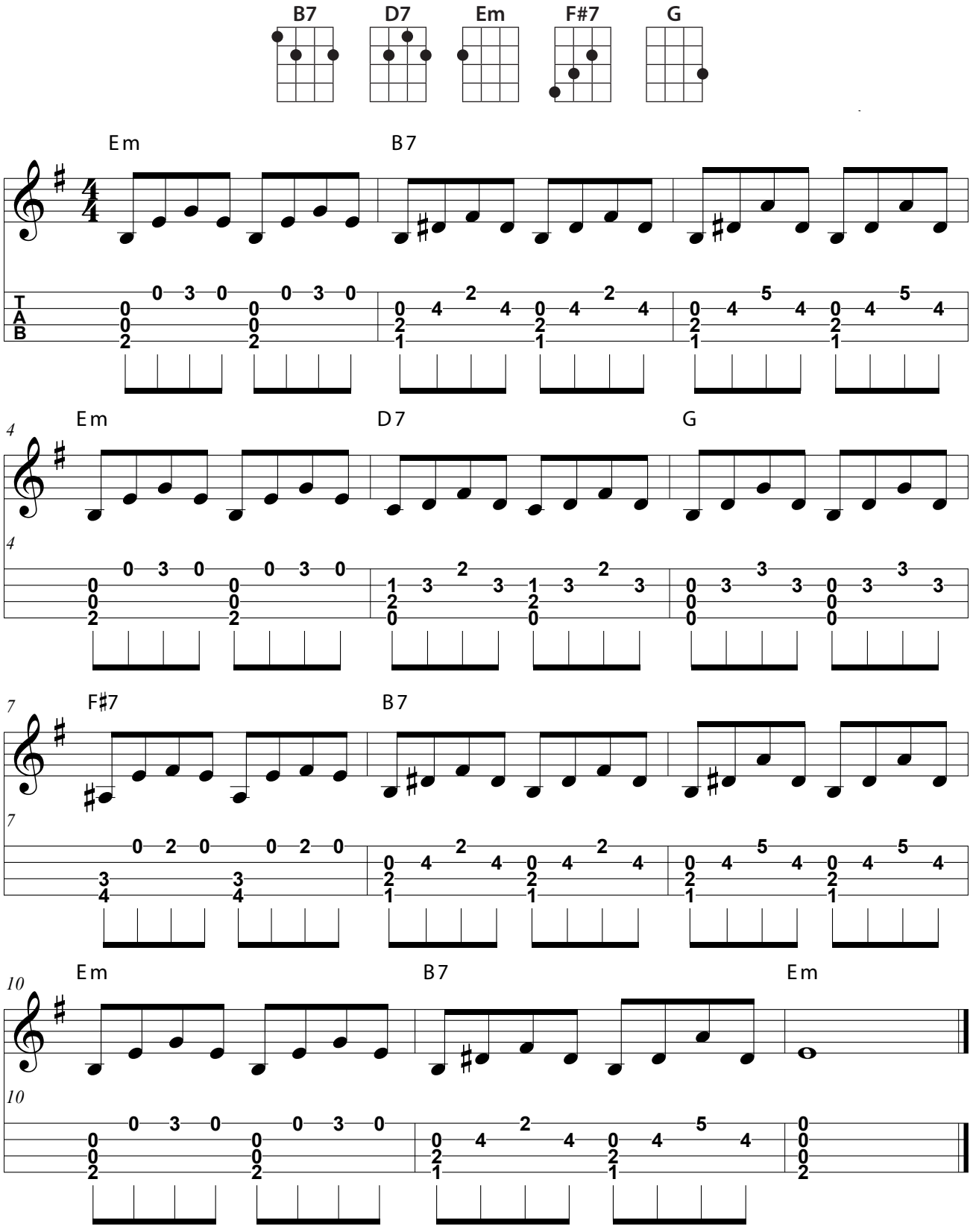
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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Prelude in E Minor
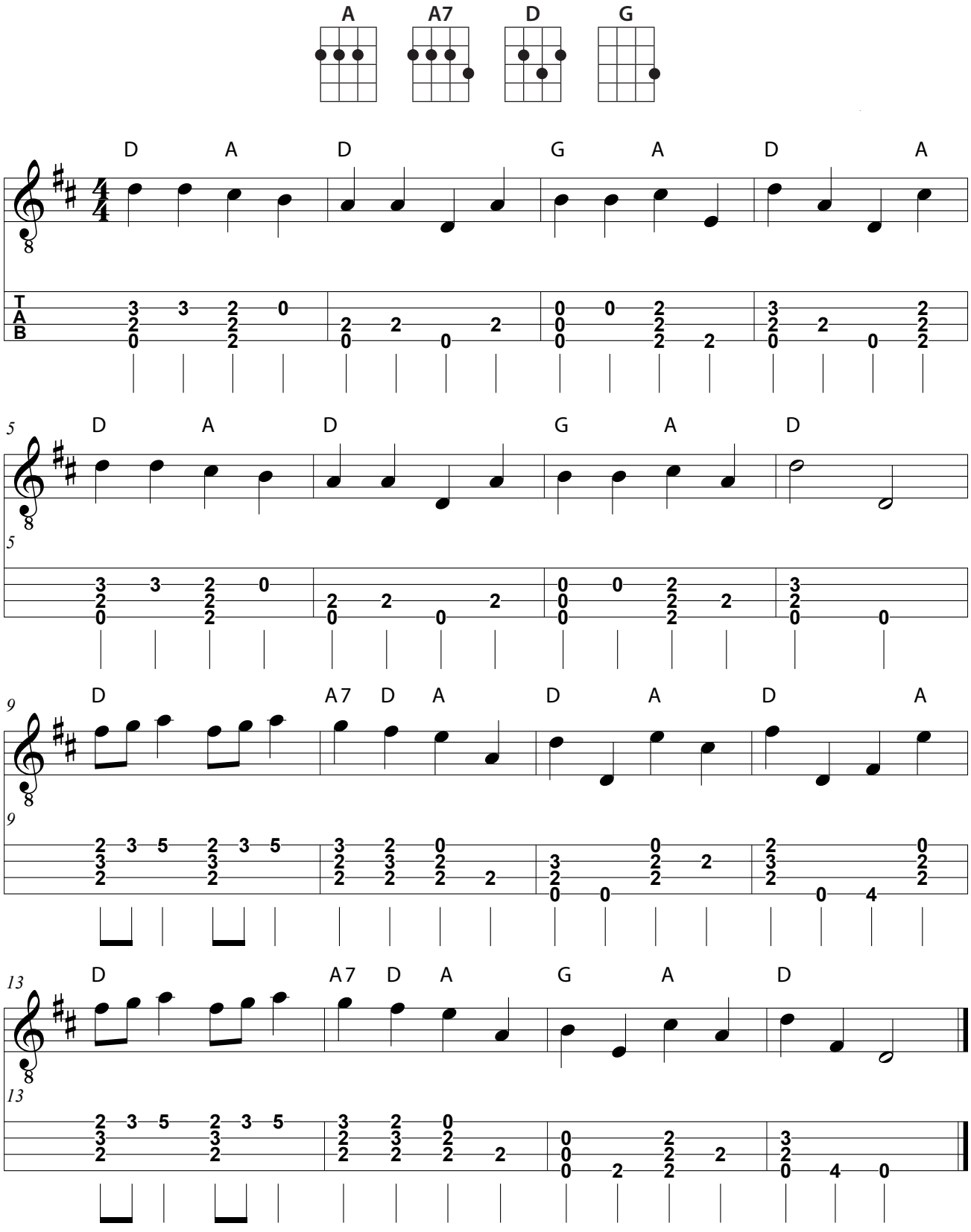
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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Rigadoon
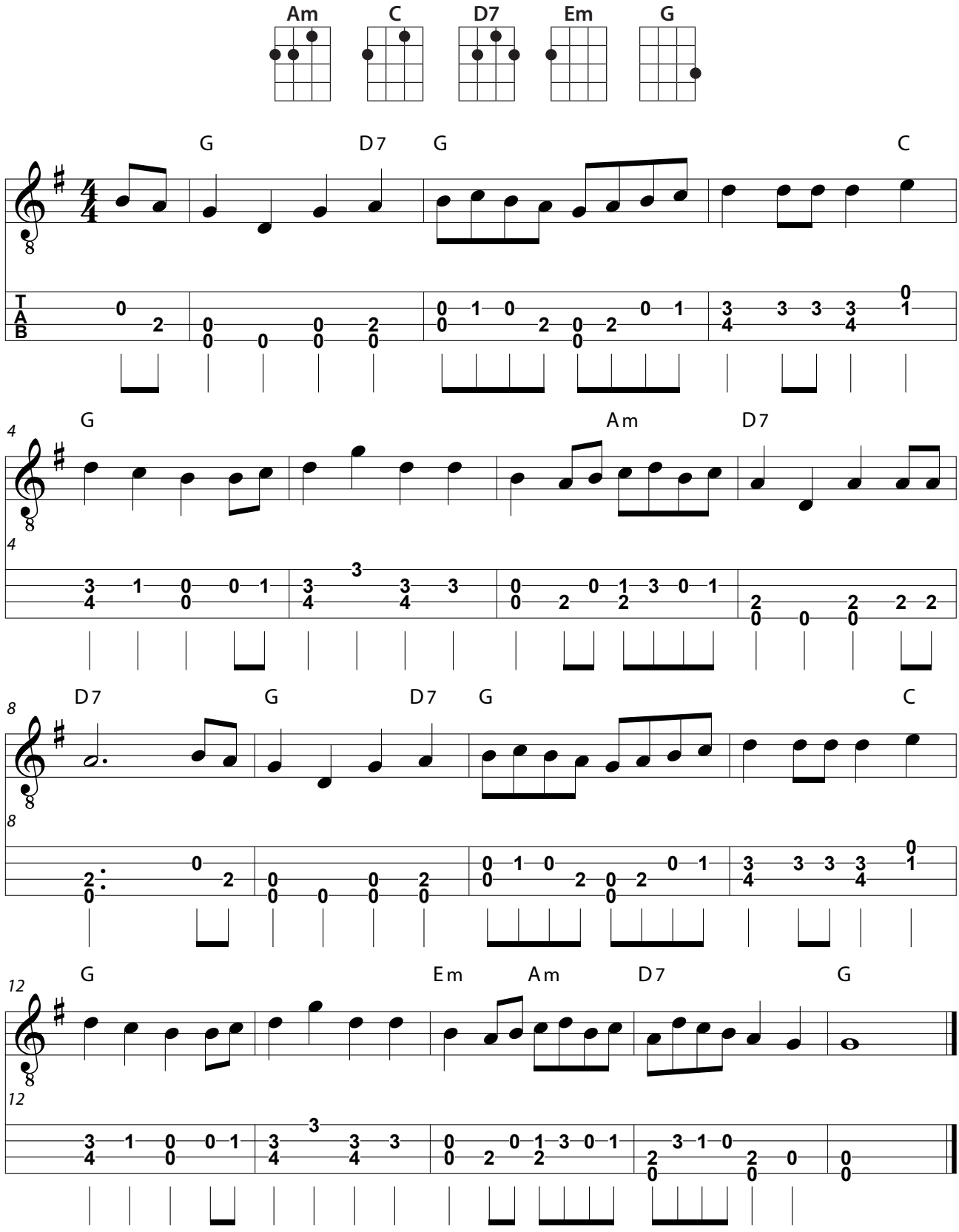
Henry Purcell (c.1659–1695)



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Rondeau
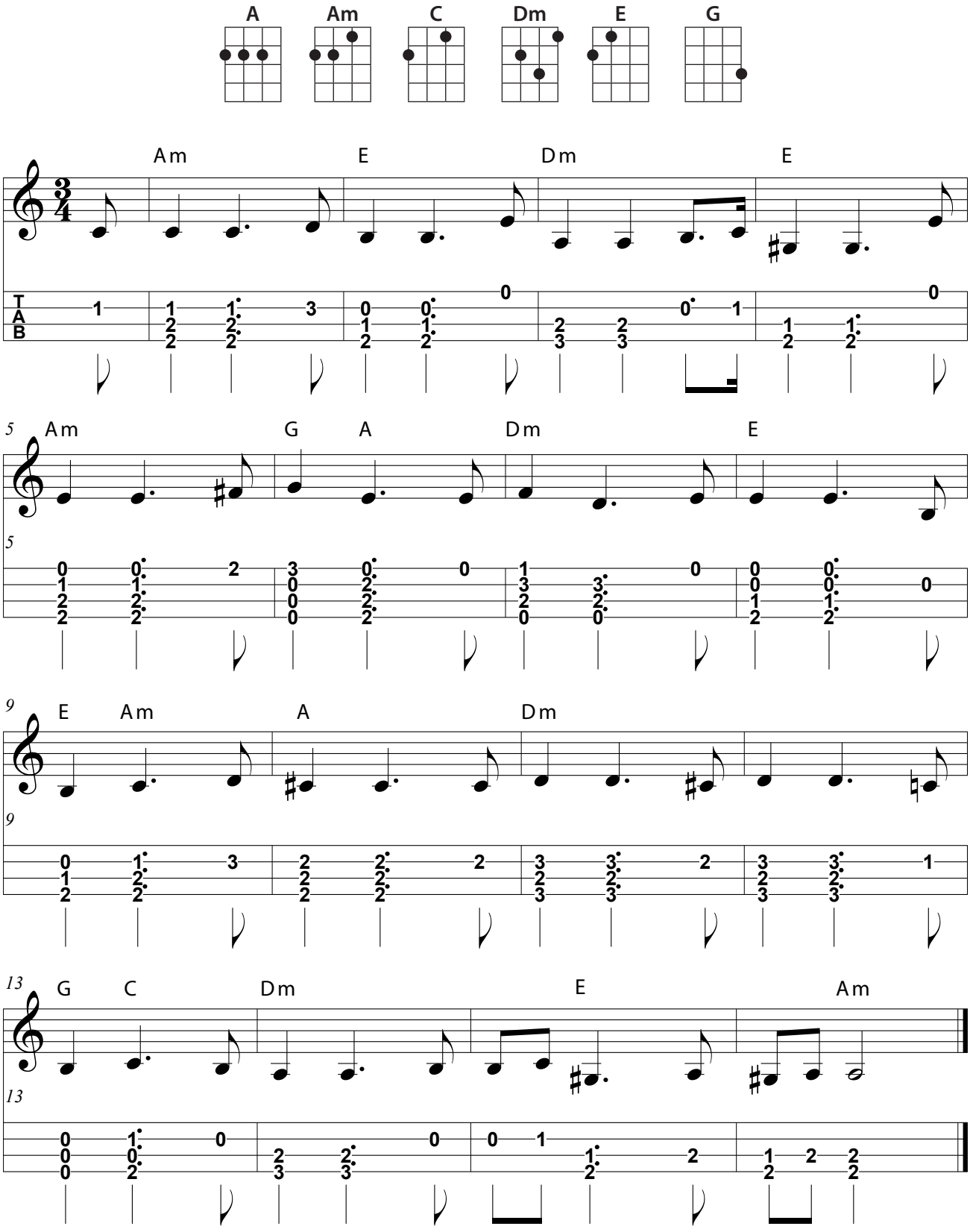
Jean-Joseph Mouret (1682–1738)



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Sarabande
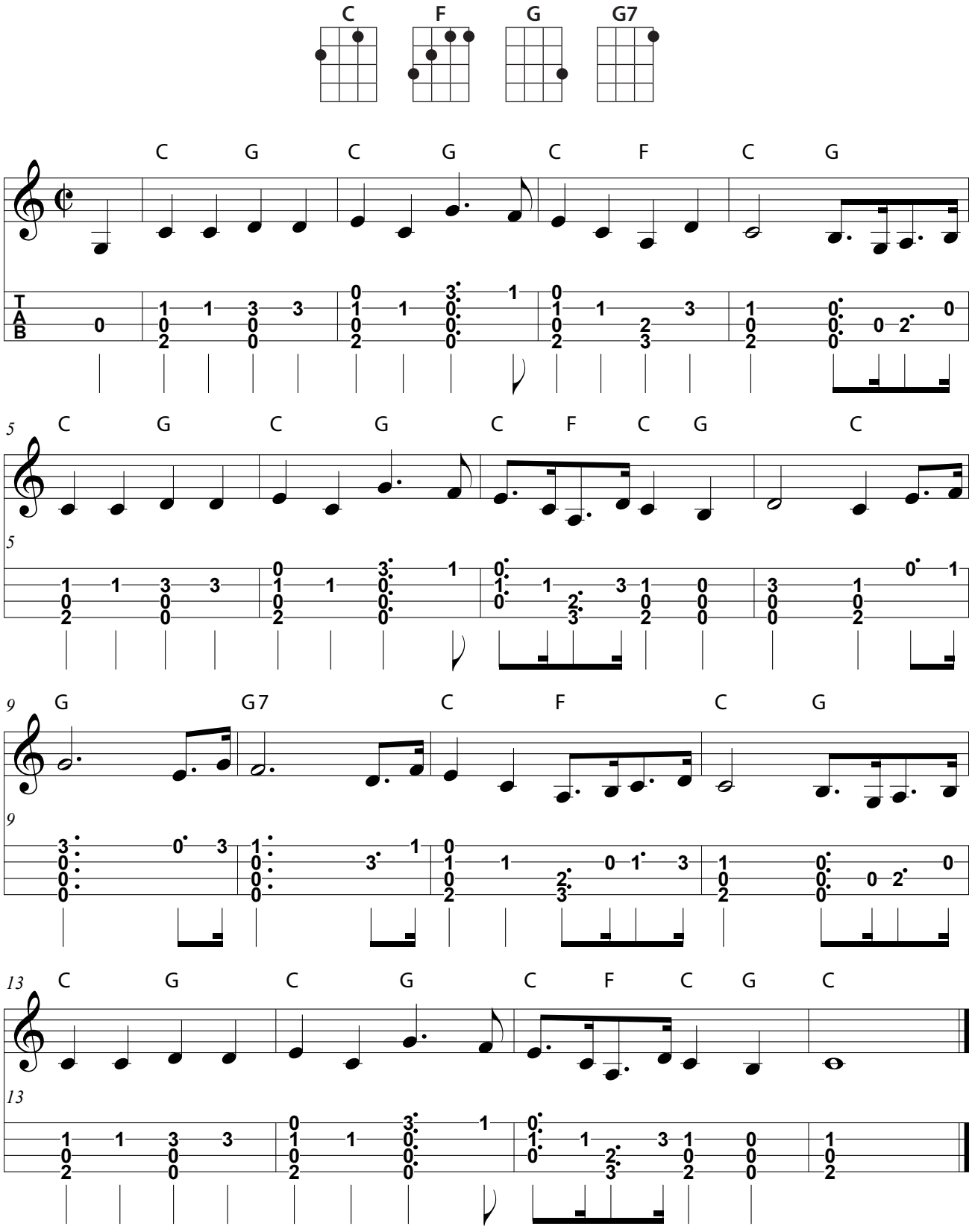
Robert de Visée (1652–1730)



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Sonatine op. 71
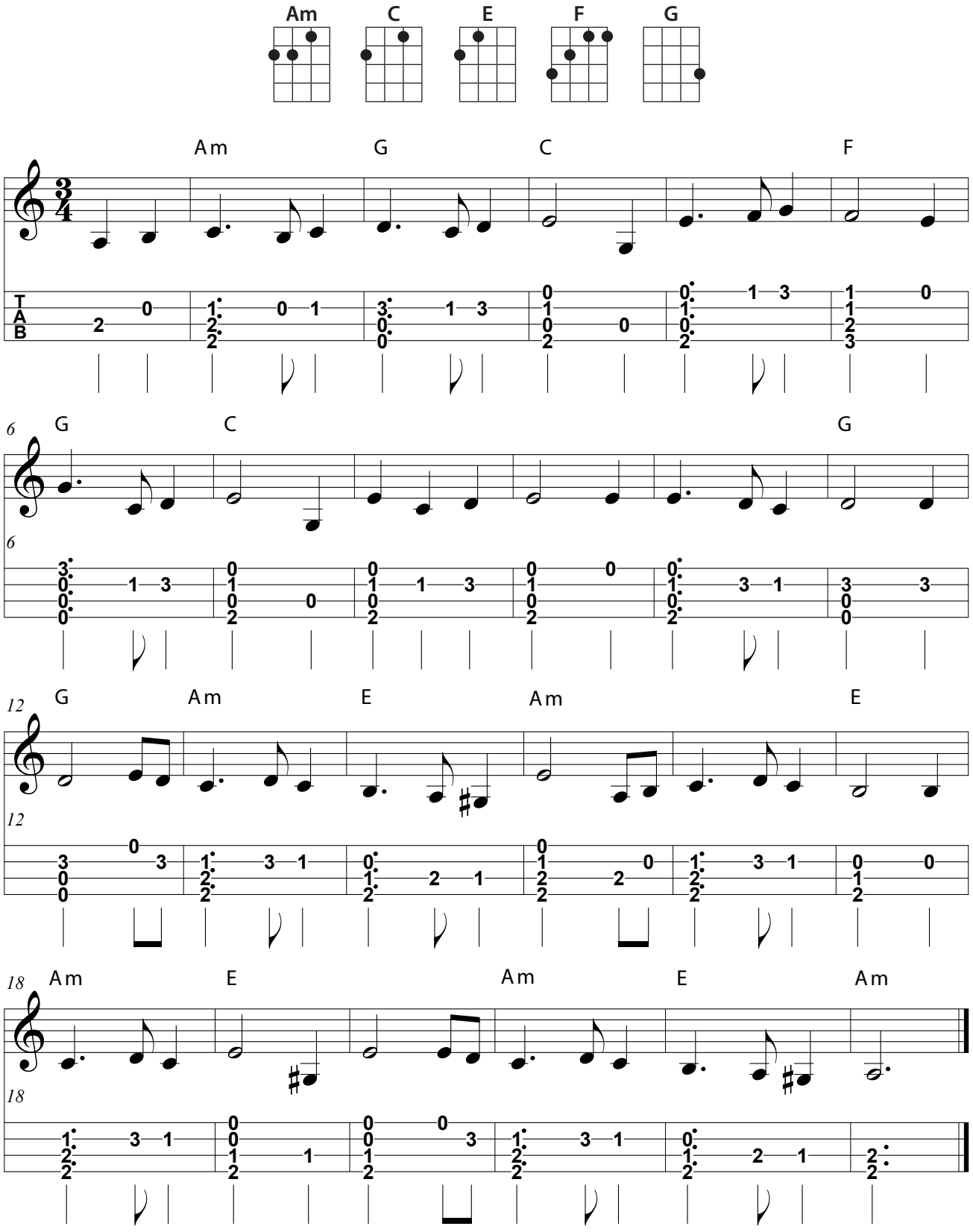
Mauro Giuliani (1781–1829)



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Spagnoletta

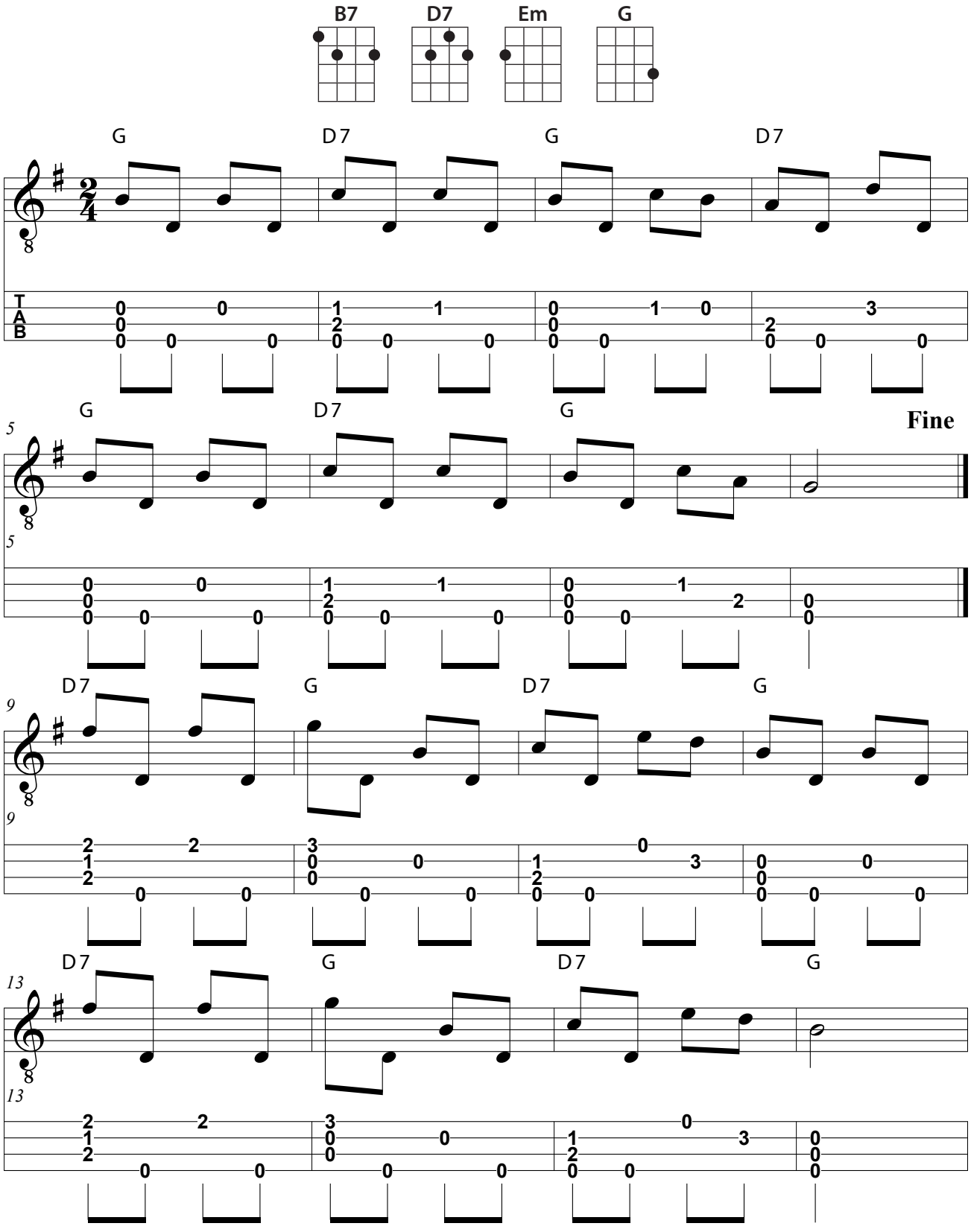
Mario Fabritio Caroso (1535–1620)



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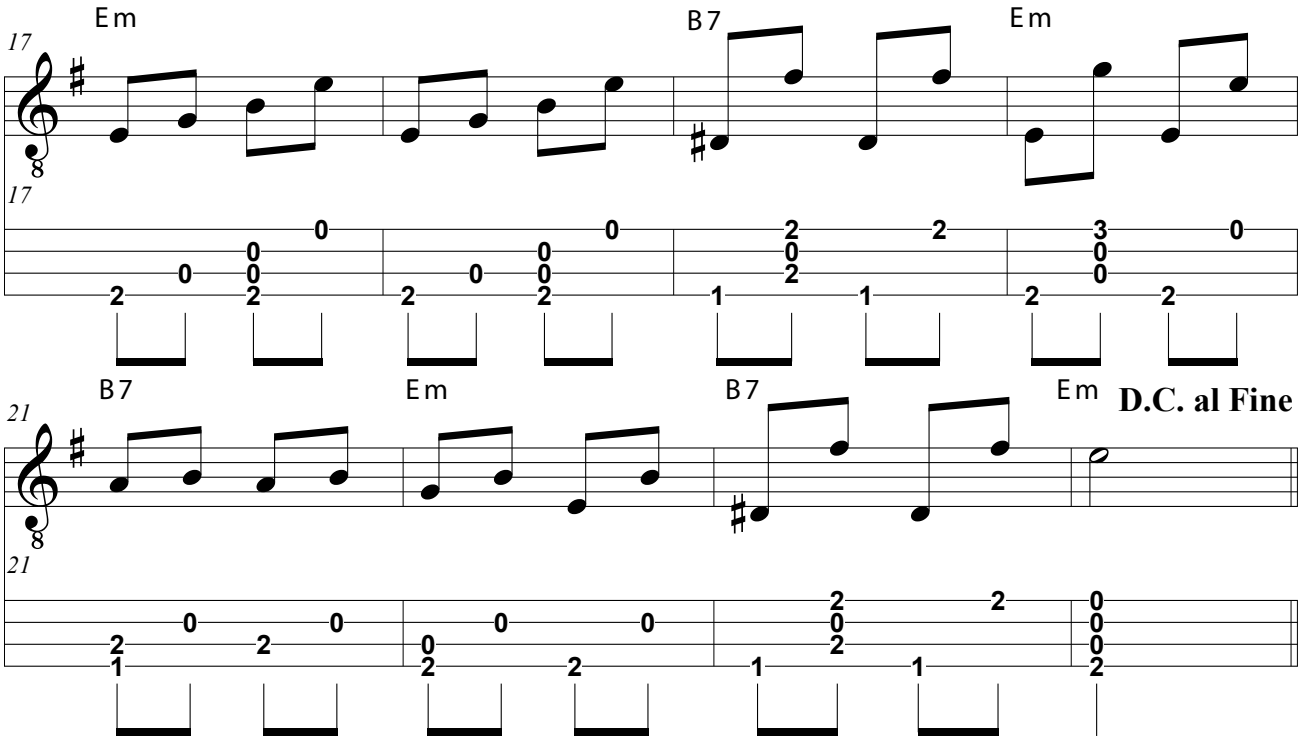
Study in G

Ferdinando Carulli (1770–1841)



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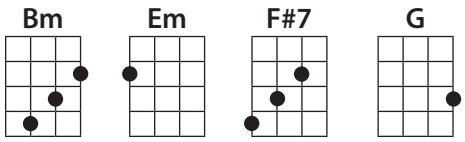
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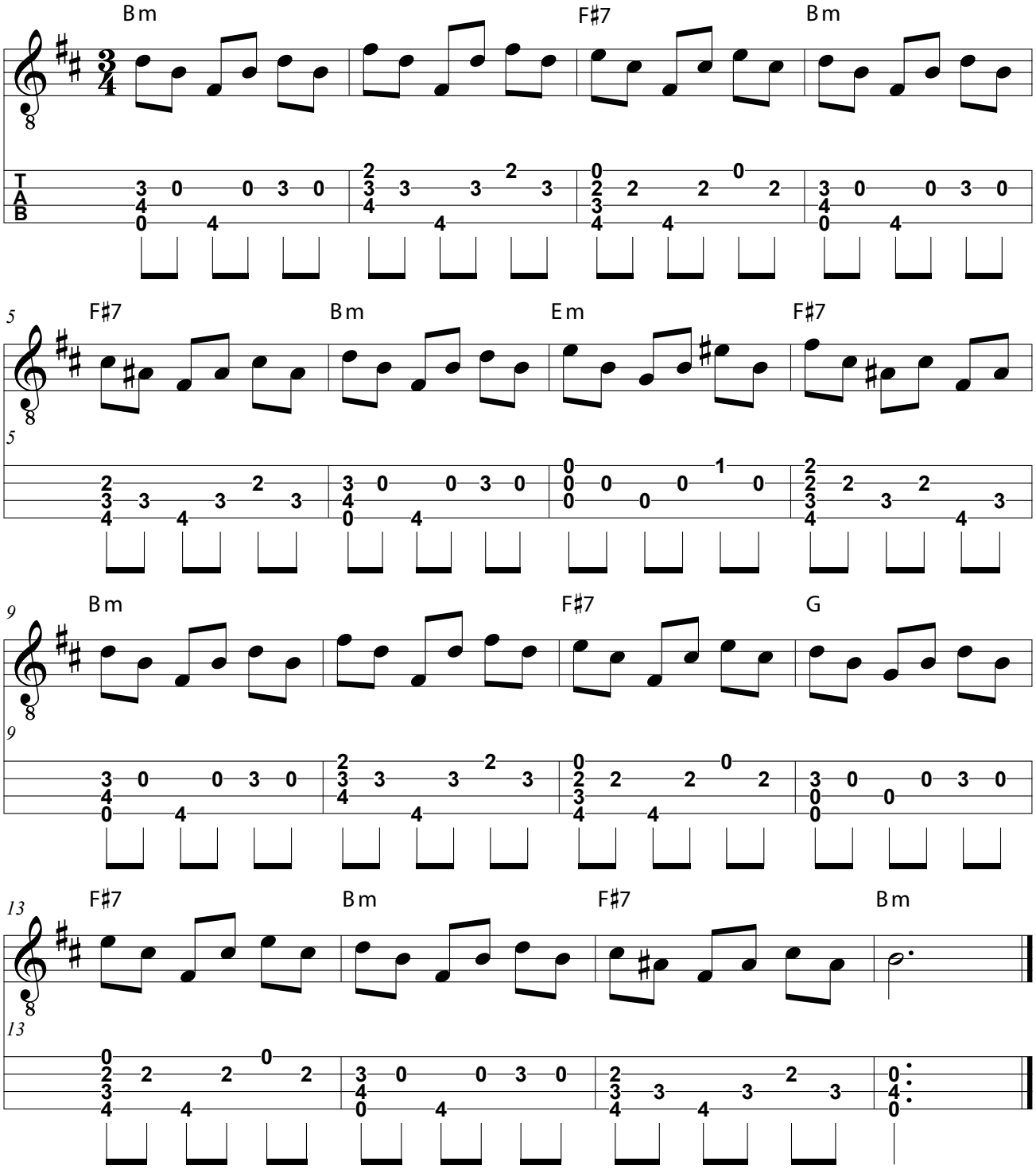


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Study No. 5

Fernando Sor (1778–1839)
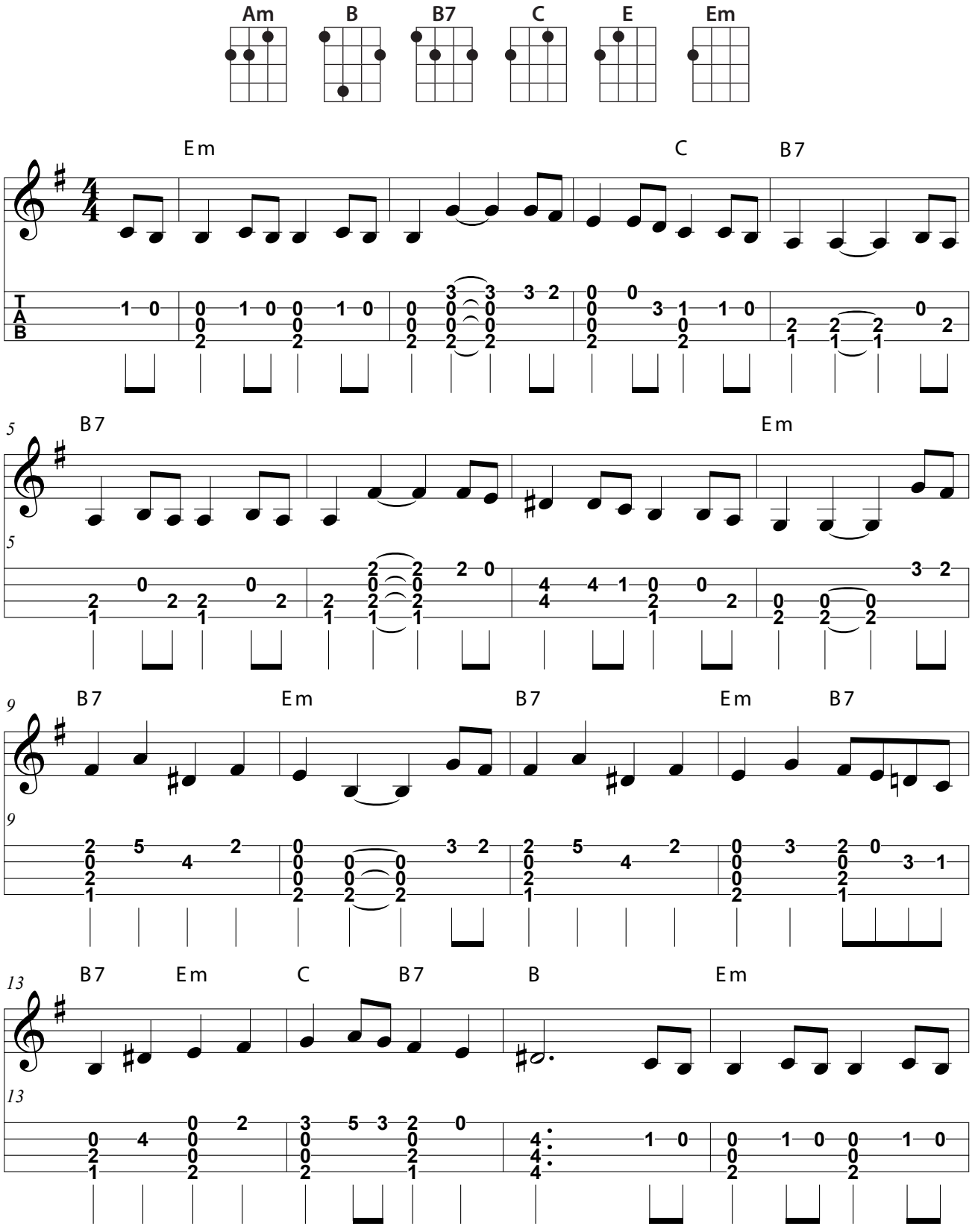




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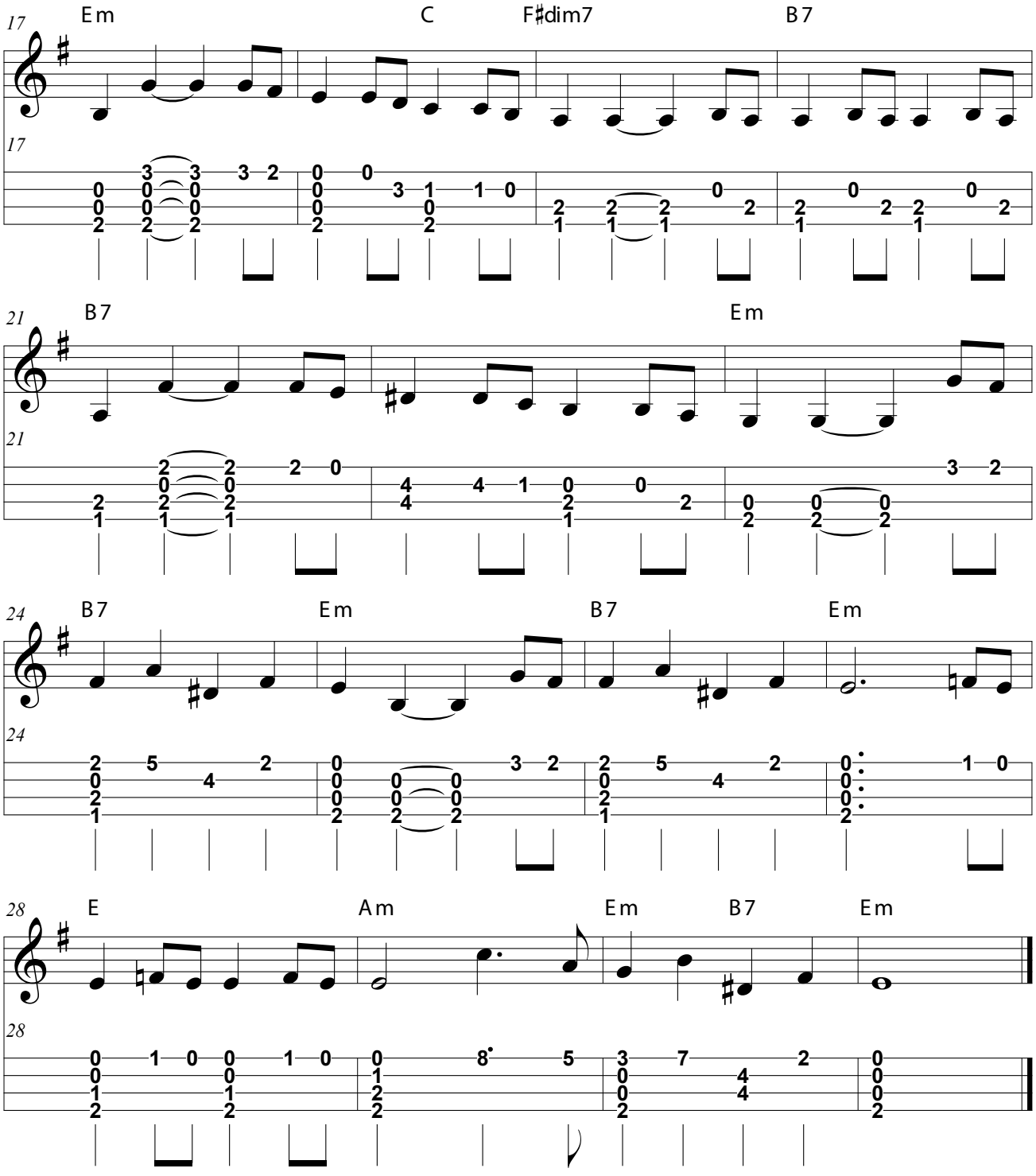
Symphony No. 40

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart (1756–1791)



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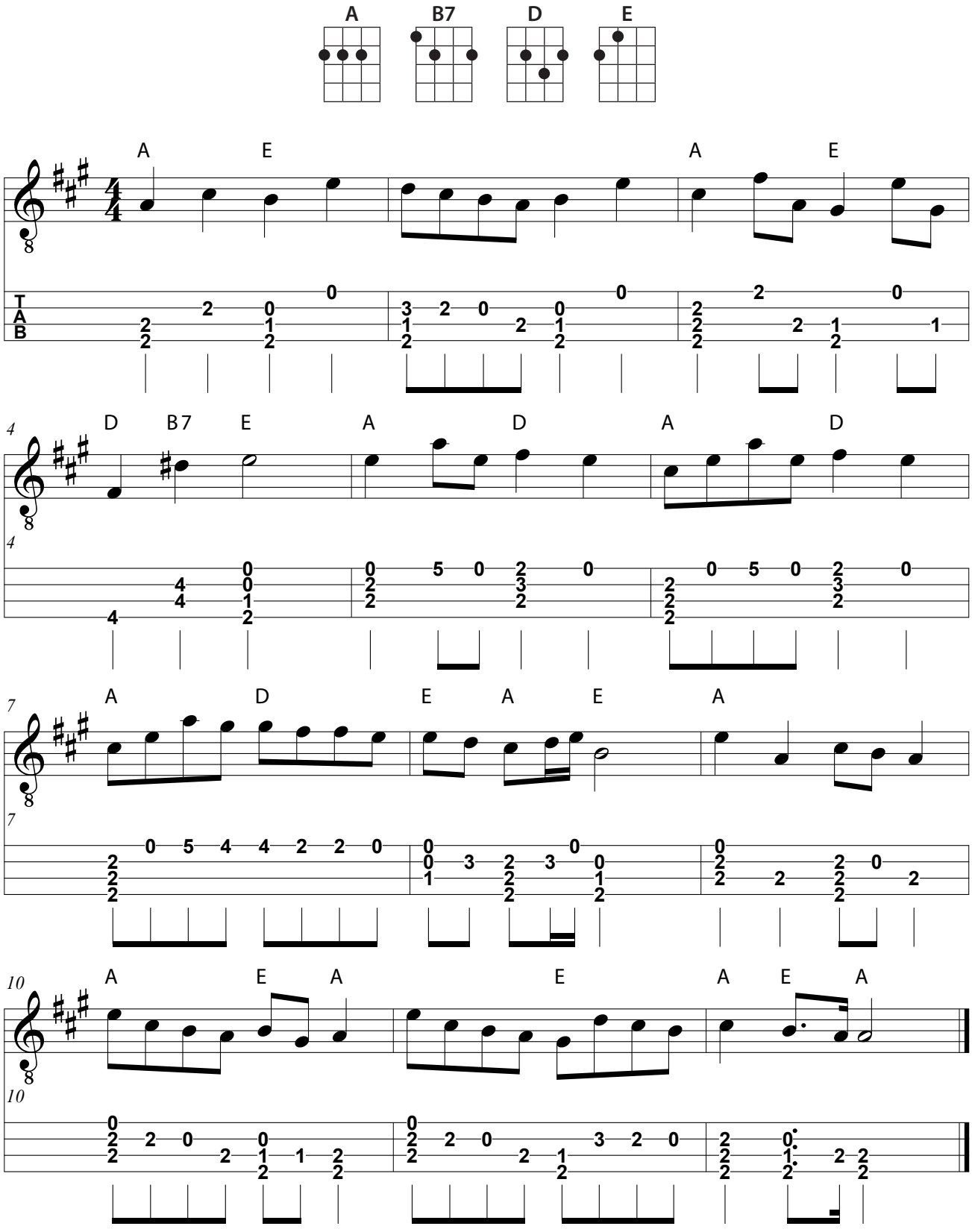
Symphony No. 40



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Theme and Variations
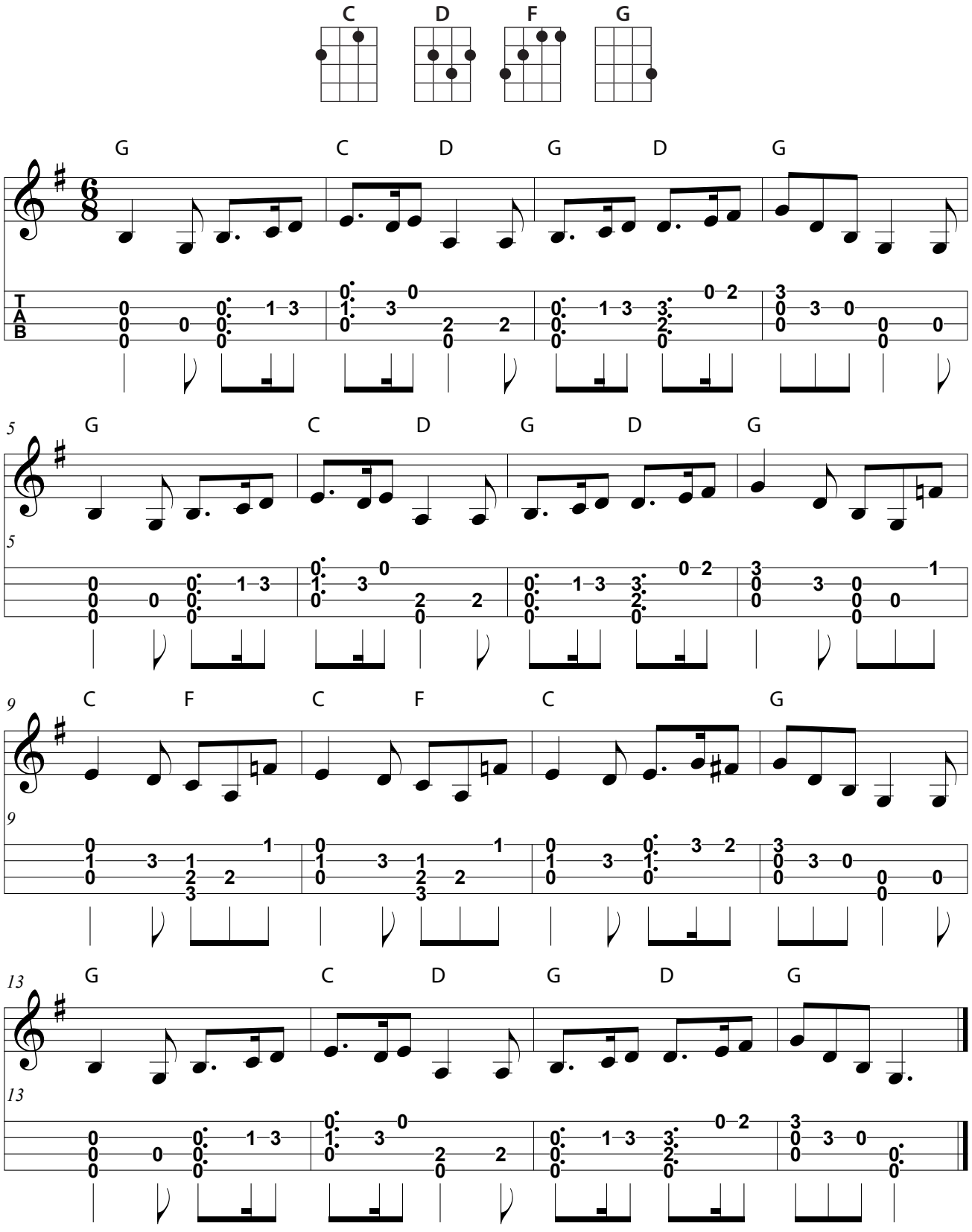
Mauro Giuliani (1781–1829)



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A Toy
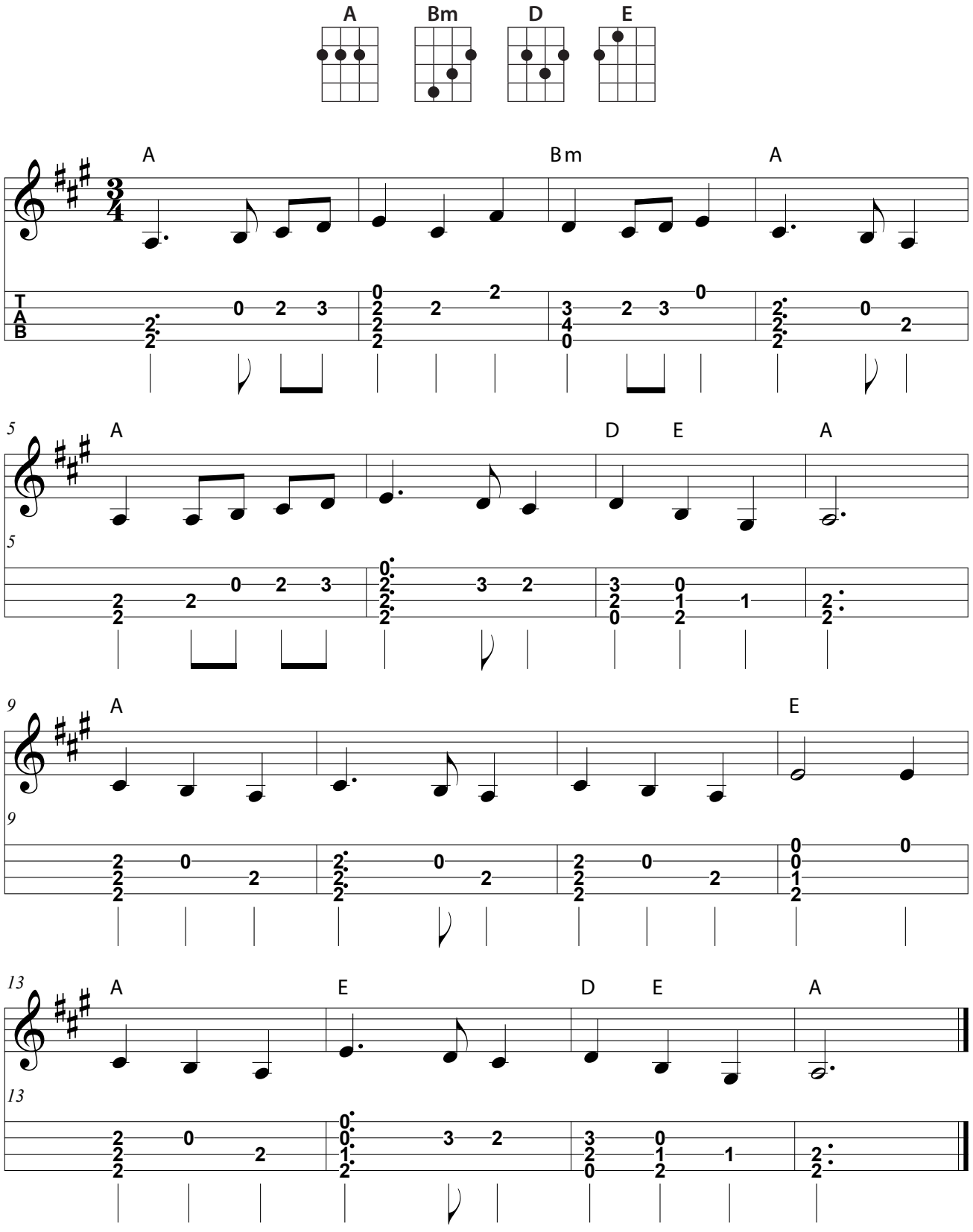
Anonymous (Renaissance)



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Volte

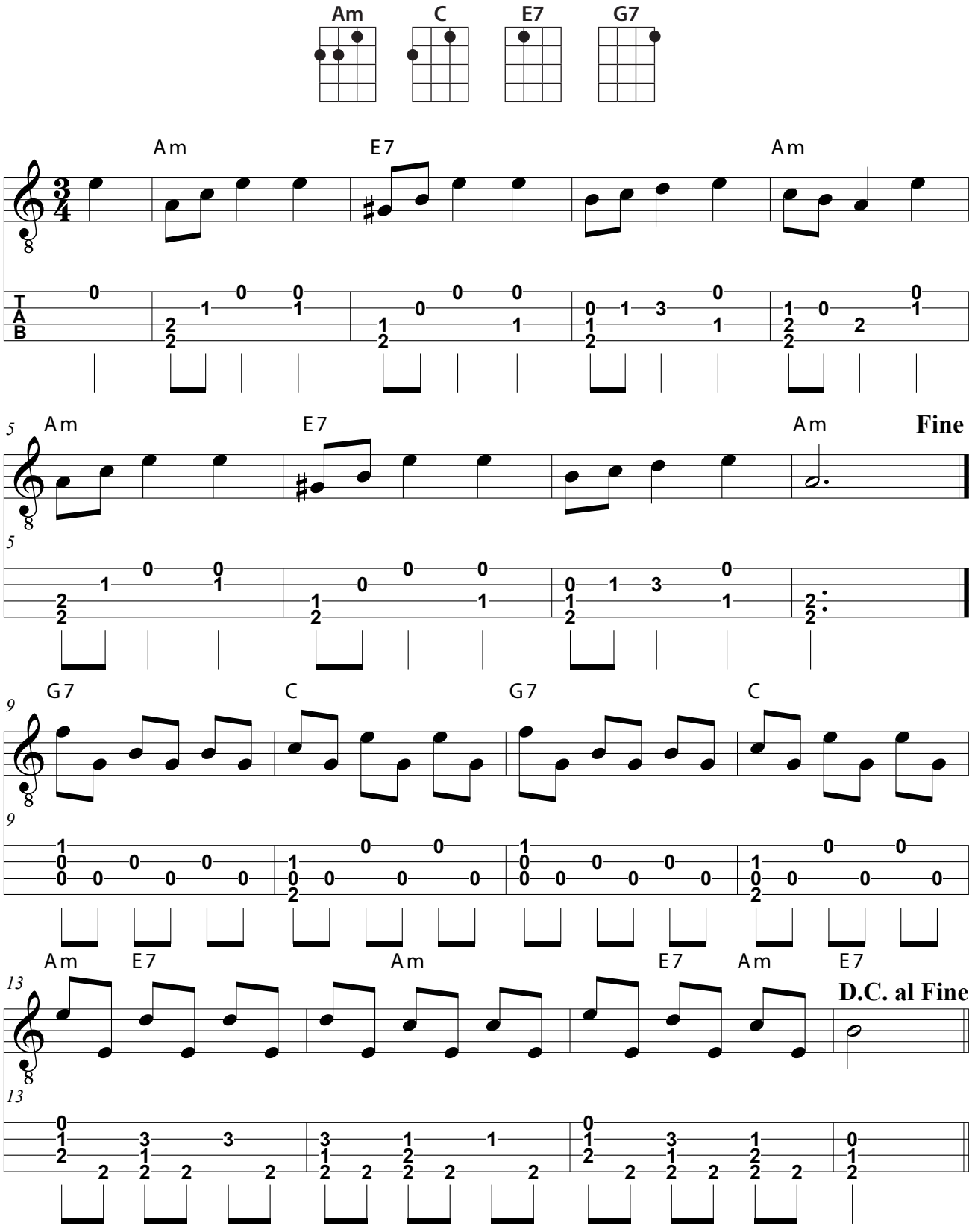
Anonymous (Renaissance)



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Waltz in A Minor
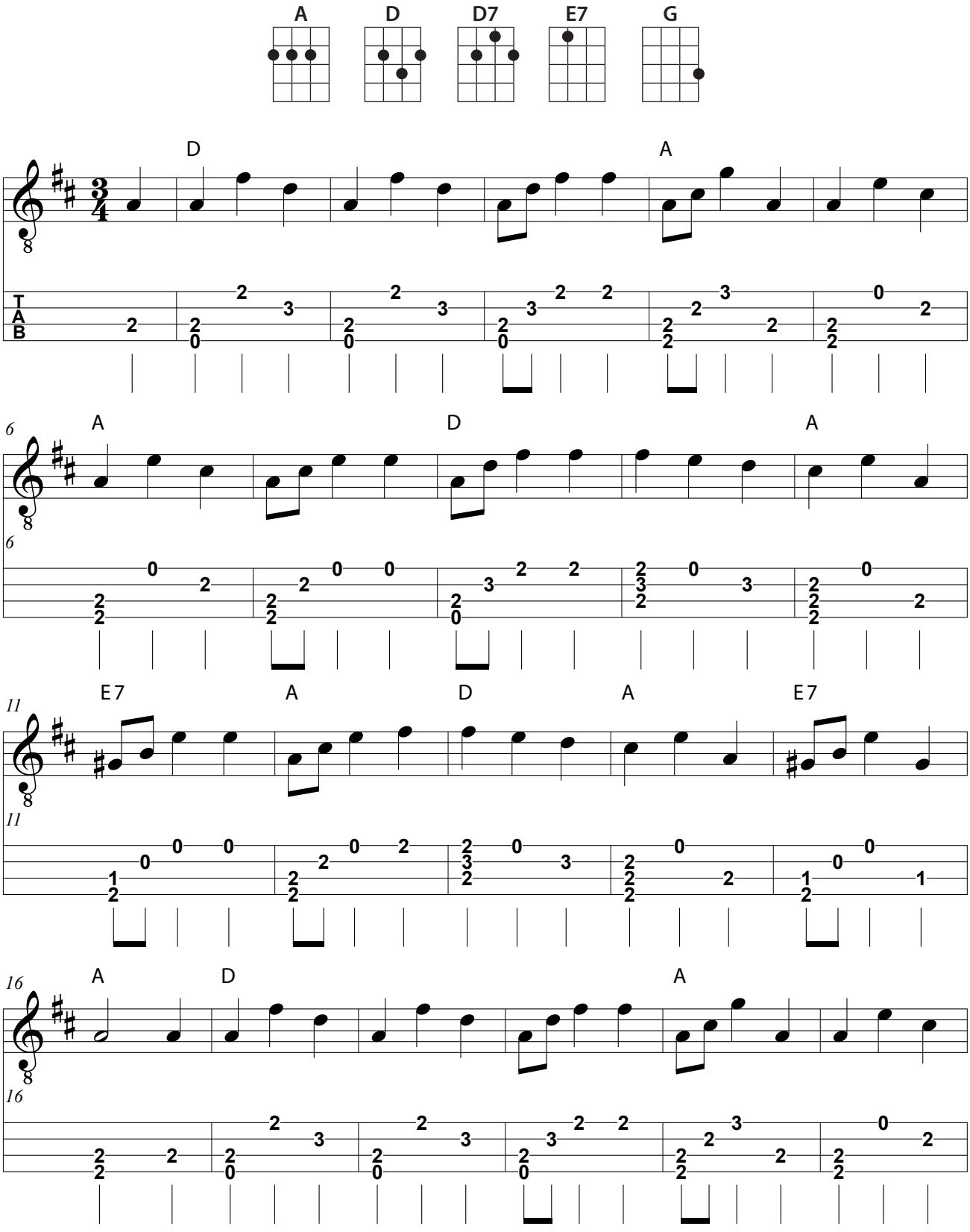
Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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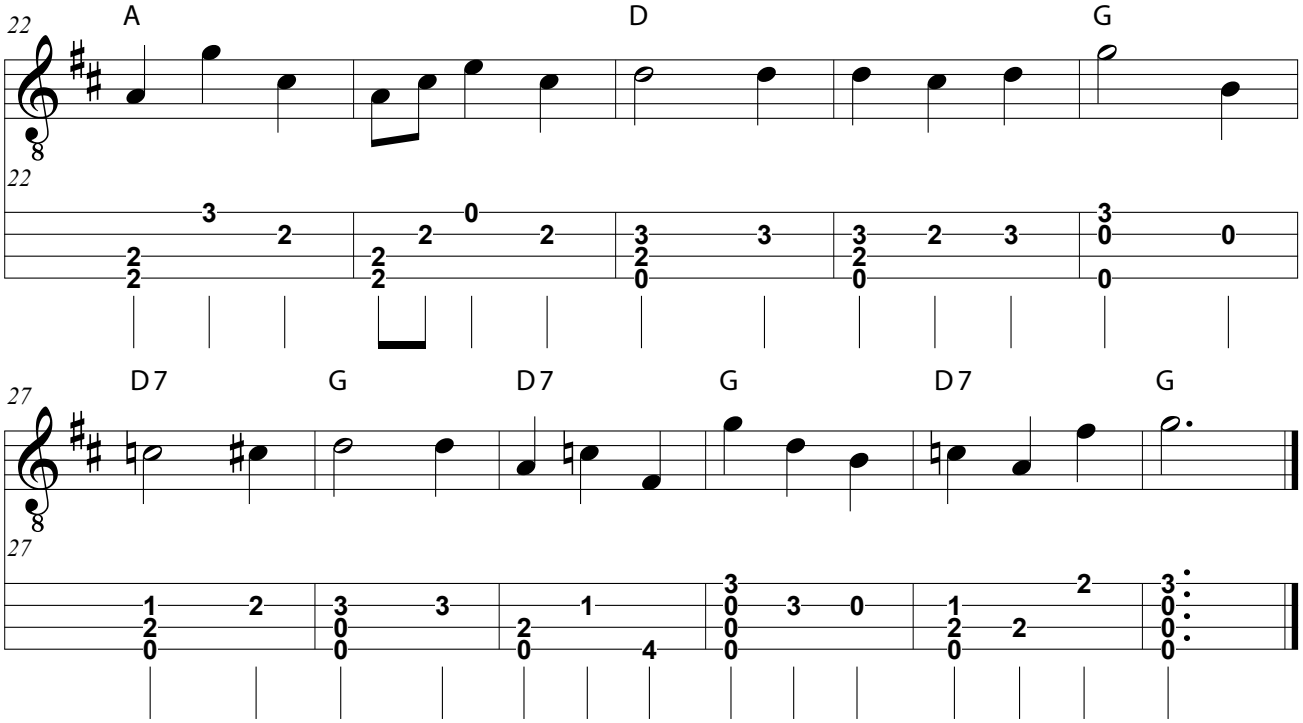
Waltz in D

Matteo Carcassi (1792–1853)



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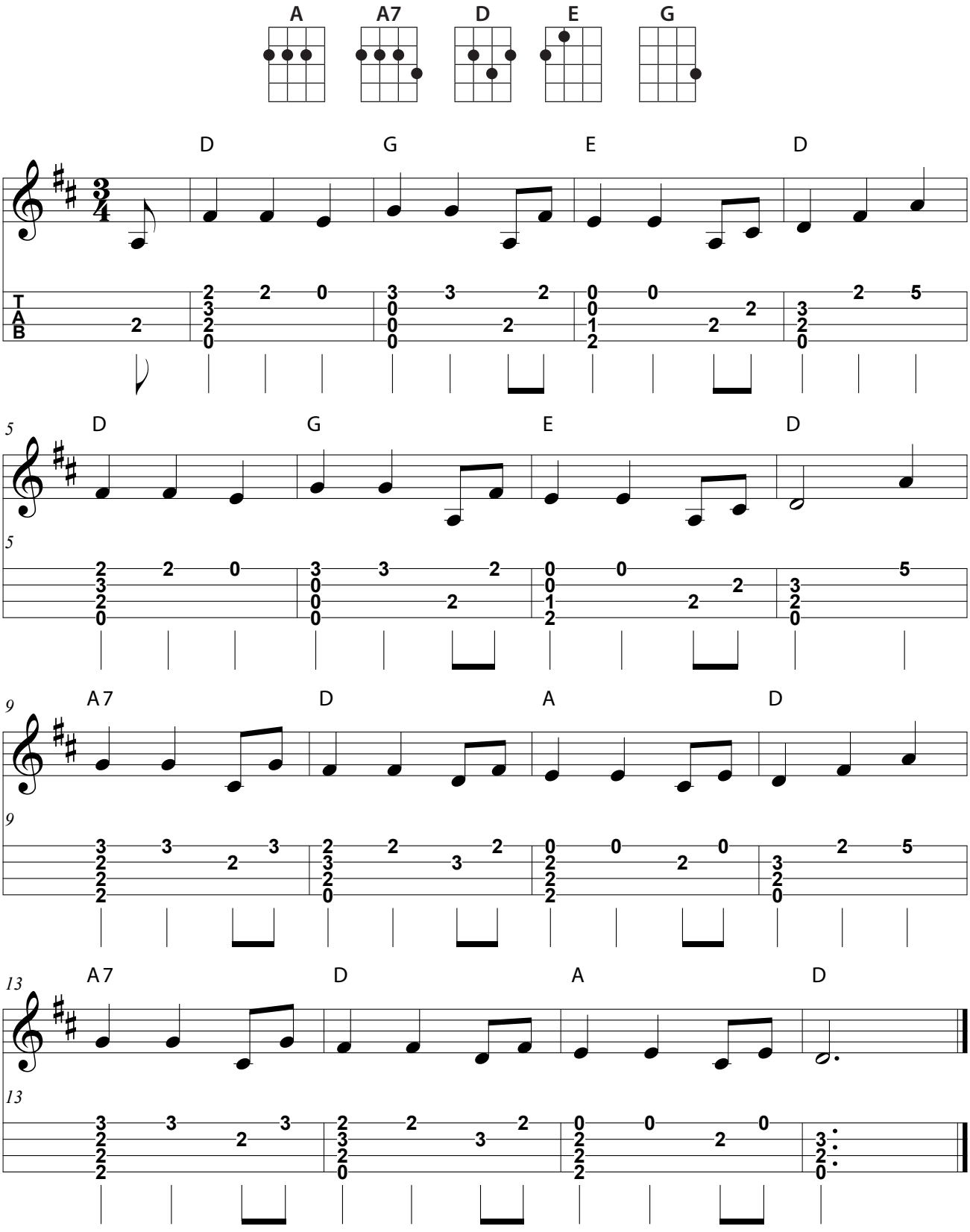
Waltz in D



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Waltz No. 3
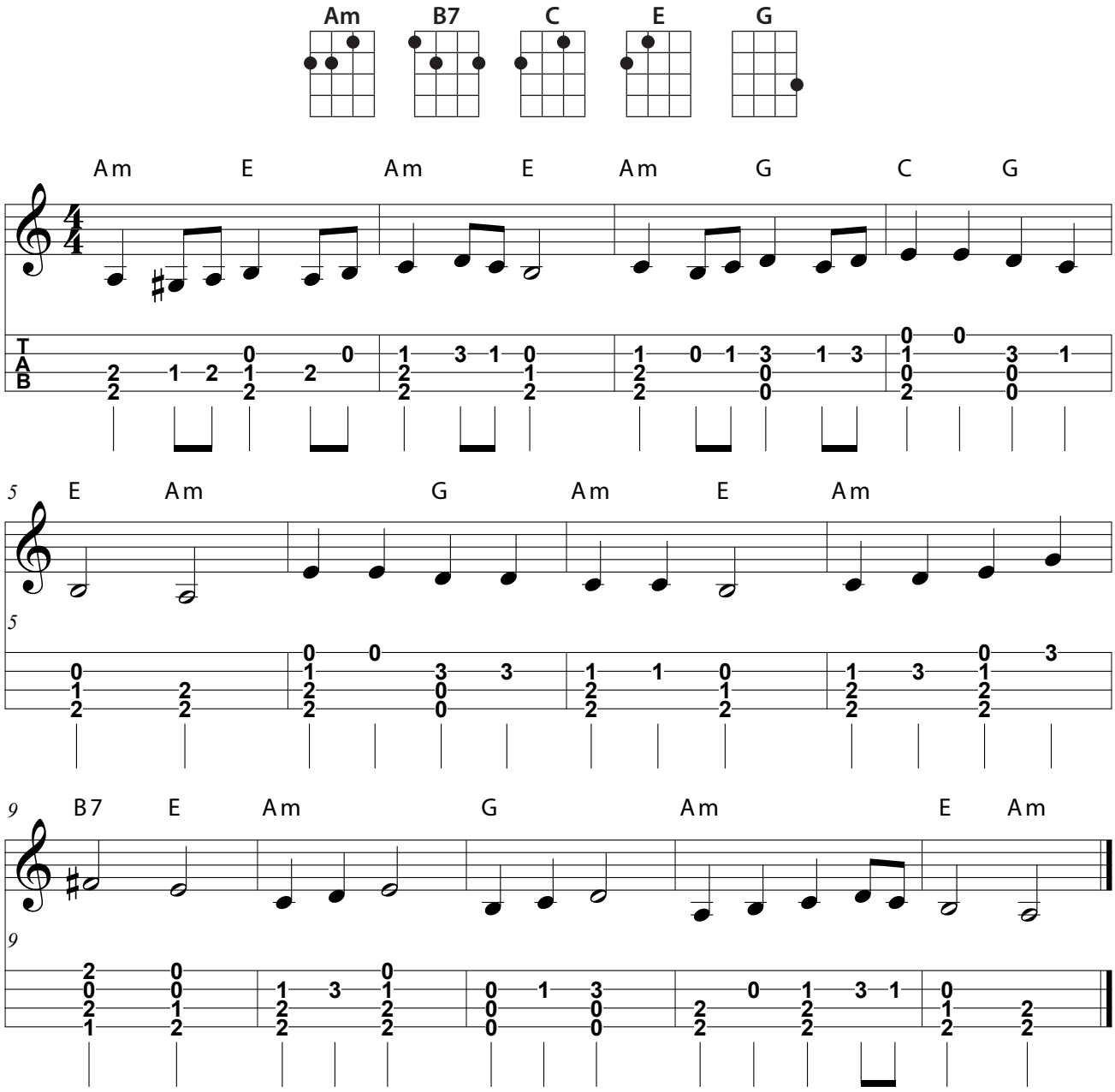
Ferdinando Carulli (1770–1841)



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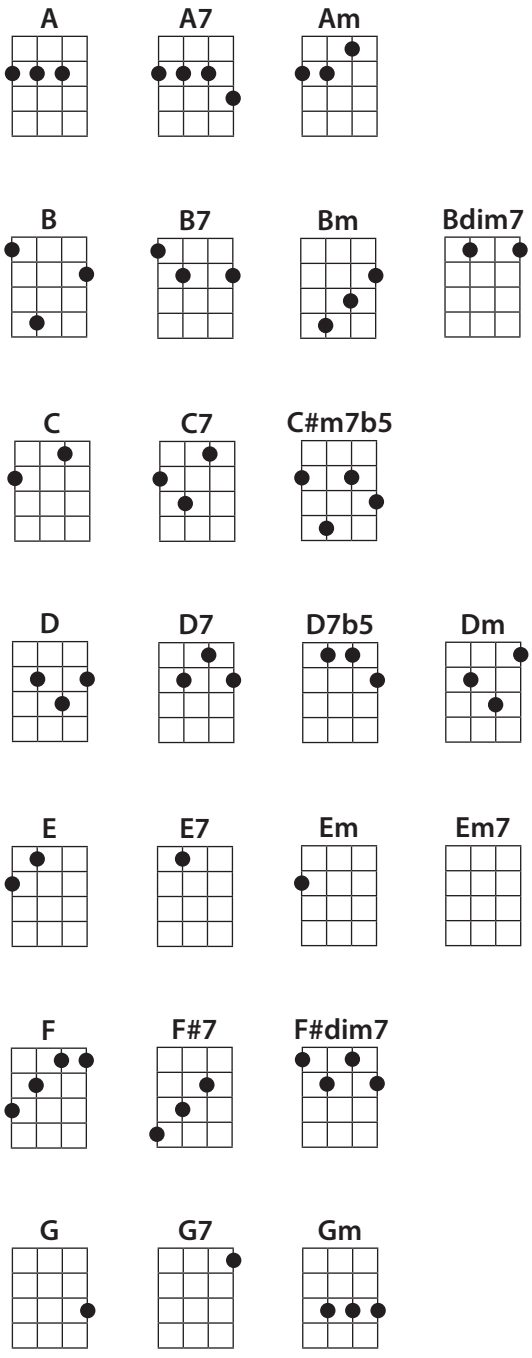
What If a Day or a Month or a Year

Anonymous (Renaissance)



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Appendix



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